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Call: Nov 2023

Page 1 of 13

"JSW Infrastructure Limited
Q2 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call"
November 04, 2023

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JSW Infrastructure Limited
November 04, 2023

Page 2 of 13

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to JSW Infrastructure Q2 FY24 Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Sagar. Good morning. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q2 FY24 Earnings Call of JSW Infra. This is the first call, post -listing of the company. To discuss the result today, we have with us Mr. Arun Maheshwari, Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole -time Director and CFO and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head Investor Relations. We will start with brief opening remarks by the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Mohit. Good morning and thank you all for joining our first earnings calls as a listed entity. I am Arun Maheshwari. I start by taking this opportunity to thank each one of our shareholders for the trust and confidence that you have bestowed in our company. The company achieved a major milestone of getting listed on 3rd October 2023. Despite the global geopolitical challenges we witnessed in the last two years, that too after two and a half years of COVID disruptions, the business environment in India continues to be very strong.

We are witnessing a solid structural growth in almost every sector of the economy. Considering the importance of the logistics sector of a growing economy and more so maritime sector, which constitutes about 95% of the exempt rate, Prime Minister unveiled a blueprint for the Indian

maritime blue economy and laid the foundation stone for projects worth more than INR23,000 crores at the recently concluded Global Maritime Summit 2023. Government's vision of course for prosperity, progress and productivity is bringing transformational changes at the ground level.

It was heartening to witness that the government is taking major steps to take the logistics sector more efficient and effective. The growing need of strategic modern logistics assets to bring down the overall cost has been the flare for past few years of country's budget as well. Central and state governments are working in tandem to increase the country's total port handling capacity to

10,000 million tons by 2047 from the existing of 2,600 million tons per annum.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 3 of 13

In alignment with this vision, the role of private players is being progressively augmented with public-private partnership terminals. Major ports in India, which are central government owned, have total capacity in excess of 50% of overall India's port capacity and a large portion of it yet to be privatized. This offers a huge opportunity for a business enterprise like us to leverage and grow our business.

The government's move to landlord -port model is encouraging and will fuel a lot of private investment and will bring much desired efficiencies and enhance productivity into the port operations. Against this backdrop, we continue to evaluate such opportunities and presently we have placed our best to acquire terminals at three different ports under the government's privatization move. As such, JSW Infrastructure Limited is uniquely positioned to capitalize on India's growth opportunities with a strong balance sheet and ambitious growth targets.

Moving on to our operational performance for the period April 23 to September 23, the total cargo handle stood at 49 plus million tons. This is 70% growth year -on-year basis. The total revenue and EBITDA for the half year stood at INR1,814 crores and INR991 crores respectively. With a strong balance sheet in the sector, we are well-positioned to pursue organic and inorganic growth opportunity. In line with the strategy of pursuing value -adaptive growth, I'm happy to share that the acquisition of liquid storage facility of 465,000 cubic meters at the Fujairah port in Middle East for a consideration of \$187 million. The facility was owned by NPT Commodities Limited, which is a part of Mercurial Group.

This acquisition helps us to foray into the lucrative business of liquid storage at the Fujairah port UAE, as well as which is one of the largest bunkering hub in the world. The transaction is expected to close by December 23 and with this let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take through the financials and other details.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you Arun and good morning everyone. I take this opportunity to thank you all for your overwhelming response to our first equity -raised program. The successful listing would not have been possible without your endorsement and belief in our growth story.

So thank you again. Moving on to our quarterly results, in Q2 FY24, the company handled cargo volumes of 23.7 million tons as compared to 18.7 million tons in quarter ended September '22. Increase in cargo volume has resulted in increase in revenue for the quarter from INR662 crores to INR848 crores, year -on-year growth of 28%.

Cargo handled at Jaigarh and Dharamtar port have increased by 35% and 34% respectively, year-on-year on back of increased cargo from JSW Steel. For the Paradip coal terminal which had first full year of operations in FY23 has given a cargo growth of 28% in the current quarter. Similarly, cargo handled at Paradip Iron Ore terminal has increased substantially in the current quarter on a year -on-year basis.

Mangalore container terminal handled close to 54,400 TEU which is 7% higher on year -on-year basis. Increase in Paradip and Mangalore locations have contributed to increase in third -party cargo growth of 31% in current quarter on overall basis. So third -party cargo has increased to 8.55 million tons from 6.58 million tons. Other income which mainly includes interest on fixed

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 4 of 13

deposit and gain on mutual fund investment has gone up to INR47 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR35 crores in the quarter ended September 22.

So EBITDA of quarter ended September 23 has gone to INR499 crores from INR375 crores in the quarter ended September 22 resulting in an increase of 33%.

EBITDA margins stood at

55.76% in the current quarter as compared to 53.91% in the quarter ended September 22.

Depreciation was INR100 crores and finance cost was INR71 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR99 crores and INR109 crores respectively in the quarter ended September 22. Tax expense for the current quarter is INR72 crores as against INR29 crores in the quarter ended September 22. So effective tax rate has gone up to in current quarter to 22% from 17% mainly on account of end of 80 IA deductions for two births at our Jaigarh Port in current year FY '24. PAT for the current quarter is INR255 crores, as against INR138 crores for the quarter ended September '22, representing an increase of 85% on year -on-year basis.

Increase in PAT is a reflection of increased total income efficient operations resulting in lower operating expenses and lower finance cost. As of September 30, we remain a net debt free company with total cash and cash equivalents of INR5,333 crores while gross debt stood at INR4,261 crores. Based on our strong performance of the previous period, the credit agency Moody has upgraded our credit rating from BA 2 to BA1 with Stable outlook.

Now I'll take a moment to reiterate the usage of IPO proceeds. So out of total proceeds of INR2,800 crores, approximately INR900 crores was meant for debt repayment. As an update, we have already prepaid INR325 crores in the month of October and balance prepayment is expected in the current month. INR1,200 crores is for capex mainly for 2 million ton LPG project at Jaigarh Port and expansion of Mangalore container terminal.

Both are progressing well and are expected to be completed by January '26, and February '25, respectively. The balance is for general purpose and will be utilized accordingly. On the acquisition as Arun highlighted enterprise value is \$187 million. This will be funded by a mix of debt and internal approvals.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you so much. We will now begin with the question -and-answer session. First question is from the line of Mr. Achal Lohade from JM financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Good morning. My first question is with respect to volumes. Can you have an understanding in terms of how you see FY 24, FY '25, FY '26 volumes panned out? And what kind of [inaudible] you expect by FY '26?

Lalit Singhvi: No we are not able to hear you properly. Can you please repeat it?

Moderator: Mr. Lohade, there seems to be a lot of disturbance from your side or maybe your network is not proper. If you're using speaker mode can I request you to use your handset, please?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 5 of 13

Achal Lohade: Sorry about that. So I would like to check in terms of the volume growth expectation over the next two years. What kind of volume growth and what mix and what third -party mix can we look at?

Arun Maheshwari: Okay, thanks for this question. See basically, as we had -- you must have seen of our company, we have been continuously growing in all the sectors and we have been striving very hard for the last five years to increase our cargo mix profile and we'll continue to do that and the results have been quite visible in the previous four years, five years.

Going forward from here on, the way the opportunities are there in different sectors our acquisition of Fujairah oil terminal is then a step towards that because we were never into tankage terminal, we didn't deal with the subject.

Fujairah being a known territory for us, one of the largest liquid terminals market in the globe. So we thought, a step over there will give the hands-on experience for us to get into a tankage terminal which is very promising again in India going forward. So the effort is on and I think we have been growing at the rate of 22% CAGR for the last 20 years and most

prominently in the last four years we have grown at the rate of 40% CAGR.

I think our all the efforts would be to maintain a long -term kind of CAGR depending upon the opportunity what we get, depending upon the project how we are executing. We see immense opportunities coming in and we will try to maintain the similar kind of CAGR on the growth front, in the volume as well as product basket.

Moderator: Well as the current questioner has left the queue. We will take the next question from the line of Mr. Lokesh Maru from Nippon India Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Lokesh Maru: Thank you. Congratulations team on excellent set of numbers and the successful listing. I have two questions. One is on seasonality in volume off -take and margin mix over the four quarters of a year. And another is, what is the peak EBITDA potential or what are we expecting from the Fujairah Port in FY '25 and FY '26, respectively? Just these two questions. Thanks.

Arun Maheshwari: Mr. Maru the first one is seasonality you are talking about right?

Lokesh Maru: Right. Seasonality in volumes and margin mix across our four quarters.

Arun Maheshwari: I'll just take the first part of the question on the seasonality and rest my colleague can answer that. Basically in India, monsoons are very heavy during July to September period. So a typical, I would say H1 is generally, slightly lower, Q1 is okay, Q2 is slightly lower but Q3 and Q4 are

generally better than Q2.

So in all if I have to look at it H1 is slightly lower than always as H2. So whatever the results we have given for H1 you can drive from there on. H2 would be in our expectation, as our experience has gone in the last 20 years, H2 has been slightly better than H1 always. So it would remain that way.

So far as the profitability and Fujairah Ports are concerned, my colleague Lalit would.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 6 of 13

Lalit Singhvi: So as regards Fujairah acquisition probably you are asking. So as we look at it that it should be around say, \$20 million to \$22 million for next FY, FY '24, FY '25. So that is the number we are expecting from this and we'll keep updating as we start operating this but this is our expectation. Is there anything else on this?

Lokesh Maru: Sir just a follow-up on both the things. Fujairah \$20 million to \$22 million of EBITDA annually, right?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes.

Lokesh Maru: Okay. And on seasonality, so H2 is stronger. Is it a fair assumption to put it that H2 would be 60 and H1 would be 40, like 60-40 ratio or 55-45 kind of a ratio?

Arun Maheshwari: Our previous experience has been you know generally, H2 is almost better but then we have seen it has been ranging from 7% to 12% somewhere better than H1. So it could be somewhere in between that.

Lokesh Maru: Understood sir. Thank you so much and all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mr. Sumit Kishore from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.

Sumit Kishore: Good morning. Thanks for the opportunity. I have two questions. The first question is could you give us an update on the ongoing progress or development of the Jatadhar and Keni ports? And what is the stage of financial closure and sort of groundbreaking for these projects?

And the second question is on your BSE filing related to the container train operator license that you have secured from Sical. Could you give us more strategic insight into what this means for the company over the next two years? Thanks.

Arun Maheshwari: Okay. On the update on the two Greenfield ports Jatadhar and Keni. So Jatadhar as we said, we'll be getting this soon. As we talked today, there is a meeting going on in Odisha on this particular concession agreement. So hopefully we are expecting that it should be coming around in another couple of weeks' time. So it should be done within the next couple of weeks' time as what we understand

from the authorities over there.

So far as Keni, any award of contract is there, I believe a lot of discussion has happened within the government in the last couple of weeks. And though it is still -- the award is yet to be given to us and we are expecting the general guidelines what has been given to us that they would be soon giving their decision on the award maybe within a week's time or so. So hopefully, by end of middle of October, middle of November or the end of November, we should be there on both the sides.

And so far as your second question is concerned regarding the container train operator license. So if you have closely watched our company, we were never into containers. We got into containers 2020 and we have been very happy with that. We were never into LPG. We got into LPG in a smaller manner in Jaigarh. We have been very, very outstanding results. We were

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 7 of 13

never into liquid terminals. We got into liquid tankage terminal in Fujairah by this acquisition what we announced yesterday. So we will test that water with that as well and we are pretty hopeful our due diligence is a very, very good investment.

Similarly container train operator license, we were never into end-mile delivery. So this is the first step towards the connecting the end customer directly. So this is a test what we are doing. The investments are very miniscule but it's a flare which probably will take the company to the next level of servicing to our customers. So this is an attempt towards that and I'm sure the way our research says, it would be a good investment. And once we get a hang of it, probably we can go further deep into these deliveries.

Sumit Kishore: Thanks a lot and wish you all the best.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you so much. The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead, sir.

Priyanka Biswas: Thanks for the opportunity, sir. So my first question is, like regarding further acquisition opportunities. So both in case of major port s' tenders or let's say, NCLT cases that may be there. So can you provide a let's say a pipeline or some sort of a thing like what can we expect in the let's say, next 24 months regarding major port tenders or maybe some acquisition opportunity? That's the first one.

Arun Maheshwari: So guidelines wise if I have to look at it, Government of India has made it very clear they would like to be a land on model and every month we see couple of opportunities coming up. Few of our liking and few of our not in the overall strategy sitting. So every month we see opportunities coming in. The pipeline is huge. How much comes, when it comes, it is purely depends upon the individual port developments. It is difficult to put a number how much will come in the next 12 months or 24 months.

But there are there are opportunities coming every month and I think two to three out of 10 are to our liking. So we can -- we keep exploring it. We look at the geography, the potential of the increase, the customer base, whether the cargo profile suits our overall strategy, whether it is fitting into our vision of 2030 or 2035 global vision. So if everything ticks box then only we pursue that opportunity very sincerely and then we will bid for it.

So it is difficult to put a number how many opportunities will government give but the capacity wise if I have to look at it, almost out of 2,600 million ton of total port capacity of India, 1,600 million ton is owned by Government of India. So 1,500 million is owned by Government of India. So that and out of which only 30%, 40% is as of now under public -private partnership. Balance is yet to be given on public -private partnership.

So pipeline is solid in terms of capacity. Pipeline is solid in number of the intention of the government and we being one of the largest terminal holders

in India understand this business

very well. And hopefully, we will be well suited for participating in these biddings and secure something out of it.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 8 of 13

So far as NCLT is concerned, we are not looking or scanning each and every opportunity which is coming our way. We are very cautious, choosy and ensuring that our money gets us better return. There's plethora of opportunity. We don't want to just bid whatever opportunity comes in our way and stuck with that. So we would like to invest only a value -accretive strategy or any investment which gives a better return for all of us.

Priyanka Biswas: If I just add on to it, like which states or would be your focus, as far as let's say, considering ports?

Arun Maheshwari: So see, we have been in Maharashtra, we have been in Karnataka, we have been in Chennai, in Tamil Nadu, we are in Odisha and we are in Goa. So where we are not is Gujarat, we are not in Bengal, we are not in Andhra, we are not in Kerala. These are the four states left out by us.

There are opportunities coming in these states and including the existing states where we are. I think we would see if we can have something in Gujarat, if we can have something in Andhra, if we can have something in more in Karnataka or somewhere. So already Odisha and Karnataka we are already pursuing greenfield ports. We would like to look at that but otherwise good enough opportunities in every state today. So whichever comes in our way, if it is fitting on our overall strategy, we are definitely there.

But four states we are not there as of today. Gujarat, Bengal, Kerala and Andhra. So these four states definitely remains on our wish list.

Priyanka Biswas: If I just can squeeze one more in. So we are seeing a lot of volume growth driven by your Paradip Asset in particular. So if you can highlight what is the peak potential? I mean if you include future expansions as well especially on the coal and iron ore sites because I understand that there would be increased coastal movement from let's say, Coal India connections. So what is your, can you shed some color on that aspect?

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you for asking this question. See these are the two big investments we have done outside Jaigarh port. Jaigarh port is our flagship port and the second biggest investment we have done is in Paradip port in these two terminals put together.

Now iron ore terminal is only three year old terminal running at 100% capacity has a potential to do much more than what it is designed for what has been in the concession agreement. And if the port allows us, we can handle more cargo over there which we can certainly see because port would be earning revenue out of our handling of cargo as a revenue share.

So far as the coal terminal is considered, it's a 30 million ton coal terminal. This is the second full year of operation of the terminal. One of the largest coal export terminal in India handled very efficiently with all the modern equipments. This is the second year of operation. The first year of operation we were handling 40% of the total capacity.

This is the second year of operation we expect that we should be -- our target is to achieve 60%

of the total capacity. Still we will have enough headroom available to utilize that capacity being one of the very strategically located these two terminal very close to the mines, it becomes a naturally first choice for any customer to handle their cargo from our -- these two terminals.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 9 of 13

Imagine, there is no new coal mine started for coastal movement there is no new thermal power plant started for coastal movement. This terminal which is one of the largest came into the scenario and running at almost 60% capacity in the second year of operation. So there's so much of cargo demand the people were -- because

of the strategic location, we see that the volume will continue to grow in this terminal till we reach our peak over here. I think another two years to three years' time, we should be there for the -- for touching the peak.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay sir, so there could be further expansion on this or this is the...

Arun Maheshwari: No. Capex is already done. So it is only the utilization because any port takes about four years to five years of utilization. The beauty of terminal model is that the customer base is already there, strategic locations are there. So the utilization is much faster in terminal businesses so maybe two years to three years we reach almost 80% to 100%.

What we have witnessed in other terminals, whether it's Ennore or Mangalore or Paradip iron ore terminal, the utilization has been close to 100% of the third year of operation. And the coal is only the second year of full year of operation. So we expect similar feat should be there for coal terminal also but it all depends upon how much of coastal cargo or how much of railways available, how much coal mining is done. But in all fairness because of the location and the facility what we provide for the coal movement on the coastal side, we should be there.

Priyanka Biswas: Thank you sir that's very clear.

Moderator: Thank you so much. The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: Good morning everyone and thank you for the opportunity. My first question relates to Jaigarh airport and Dharamtar airport. I wanted to get a sense that while these airports are benefiting from wallet share gain. For how long can a very, very strong trajectory continue post which the wallet share gain from Dolvi will kind of be taken out?

Vishesh Pachnanda: Aditya would you mind repeating your question please?

Arun Maheshwari: Your voice is bit echoing, so we couldn't really get out.

Aditya Mongia: So the question was that today Dolvi is kind of helping Dharamtar and Jaigarh airport fantastic growth numbers, probably due to wallet share gain. For how long does this strong period for Dolvi and sorry, Jaigarh and Dharamtar continue, post which the wallet share gain argument gets taken out?

Arun Maheshwari: Okay. So Dolvi and Jaigarh has been growing, showing strong numbers. Jaigarh has the different reasons all also in addition to what Dharamtar had because Jaigarh has been ending third-party business. The sugar has grown quite a lot in the last three years, four years, five years. LPG has started, fertilizer is started. So there are variety of other cargos which are at Jaigarh. So their growth story and Dharamtar growth stories are similar to an extent but then Jaigarh has a more potential and more growth story available to them because it's a greenfield port, deep sea water port and a good hinterland over there.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

November 04, 2023

Page 10 of 13

So going forward, the way JSW Steel Dolvi plant is growing, as of now they are 10 million ton which is this is the first year of their peak of 10 million ton what they are producing over there. That's why the growth numbers are coming going up -and-up. The kind of their sourcing is changing the more volumes are flowing into Jaigarh. So we see not everything will come directly to Dharamtar. There will part of the volume will also come to Jaigarh Port, which will add more volumes at Jaigarh in addition to what they are already doing.

There is an intention for JSW Steel, what we understand that they would like to increase their capacities there also which will be a direct plus point for Jaigarh and Dharamtar both with a minimal capex we can do much, much more volume in these two ports again. Once we have a very clear advice from JSW Steel, probably that will help us to give our projections much more stronger and very clarity how and when it will happen.

Adi

Aditya Mongia: Sure, thanks for the color over there. The second question that I had was while we talk about privatization, from a balance sheet perspective, how much money can be put to good use over

say, the next three years, given your own assessment or the business point of view in terms of EBITDA as well?

Arun Maheshwari: Participating in privatization you mean to say?

Aditya Mongia: I'm trying to assess how much money from the balance sheet can be put to good use over time over a three-year period from your perspective towards adding new assets?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes so it's like this we have you know given a guidance that we will have a net debt to EBITDA you know of 2.5 so today we are net debt free positions so you can see that there is a large headroom available for our growth as the balance sheet is so strong today so based on this guidance we will keep investing for our growth projects.

Aditya Mongia: Understood and just to kind of finish this part more better is there a sweet spot in terms of project sites that you are looking towards when you're bidding for assets? That's the last question for myself. Thank you.

Arun Maheshwari: So project site per se you know we have already said you know Jatadhar is one project site in Odisha which is Greenfield Port. There is another one which we are awaiting the award in Karnataka in Keni that's again a Greenfield Port. We have done an acquisition in Fujairah that is another one which we have done.

The project site we have already bidding continuously assessing and bidding into the terminals into the government ports which are all strategically located has been running for 60-70 years so those are strategic location in any which case. As I said in the earlier one of the investors call was that you know the Gujarat, Bengal, Kerala and Andhra are the states wherein we don't have any footprints as of now. We would continue to seek and explore the opportunity if we get something over there.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mr. Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

JSW Infrastructure Limited
November 04, 2023

Page 11 of 13

Achal Lohade: I missed out on the long term was the last word I heard. If you could repeat the same. If you would have talked about FY '24, '25, '26 volume guidance anything given?

Arun Maheshwari: So what we have mentioned earlier is that you know generally our growth has been 20%-22% CAGR of the last 20 years and in the last four years we have been doing about 40% kind of CAGR. On a long term basis we would like to our business would like to maintain the similar kind of CAGR. The opportunities are unlimited, the balance sheet is there, the management intention is to keep growing the business and India is offering that opportunity today. Probably with this kind of balance sheet we would like to continue our business would to continue maintain the similar kind of CAGR going forward.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Is there any number you can put out sir for capex for FY '24, '25, '26?

Arun Maheshwari: On the capex front?

Lalit Singhvi: No capex actually we keep looking for many opportunities as we just said that you know our guidance is 2.5 net debt to EBITDA. Within that we will keep doing it. So it's difficult to give any number as we look for many opportunities. We just announced one acquisition today then there are greenfield projects which will keep coming in how much money will go in that in particular year. So number is difficult but within that guidance we will keep growing.

Achal Lohade: Right and if I were to ask you about Jatadhar project you know given we are at the almost closing of the agreement. Can you help us in terms of what size by when and what capex would it entail in the Phase I or total?

Arun Maheshwari: See the Jatadhar project the total project is for about 52 million ton in two phases. The Phase I is about 30

million ton and the second Phase is 22 million ton. We are yet waiting for the concession agreement to be signed. Hopefully we should be sending it very shortly now and the project should take about three years time from the day we start commencing the construction. So in all fairness we think this is the first project on the greenfield side which will be starting and completing.

Achal Lohade: Sir any clarity you can give with respect to the environment clearances all the approvals are already in place for Jatadhar?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes all the approvals are in place for that.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nikhil Abhyankar from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Thank you sir. My first question is on Fujairah. So how much is the debt at Fujairah and our capacity utilization is already at 95% so are we looking at any immediate capacity?

Lalit Singhvi: You are talking about Fujairah terminal Yes currently capacity you know there is a huge demand so it is at 95% utilization and you know very recently it is being talked at 100% you know all the tanks are being utilized. So there we government is ready to give us you know adjacent land so there is a possibility once we take over and then if demand persists we will certainly you

know expand those capacities at a much lower cost and then we will scale it up further. As you know 465,000 cubic meter is the current capacity or we can always increase this capacity to reap benefits of the expanded you know capacities.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Understood. So and so can this confirm that the CTO operations that we have acquired so there are no trains as of now? Chikal it doesn't have any trains?

Arun Maheshwari: Green set? It doesn't have any what?

Nikhil Abhyankar: Trains.

Arun Maheshwari: No CTO is a permission for you know Yes of course there are no trains as of now but then we are so it is the first step as I said the first step getting into this last month related connectivity and we will build from here on this. So this is a testing ground for us into this segment. So we are slowly we will be slowly building up this particular portfolio.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Okay. So and like are there any opportunities in minor ports from state governments in the near to medium term?

Arun Maheshwari: So as of now we have mentioned about two, Jatadhar and Keni which we are working on. There are they keep coming several opportunities being second largest port company in India definitely every opportunity also comes to our table and we look at in our all you know sense whether it is really fitting into our overall scheme of things of growth and the kind of capacity, the kind of internal and the kind of cargo growth, profile of cargo, the customer, last minute delivery, everything it has to tick many boxes before we really go full hog on that.

So we keep assessing several opportunities and India is offering several opportunities. I must be very candid about it and I think we are there to encash part of it. But as of today we have declared two and we are we are mentioned two and we will we'll talk about that.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Okay. And so final question, who are our customers at Paradip and where exactly is the coal, what is the coal destination from this port?

Arun Maheshwari: So this this is a coal export terminal for a port company. Coal export means it is all moved towards coastal movement. India doesn't export coal per se. So it is also coastal movement. The end users are largely five major ones Tamil Nadu State Electricity Board, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, then Karnataka, then Chemco. These are the four five major customers over there which are utilizing the services from us.

Moderator: The last question is from the line of Rajarshi Maitra from InCred Capital. Please go ahead.

Rajarshi Maitra: Thank you

u for the opportunity. So my question is on the first half performance of last year. So what I noticed is that between the first quarter FY '23 and second quarter there was a volume decline of about 20% and moreover group company volumes declined by about 26%. So what I want to ask is in the second quarter of FY '23, were there any exceptional events that happened because of which the group company group volumes declined 26% in second quarter FY '23?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, so you want to say that anchor customer's volume was lower in FY '23 H1 compared to FY '24?

Rajarshi Maitra: So the anchor volumes in the second quarter FY '23 was about 12 million tons and the anchor volumes in first quarter FY '23 was 16.4 million tons. So just wanted to check was there any exceptional reason for that?

Lalit Singhvi: No, no, Q2 is always as we discussed earlier also it's a monsoon month. In the monsoon month every year you will find cargo dipping compared to Q1 or Q3. And last year there was a cyclone there which affected operations for part of the period.

Rajarshi Maitra: Okay, so the cyclone had an impact which was not there this year. So as a result the decline is not as sharp. This year the volume the decline is not that sharp.

Lalit Singhvi: Absolutely.

Moderator: Thank you so much. I would like to hand the conference over to Mr. Arun for closing comments.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you all investors and thank you for hearing it out very patiently and continue to have the confidence in the company and the management and the sector is looking good. India's economy is standing out as compared to any other economy of this size and scale and I think we are into the right country in the right sector and looking forward to have continuous engagement with you all. Thanks again for joining on a Saturday.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you so much. On behalf of ICICI Securities that concludes this conference. Thank you

for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2024

Page 1 of 13

"JSW Infrastructure Limited
Q3 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call"
February 02, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN MAHESHWARI – JOINT MANAGING
DIRECTOR AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER – JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – WHOLE -TIME DIRECTOR AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
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MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD INVESTOR
RELATIONS – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
February 02, 2024

Page 2 of 13

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to JSW Infrastructure Q3 FY24 Earnings Call hosted by ICICI Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touch -tone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Tushar. Good afternoon. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q3 FY24 earnings call of JSW Infra.

To discuss the result today, we have with us Mr. Arun Maheshwari, Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole -Time Director and CFO, and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head Investor Relations. We will start with a brief opening remarks by the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Mohit. Good evening, everyone. And thank you all for joining our earnings call for the quarter and nine -month end of December 31, 2023.

To start with, India's economic growth remains strong, led by the momentum in the manufacturing and continued investments in the infrastructure, as the tax collections are supporting a robust increase in capital outlay. As for the latest interim budget, the infrastructure capital outlay for FY25 has increased by an impressive 11% to INR11.11 lakh crores, which will continue to spur a huge multiplied impact on the economic growth momentum. Further, the government is taking major steps to make the logistics sector much more efficient and effective. The growing need of strategic modern logistic assets to bring down the overall cost has been the

flair of the past few years of the country's budget as well. On the global front, a lot is being spoken about the ongoing Red Sea conflict, the extended disruptions in the Red Sea trade route, pose a risk to the stability of the supply chain. However, we are immune to these developments because our cargo mainly comes from the bulk terminals originating out of Australia, Canada, USA, and Russia.

Before discussing our operational and financial performance, I'm delighted to announce that in addition to our other – our flagship port, Jaigarh Port has been awarded a five -star rating by the JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 3 of 13

British Safety Council. This recognition is a clear indication of our commitment to maintain the highest safety standards in

all our operations. We are proud of this achievement.

For the nine -month period, April 23 to December 23, the total cargo handled stood at 77.2 million pounds. This is impressive, and 17% growth year on year. Our third -party cargo grew by 37% year on – to 28.8 million tons, and the share of third -party increased to 37% in the overall cargo mix from 32% a year ago for the same – similar reference period.

This is in line with our strategy to grow third -party business to 40% in the near term. Total revenue for the nine months ended December 23 stood at INR2,832 crores , reflecting a growth similar to our volume to 18% year on year, while EBITDA for the period stood at INR1,549 crores , which is 22% growth year on year basis. I'm happy to state that JSW Infrastructure emerged as the winning bidder for the development of an all -weather deepwater greenfield port at Kenney in the state of Karnataka on public -private partnership basis.

The Karnataka Maritime Board – the government of Karnataka has issued a letter of award to JSW Infrastructure, further to which the concession agreement has been signed with Karnataka Maritime Board. The estimated cost of the project is INR4,119 crores , with the initial capacity of 30 million ton per annum. With a strong balance sheet in the sector, we are well-positioned to pursue organic and inorganic growth opportunities.

During the quarter, we acquired majority shareholding of PNP Maritime Services, PNP Port, an operating port company located in Raigad district of Maharashtra on the Amba River, which is about 20 nautical miles from Mumbai Anchorage. The port has a current capacity of 5 million ton per annum, and the potential to expand to 19 million ton per annum. Purchase consideration was INR270 crores for 50% plus one share of paid -up capital of the PNP Port.

We have also successfully completed the previously announced acquisition of a liquid storage terminal of 465,000 cubic meters, capacity of 5 million ton per annum, at the port of Fujairah in United Arab Emirates. With the ongoing capacity increases and acquisition, the total cargo handling capacity now stands at 170 million tons per annum, from 158.4 million ton per annum stated earlier .

As such, JSW Infrastructure Limited is uniquely positioned to capitalize on India's growth opportunity with a strong balance sheet and ambitious growth targets. With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take over the financials and other details for the time period. Thank you.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Arun, and good evening, everyone. Moving on to our quarterly financial results, in Q3 FY24, the company handled cargo volumes of 28.1 million tons as compared to 24 million tons in the quarter ended December 22. This 17% cargo growth is mainly driven by Paradip I&O Terminal reflecting 91% Y -on-Y growth.

Paradip Coal Terminal delivered a cargo growth of 30% in the current quarter. Similarly, cargo at Mangalore Coal grew by 49% year -on-year. Also, the Mangalore Container Terminal volumes grew by 33 %.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 4 of 13

The increase at Paradip and Mangalore locations has significantly contributed to an increase in third -party cargo of 47 % in the current quarter on an overall basis. The third -party cargo has increased to 10.9 million tons from 7.4 million tons. The growth in cargo volume resulted in an increase in operational revenue for the quarter from INR940 crores to INR798 crores year -on-year growth of 18 %.

Other income for the current quarter is INR78 crores against INR44 crores in December '22, mainly driven by an increase in income from fixed deposits and gain on mutual funds. EBITDA for the quarter ended December '23 was at INR558 crores, up from INR421 crores in the quarter ended December '22, an increase of 33 %.

Strong EBITDA growth was mainly on the increased revenue, operating lev

erage on account of

higher capacity utilization of 68 % versus 60 % last year, and cost control. All these drivers contributed to EBITDA margin of 54.8 % in the current quarter as compared to 49.9 % in the same period last year.

Depreciation was INR108 crores and finance cost was INR67 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR102 crores and INR72 crores respectively in the quarter ended December '22. As for the current quarter is at INR254 crores, as against INR116 crores for the quarter ended December '23, representing an increase of 118 % on a year-on-year basis.

Increase in PAT is a reflection of increased total income, efficient operations resulting in lower operating expenses and lower finance costs. As of December 23, our net debt is INR639 crores. Also, I will take a moment to reiterate the usage of IPO proceeds. So, out of total funds of INR2,800 crores, approximately INR880 crores was meant for debt repayment, which has been completed in the current quarter. Also, funds available towards general corporate purpose of INR666 crores has been fully utilized in the acquisition of PNP and marine oil terminal at Fujairah.

Balance of INR1,188 crores is for capex, mainly for the two [inaudible] LPG project at Jaigarh port and expansion of Mangalore Container Terminal. Both are progressing well and are expected to be completed by January '26 and February '25, respectively, as emphasized in the prospectus. We have received additional EC approval for additional 1.6 million tons at Ennore Coal Terminal, which means total capacity now stands at 9.6 million tons from 8 million tons. As highlighted earlier by Arun, during the quarter, we have completed acquisition of liquid storage terminal at Fujairah and acquired a majority stake in PNP port. The revenue and EBITDA of both these assets have been accounted. Given the closure of both acquisitions happened towards the end of December '23, a meaningful contribution will be seen from quarter 4 and beyond.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 5 of 13

Priyanka Biswas: Hi. Thanks for the opportunity, gentlemen. My first question is regarding, I would want some more details like how do you intend to expand your third-party volumes, let's say in the region around Jaigarh and Dharamtar, because what I understand the strategic rationale for acquiring PNP is actually to increase the third-party volumes. So, are we planning something like moving into an integrated logistics or that sort of a thing to capture more third-party? So, that's the first question.

Arun Maheshwari: Okay. Thank you, Mr. Biswas, for asking this question. Of course, definitely there is a rationale behind acquiring PNP to increase the third-party volumes. If you see the [inaudible] of Jaigarh Port, and Jaigarh Port along with PNP makes a very decent combination to increase the volume to new heights. Now, if I have to look at Jaigarh Port, which was largely getting limited by virtue of railway connectivity being a little far off, PNP Port has a railway connection right at the port. So, this gives a very, very good synergy impact for increasing the volume.

And this is just about 120 nautical miles away from Jaigarh Port. And there's a robust infrastructure already being utilized for this channel on the marine side. So, we intend to utilize that and enhance the utilization of PNP Port as well as Jaigarh Port by increasing the volume and making a hub-and-spoke model, which has been our strength right from day one.

On top of it, if I have to look at it, the railway connectivity, which is there at the PNP Port, and the government trust on RSR, Rail-Sea-Rail route of mo

vement of cargo, definitely gives an

impetus for us to do more and more, explore more and more such opportunities, which gives -- already we have been doing some cargo through PNP Port, through RSR route.

Now, with this in our fold, we will definitely make an attempt to utilize it to maximize. Though the capacity is stated as 5 million tons for PNP Port, but the clearances are available for 19 million tons. And definitely, once we have the business case, we will go ahead with up to 19 million tons we can handle the cargo there.

And Jaigarh Port has a capacity available for the capex's are done. So, without doing much of capex at Jaigarh Port, we can handle more cargo there. And PNP has the EC available, so we can utilize those assets. So, in this part of the world, if you have to look at it in parts of India, there's hardly any deep-sea port and with this combination of hub and spoke model, there are no other ports available.

So, this will definitely be a great idea to start this business over here now.

Priyanka Biswas: So, since this is going to be third-party model, sorry, third-party cargo, so would it be fair to say that this would be more like a liquids or a container-oriented port? Like, what is your thoughts on that?

Arun Maheshwari: It will be a combination of everything. We are not limiting ourselves only to one particular commodity or product. So, definitely, that is in our horizon to make it ICD -CFS kind of structure because there's a sea available, there's a rail available, there's a road available, and it's very close to JNPT and Mumbai Port.
JSW Infrastructure Limited
February 02, 2024

Page 6 of 13

So, definitely, it makes sense for us to make it as an ICD -CFS kind of model as well, in addition to the hub and spoke model, what I spoke earlier. And also, liquid terminals are in great demand in and around Mumbai. So, probably, this could be an opportunity for us to develop that as well. So, we have been working on multiple products now, as of now, since it has come to our fold just about a month back. So, we have been working on a variety of models, which we had worked on prior to takeover. And now, we'll fast-track this, and we'll come back to you all, giving the details of what all we are doing in this area.

Priyanka Biswas: Sorry, if I just can squeeze just one question more. So, regarding the coastal coal movements, so, we have been doing quite good volumes at Paradip Port of late. So, what we understand that even competitor Dhamra is also reporting some good growth in volumes. So, can you please explain that, what sort of coastal coal volume trajectory we should be looking at specifically for Paradip, let's say, over the next two, three years? That's my last question.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, good that you asked us this question. As I said earlier in our earlier calls, last quarter and before that, in other investors' meet, coal, there has been no major coal thermal power plant came into India in the last couple of years, which needs a coastal cargo movement. Still, the coastal cargo volumes are growing up tremendously, because there has been a shortage of coal movement.

Indian coal is preferred, because it's cheap. And, of course, even Indian government's target is that to reduce import of coal. And they have been promoting coastal coal movement. Coastal movement has been encouraged. And RSR is part of that route. This terminal, which we have started in Paradip Port, which is the single largest coal export terminal, one of the most modern, 30 million ton.

This is the third year of operation, and we are running almost 60%, 70% of the capacity, 60% of the capacity as of now. Which is a testimonial that, you know, there was so much of facility shortage within India, or infrastructure shortage within India. This has come as a boon to many of the users.

Dhamra, Paradip themselves are, Paradip Port government is running the

terminal port. Our terminal is

there. Gopalpur is there. So, there are several other ports in and around. But, Paradip being one of the closest to the MCL, Talcher mines, definitely becomes the first choice of preference for the customers.

However, I see that this cargo growing up, looking at the demand which is there of power within India, there is no regular substitute of thermal as of now. Of course, there's a lot of thrust on renewables and all. But if I have to look at RTC power and the peak power demand, coal thermal is still a place of preference. And the demands are growing.

The PLFs are increasing for those units. And the power plants which were not running fully, started running now. So, the national demand is there without much of investment in the power plants as of now.

JSW Infrastructure Limited
February 02, 2024

Page 7 of 13

Priyanka Biswas: So, should we be looking at a capacity, by when should we be looking at a capacity utilization, say 80% -90% for this asset?

Arun Maheshwari: It is difficult for me to give a number on to that. But then looking at the trajectory, the way it has been increasing and the way the demand is likely to go up and the government is pushing for RSR. In the first year, we operated at 40%. Second year, we are operating at 60%. I think in another two to three years' time, we should be somewhere around 70% to 80% for sure.

Priyanka Biswas: Thank you so much, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, thank you. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. And the next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Yes, good afternoon, everyone. Sir, I just wanted to check on the acquisitions for the two, three bids we were talking about in the last quarter. Is there any update on to that? And is there any increase in terms of the pipeline, if you could help us understand the current status as well?

Arun Maheshwari: I think we had given for PNP and we had given for...

Lalit Singhvi: You are talking about the privatization of the three bids, what you are saying?

Achal Lohade: Yes, sir. Yes.

Lalit Singhvi: Okay.

Arun Maheshwari: So, no, we are still awaiting as we are also as eager as what you are. We are still awaiting because it's a procedure at the government. Though it has taken a little longer time, it is almost seven, eight months now. There are a lot of clearances required within the system at the government end, which they have to clear. So, the bids, all the bidders are still waiting for the outcome of those bids. And hopefully, what we understand unofficially is that probably within a month or so, one or two bids should be out and open and we will know the results about it. But as of now, we are also waiting as what you are.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And if there is any further new pipeline being created with respect to the privatization, any new opportunities?

Arun Maheshwari: There are further opportunities which we continue to assess. But as of now, nothing much, nothing we have bid it so far. But then we keep exploring that. So, we are into assessment stages today.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And one more question pertaining to, again, the Greenfield with respect to the Eastern Integrated Facility at Jatadhar. Any update on the same, sir?

Arun Maheshwari: So, all the approvals, ECFC, everything has been done now. Day before yesterday also we got the final clearances. Hopefully, in all fairness, what we understand is that the concession agreement should be signed within the next four weeks or so. So, in all fairness, we see it's

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 8 of 13

happening within this financial year, everything. On the document side. Thereafter, we'll start on the project.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Just to recap, so basically, the concession agreement will be novated to us immediately after this initial signing, right? And then we

'll start the work on the project.

Arun Maheshwari: That's right.

Achal Lohade: Great, sir. I'll come back for the follow-up. Thank you so much.

Arun Maheshwari: Sure. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. And the next question is from the line of Noel from Union Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Noel: Yes. Thank you for the opportunity. So, just wanted to get a sense of, is the company looking at inorganic opportunities for growth that kind of fall within the same logistics space, but not necessarily within the space of, say, ports or terminals for that matter? I just wanted to get some idea. And if the company were to go in that direction, what would be the criteria under which you would go in that direction? Yeah, that is also my question.

Arun Maheshwari: So, anything which is value accrued to port businesses or otherwise, not necessarily only port businesses, but then which is largely to do with the infrastructure of the growing economy, largely to do with the logistics sector or efficiencies or whether it is railways or pipelines or roads or CFS, ICDs, anything. But it has to be value accretive to, it should be scalable, and it should be independent. So, these are a few of the criteria which we have at tick marks. If that is going on, and if our IRRs are decent enough, and it is adding to value to our existing supply chain businesses, then it is definitely a go for us.

Noel: Yes. Thank you. Thank you so much.

Arun Maheshwari: Sure. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Parash Jain from HSBC. Please go ahead, sir.

Parash Jain: Thank you. Congratulations on a great set of results. If I may have two questions. Maybe first maintenance question. The sequential yield deterioration, at least on the back of the envelope calculation, is it more to do with the mix change or there are some discounts which occur in one quarter versus the other?

And my second question is, can you give us a timeline of your capex outlay for the Keni project, how the INR4,000 crores will be spread over the next several quarters and years? And with that regard, what sort of capital structure will you be comfortable going forward given how strong your balance sheet is at the moment? Thank you.

Arun Maheshwari: So, on the second part, I'll ask, answer first. On the capital outlay side, we'll, keep on meeting our guidelines, whatever we have, maintain internal guidelines of the debt equity ratio or the other key ratios because the balance sheet is strong enough, robust enough to take any of the

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 9 of 13

capex is for now. But we would not like to deviate from our overall guidance internally on the ratios. So, that is one very key area for us. There's enough, good enough opportunities available for us to do that.

Now, coming to your first question, which I would request Mr. Lalit Singhvi to respond because the question itself was not very clear for us. So, if you can just repeat that question.

Lalit Singhvi: Yeah, we would like you to repeat that you said sequentially we are somewhere down. I would like to, know from which number you are referring to?

Parash Jain: I was looking at your quarter -on-quarter revenue and the quarter -on-quarter volume. And on a blended basis, it shows a bit of yield erosion? It could be.

Lalit Singhvi: Quarter -on-quarter revenue, Q3 over Q2, our growth is 19% in terms of cargo. And in terms of total revenue, it is 14% growth. And EBITDA is 12% growth.

Parash Jain: So, the revenue growing slower than a volume implies a yield dilution, right? What is driving that? Is it a mix? Is it seasonality wise mix?

Lalit Singhvi: It's purely a mix. It's purely a mix.

Parash Jain: It's a mix.

Lalit Singhvi: Yeah. Because at certain terminals, your revenue per ton is much lower. And, in the second quarter, the revenue of Jaigarh and Dharamtar were higher. Ther

e we have higher revenues. And

this time, our Mangalore and other terminals were there. So, it's like that. Yeah.

Parash Jain: And on my first question, if you agree with Arun. Arun, I was not worried about probably you crossing your debt limit on the other side, you just have a too strong balance sheet. And in an absence of any big ticket opportunities around the corner, would you pay this back to the shareholders in some shape or form?

Arun Maheshwari: No, not really. So, see, there are enough opportunities available. As we said earlier, you know, Keni is about INR4,000 crores project. If we have to come up with timeline, that is another close to about INR3,000 crores that we have to assess and get the board approval. But INR7,000 crores over there, then these three terminals what we have bidden for, we don't know how much we'll get. If we get all the three, then there's a capital outlay for that as well.

Then we keep continuing to increase our Jaigarh and Dharamtar capacities. That would be another. And we have to keep certain cash for any, low hanging acquisition opportunities coming in our way. So I think we would be more interested in redeploying the funds into the growth of the company. That would be making a much robust sense for all the stakeholders.

Parash Jain: So, no, dividend for fair at least, no dividend guidance.

Arun Maheshwari: No, nothing as of now, nothing has been approved by the board as well.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 10 of 13

Parash Jain: And just one last thing, INR4,100 crores of capex. Do we know, like in timeline, will it be spent over FY25 -FY26?

Arun Maheshwari: Well, once we have applied for the approvals of ECA and MOEF and other stuff, once we get that, then in three years, three to four years' time, it will get deployed.

Parash Jain: Okay, lovely. Thank you so much and have a wonderful rest of the day.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. And the next question is from the line of Aditya from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead, sir.

Aditya: Good afternoon, team, and thank you for the opportunity and congratulations for a very strong set of results. I'll just move on with my questions. The first one relates to the uptick in volumes seen in Paradip from an iron ore perspective. I wanted to double-check whether these volumes are coming in from an uptick in coastal shipping or are these exports to outside countries that is leading to the uptick?

Arun Maheshwari: No, these volumes are largely for exports. See, basically, coastal volume has been done by JSW as well as a few other players within India, AMNS, JSW, and a few players in Kandla and Karnataka. Otherwise, everything is exports. So in our case, it is largely exports. 80% of the volumes are exports.

Aditya: Understood. The related question over here was that I think if I see your presentation correctly, you've already crossed 9 million tons in the nine months at this port, whereas the capacity switch is about 10 million. So is there potential to do beyond 10 million in a single year? How should we think about it on a full-year basis and go from here on?

Arun Maheshwari: A very relevant question. See, in Paradip, there's a global environment approval at the Paradip port level. And this terminal capacity is about 18 million tons as a design. So the concession agreement is about 10 million tons. But even if we do more, then there are global capacities available in terms of environment approval. So far as the revenue sharing is there, we don't see any challenges coming in. So definitely, we see a case in this year at least that it will be crossing 10 million tons.

Aditya: So is it fair to assume that since you have the physical infrastructure, you can reach 18 million tons in the next few years? Can you double up from where you are today?

Arun Maheshwari: Well, 18 million is the capacity. So probably in

a port, generally, it's about 70%, 75%, 80% type of utilization of the capacities. So we can assume that 14 million, 15 million tons could be a possibility if the market remains as strong as what it's today.

Aditya: Understood. The second question that I had was just to get a better sense about 4Q of last year, which if the run rates are huge, kind of spike up in terms of revenues on a Q-on-Q basis. Is there some seasonality associated with 4Q, which plays every year out? Or was last year's 4Q something specific?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 11 of 13

Arun Maheshwari: Q4 is generally the strongest quarter for us. But then Lalit, if you can add some more to it.

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, so every time if you can see that Q4 is always higher than Q3 and H2 is always higher than H1. So Q4, you will expect that it will be higher, largely because take or pay triggers in the fourth quarter. So by the end of the year, only they are built. So certain take or pay agreements, we are sure to get the revenue built in the fourth quarter. So that will definitely, you know, Q4 will definitely be better.

Aditya: Understood. Just a last question from my side. Of the two assets that you acquired, you said that the full quarter contribution happens from the fourth quarter. Can you quantify a number over here for the revenue EBITDA...

Lalit Singhvi: Number it's difficult to say, but you can see that the PNP and these assets were just acquired like 26th December or maybe 20th December. The full quarter number EBITDA, we perceive it should be in excess of INR50 crores. So that would get built in the fourth quarter.

Aditya: And just finally, you can see, while third party volumes have done fantastically well for us, congratulations for that. The group volumes have kind of broadly been flat on a Y-o-Y basis in the third quarter. Anything to read into that or is it just a quarterly issue and gets sorted out incrementally?

Arun Maheshwari: No, regarding the group volume it depends on, what are the capacities adding near to our ports. So it comes into a spur, like if JSW Steel or JSW Cement, others are getting into capacity expansions, which are closer to our ports. Definitely you see a spur in the volume and which we see happening because all these companies are growing at a very, very quick speed. So those volumes will keep triggering in. If you remember our earlier calls when we were speaking about it, we don't look at the quarter-on-quarter, what is the share of third party or captive. We look on a longer horizon. Probably we will reach 40% within next quarter. It could be a possibility of the third party. But if I could look at a longer horizon for three, five, seven years, then it would remain 60-40 ratio, 60 in terms of captive and 40 in terms of third party. Our endeavour would be to make it 50-50, which we are striving for. But then largely on a longer horizon, it looks like 60-40. At times when the new capacity comes up for the captive cargo, those will jump up. And thereafter, again, the third party will start growing up, taking their share and all this stuff.

Aditya: Maybe I'll just rephrase my question. What I was asking was that if I just consider the group revenues or group volumes that are coming to JSW Infra, do you see in them any kind of [yachts], the way it has been seen in the third quarter? Or do you see levers and drivers to ensure that the growth continues in that part of the portfolio, independent of whatever happens in third party?

Lalit Singhvi: The group volumes will remain almost similar. Because, you know, once the steel capacity is increased, then they get increased. Otherwise, the level almost remains the same.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 12 of 13

Third party definitely is growing. You can see that Q3 also has grown and Q4 also will continue to grow. So once their capacity increases

es, steel is working on various capacity expansion plans, then only it gets added. Otherwise, it remains almost in a similar fashion.

Aditya: I got that clarified. Thanks a lot and all the very best. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We would like to remind participants that you may press star and 1 to ask questions. The next question is from the line of Nikhil Abhyankar from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead, sir.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Thank you, sir. Thanks for the opportunity and congrats on a good set of numbers. My first question is basically for clarification.

You mentioned that there is a railway line at the PNP port that you have recently acquired. So how exactly will it help our Jaigarh volumes?

Arun Maheshwari: So basically, you know, whenever the bulk cargo, suppose if there is an RSR route through the coal movement, which is directed by the government of Jaigarh, we have a terminal at [Parazheh] which handles coals and which has a good capacity available. And the coal mines are very, this is one of the closest terminals for the coal mines.

So if any cargo is required within Maharashtra or within central part of India or within North Karnataka, and if it has to be routed through rail, then definitely Jaigarh being not having rail connectivity as of now, they can bring the cargo over there.

From there, it is transhipped to the smaller ships coming into PNP. And thereafter, it is transported through rail to these locations, which is happening in one of the cases as of now. But it can be scaled up with this, with this support within our fold now. Similarly, we can, we can also export other products, which otherwise were not happening through Jaigarh port. Now with PNP, with the railway connectivity, which we can do now.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Okay, understood. The next question is regarding Kenny. So what exactly is, how much do we have to pay as revenue share to the government? And the second, what is usually the debt to equity ratio for these capexes?

Arun Maheshwari: So there is a, there is a scale of rate of forfeiture of Kenny, which is, which is close to about INR17. Yeah, close to about INR17 per ton revenue share. And this is a 30 year contract, 30 year lease period with the auto extension of another 30 years. But then this would be triggered once we start the operations.

Nikhil Abhyankar: Okay. Okay, understood. And so regarding the three bids that were put in, I understand we have got a lot of cash right now on our books. But if we win all the three, how do we expect to fund it?

Arun Maheshwari: No, no. See, depending on which of the condition, which of the bidding we win, and the model would be largely 30 -70, 30 equity and 70 debt. So as we win, we will decide, you know, what is the shareholding or what is the, you know, financing model we have to keep.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

February 02, 2024

Page 13 of 13

Noel: Okay, understood. That's all from my side. Thank you.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, everyone. Thank you for having a good interactive session and looking forward to more such interaction and all the best. Thank you.

Moderator: On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2024

Page 1 of 9

"JSW Infrastructure Limited
Q4 FY '24 Earnings Conference Call"
May 03, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN MAHESHWARI – JOINT MANAGING
DIRECTOR AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER – JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – WHOLE -TIME DIRECTOR AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
LIMITED
MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD INVESTOR
RELATIONS – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
May 03, 2024

Page 2 of 9

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I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Manav. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q4 FY '24 Earnings Call of JSW Infrastructure. To discuss the results today, we have with us Mr. Arun Maheshwari, Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole Time Director and CFO, and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head, Investor Relations. We'll start with a brief opening remarks by the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Mohit, and good evening and thank you all for joining our Earnings Call for the quarter and the year ending March 31, '24. I'm Arun Maheshwari. India's economy continues to perform better than most major economies due to strong domestic demand, momentum in manufacturing, and ongoing investments in infrastructure.

The Indian government is taking major steps to make the logistics sector more effective and efficient. Central and state governments are working in tandem to increase the country's total port handling capacity to 10,000 million tons by 2047, from the current capacity of 2,600 million tons per annum. In alignment with the vision, the role of private players is being progressively augmented with public -private partnership terminals.

Major ports in India, which are central government -owned, have a total capacity above 50% of India's port capacity today, and a significant portion of it is yet to be privatized. This offers a huge opportunity for a business enterprise like ours to leverage our growth of our businesses. Moving on to the performance of JSW Infrastructure Limited for the financial year 2024, the year has been a year of milestones and delivering on our promises. Most successful equity listing in October '23, we have acquired a liquid storage terminal at Fujairah in the United Arab

Emirates, and acquired a majority stake in PNP port, which is opposite to our Dharam tar port in the state of Maharashtra. On the development of Greenfield port, a concession agreement has been signed with Karnataka Medicine Board to develop a 30 million ton all -weat

her multi -cargo
JSW Infrastructure Limited
May 03 , 202 4

Page 3 of 9

deepwater commercial port in a location called Keni, which is south of Karwar in north Karnataka.

We emerged as a winner bid for 7 million ton per annum of drivable terminal in Tuticorin as well, through a PPP mode, and signed a concession agreement with Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authorities for the two liquid bursts for 4.5 million ton during the last quarter. For the period April '23 to March '24, the total cargo handled stood at 106 million tons, which is 15% year -on-year growth. Our third party grew by 36% year -on-year to 42 million tons, and the share of third party increased to 40% in the overall mix of 33% a year ago. Total revenue for the year stood at INR4,032 crores, reflecting a growth of 20% year -on-year.

EBITDA for the period stood at INR2,234 crores . This is 2 4% year -on-year growth, and the net profit grew by 55% to INR1,161 crores. The board has recommended a dividend of INR0. 55 paise per share, that's INR0.55 per share. Given the strong fundamentals of the sector, and in line with our strategy to deliver growth, we have embarked on a 2030 growth plan aimed to enhancing our present cargo handling capacity by 2.4 x, from existing 170 million tons to 400 million tons by 2030. This represents a CAGR of 15%. We are actively pursuing and exploring various project development opportunities, and already have a robust project pipeline in hand. Moreover, there are additional levers to accelerate the growth, like the privatization bids of terminals to births in the government -owned major ports, an enormous opportunity. We are one of the largest terminal holders in India in the major ports. Further, we will keep on exploring value -added inorganic opportunities in the areas of port and related infrastructures.

The detailed 2030 roadmap is also available on page 14 of our presentation, which has been uploaded on stock exchanges. With a strong balance sheet in the sector, we are well -positioned to pursue organic and inorganic growth opportunities. With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take through the financials and other details for the time period we are talking about.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Arun. And good evening, everyone. Let me first give you a sense of our quarterly performance first, and then talk about the full year. In Q4 FY '24, company handled cargo volumes of 29.3 million tons, as compared to 26.8 million tons in the quarter ended March '23. This 9% cargo growth is mainly driven by Paradip coal terminal and Ennore coal terminal, which grew by 26% and 18% respectively. Newly acquired assets, PNP and liquid terminal at UAE also contributed to the growth.

The increase at Paradip and Ennore locations and acquisitions has significantly contributed to an increase in third -party cargo of 35% in the current quarter on an overall basis. Third -party cargo has increased to 30.5 million tons from 10 million tons in the previous period. The growth in cargo volume resulted in an increase in operational revenue for the quarter from INR915 crores to INR1,096 crores year -on-year growth of 20%.

Other income for the quarter is INR104 crores, as against INR58 crores in March '23, mainly driven by an increased income from fixed deposits and gains of mutual funds. EBITDA for quarter ended March '24 was at INR685 crores, up from INR530 crores in quarter ended March '23, an increase of 29%. Strong EBITDA growth was mainly on increased revenue.

JSW Infrastructure Limited
May 03 , 202 4

Page 4 of 9

Depreciation was INR134 crores and finance cost was INR75 crores in the current quarter, as compared to INR98 crores and INR70 crores respectively in the quarter ended March '23. Profit before tax stood at INR417 crores, a 41% increase year -on-year. Tax for the current quarter is INR329 crores, as compared to INR302 crores for the quarter ended March '23, rep

resenting an
increase of 9%.

Moving on to the full year results. During the year, company handled cargo volumes at 106 million tons, which is higher by 15% over the last year. Increase in volume is primarily on the back of increased capacity utilization at the iron ore and coal terminals of Paradip and Mangalore coal terminals.

Newly acquired assets that is PNP and liquid terminal UAE, also contributed to this growth. The third -party cargo volume increased grew by 36% year -on-year, and the share of third -party in

the overall volume stood at 40% versus 33% a year ago. The higher volume translated to 18% growth in the operating revenue, which stood at INR3,763 crores. Increased revenue, the benefit of operating leverage and cost control meant EBITDA of INR2,234 crores, which is a 24% year-on-year, with a strong margin of 55.4%. Depreciation was INR436 crores and finance loss was INR289 crores during the year, as compared to INR391 crores and INR282 crores respectively in the financial year.

PAT grew at 55% to INR1,161 crores. As of March '24, our net debt is just INR65 crores, so practically zero net debt and one of the strongest balance sheets in the sector. This, coupled with steadily increasing annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well-equipped to pursue a growth plan aimed at enhancing our present cargo handling capacity to 400 million tons by FY 2030 or earlier. With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions.

Moderator: We have our first question from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Priyanka Biswas: Sir, congratulations for strong results today. So, my first question to you is, can you shed some light on what sort of capex given the growth pipeline that you see we should be looking at for, let's say next 3 years to 4 years? And what is the, let's say, target ROCE for such capex? And additionally, on top of that like if you can also elaborate let's say growth opportunities like Murbe Port and the volume aspirations at Tuticorin?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So, as regards to capex pipeline as we mentioned in the investor presentation that we are going to be 400 million companies by 2030. This is base cargo and on top of it there will be some acquisitions or privatization programs, etc.

So, as regards to capex, on the base up to 400 million we are expecting around INR30,000 crores of investment in next 6 years from 2024 -2025 to 2030. So, if you look at - if you want to have a 3-year horizon it would be around say INR14,000 crores, and the second 3 years it would be INR16,000 crores. This is what we are tentatively committing to capex for this period.

Arun Maheshwari: So, Mr. Biswas, regarding your question regarding Murbe and Tuticorin, I'll take Tuticorin first wherein we have been a declared winner for the bid we had submitted. The concession agreement is in the framing stage as of now and we'll update the market as and when it gets signed. So, this is an update on the Tuticorin side.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

May 03, 2024

Page 5 of 9

On Murbe it is a Swiss challenge which we had submitted and we are waiting for the further directions from the authorities on this subject. So, as and when we get any further thing to hear about it, we'll let all of us know.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay, sir. Sir, one more question. So, typically, there would be some ESOP effect in the employee expenses? So, what would be that for the full year in FY24 and should we see that in FY25 as well?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So, in the 23-24, the provisioning was around INR148 crores and now 24-25 it will be much less. It will be around INR65 to INR70 crores.

Priyanka Biswas: Thank you, sir. I will get back into the queue.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We have our next question from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Yes. Again, as I was saying

g, congratulations on a great result. There are a couple of questions that I had on the capex side. What was the capex for the current year and then how are we proceeding in the next 2 years to 3 years to come? That is number one.

And two is at Tuticorin, what are we expecting in terms of potential capacity addition in the next couple of years?

Lalit Singhvi: We spent around INR150 crores on a sustainable capex and around INR75 crores on the regular capex. You are looking at a capex number because your voice was not very clear

Arun Maheshwari: So, Nidhi, the total capex including sustainable capex was close to about INR225 crores in FY24. And as we had mentioned in the previous call, that the total capex expected in another 3 years would be close to INR14,000 crores. And the capacity addition, if I have to look at in commensurate with that, in the next three years, would be close to about... 85 million.

Nidhi Shah: Okay. Lastly, if I could ask you about what you think are the opportunities that we could foresee in the upcoming years?

Arun Maheshwari: Well, see, the government is very clear that they would like to go more and more privatization. So, there are many opportunities keep coming up. There are opportunities in multiple major ports coming in.

So, we exactly won't be able to comment how many opportunities would come in. But there are continuously opportunities out there, whether it's Kandla, whether it's Haldia, whether it's Vizag or Tuticorin. So, we keep assessing those opportunities. And as and when it fits into our overall strategy and the growth plans, we do consider them for bidding.

Nidhi Shah: Okay, all right. Thank you so much.
Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.
JSW Infrastructure Limited
May 03 , 202 4

Page 6 of 9

Moderator: Thank you. We have our next question from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal Financial Services. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora: Good evening, sir, and congratulations on very good numbers. So, sir, just first on the volume, we have done pretty decent volumes in this quarter and full year. So, what is the outlook there for the next couple of years on the volume growth, assuming that we are at this capacity and some capacity additions will also happen? So, what's the growth we are looking at as far as tonnage is concerned?

Arun Maheshwari: So, generally, the growth, as the base grows up, the percentage will be tapered down to that extent. But I would fairly assume 10 % to 12 % kind of volume percentage growth should be there. Our CAGR, because it's a big infrastructure company, it's a very long horizon.

So, year -on-year growth would be a bit of a misnomer, if I have to look at it that way. If a long -term sustainable, if I were to look at it, it would be around 15 %-17% kind of CAGR. But year -on-year, if I were to talk about immediate next year, probably the guidance would be 10 % to 12% of growth in terms of volume.

Alok Deora: Got it, sir. And, sir, we are talking about a pretty massive jump in capacity over the next five years or so. It's almost more than doubling capacity. So, it's a related question to the previous question which came through. Are those kind of projects which are upcoming? Or how is the situation? Because it's like 170

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, we have the management line disconnected. Please stay connected while we reconnect them. Thank you for patiently waiting. We have the management line back with us.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes. So, Mr. Deora, you were asking about what kind of projects, pipeline and . So, we have given those details on the page 14 of the presentation which is uploaded . So, primarily, just for the sake of clarity to the group over here, for the growth of about 85 to 88 million tons in another three to four years' time is largely coming from a variety of projects which were declared. And which are approved projects for us. So, that is what we have m

entioned over here.

And thereafter, we have taken the K eni project which is the concession agreement is signed. That we have taken after post three years because that the gestation period is a little longer. And there are several other projects which are in pipeline, potential projects, which we'll keep on updating as and when we move towards that. Forming of those projects in the approved line. So, the details of the projects are already mentioned in that presentation.

Alok Deora: Got it, sir. And just a last question from my side. So, are we also looking to, you know, from a longer term perspective since we have so much funds also available. Are we looking to increase or increase logistics activity in the sense that setting up a logistics vertical in a bigger way where we can provide end -to-end services? Any color on that?

Arun Maheshwari: So, we have been maintaining this, you know, stand that we would be developing our portfolio not only in port but also the retail infrastructure. Which is value -accredited to the port business as well. So, last mile connectivity getting into the logistics play is part of that. So, we are

JSW Infrastructure Limited

May 03 , 202 4

Page 7 of 9

definitely considering that to be in that sector. And we are working on this sector very closely.

If anything comes up, definitely we'll update the market.

Alok Deora: Sure, that's all from my side. Thank you and all the best, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. We have our next question from the line of Ravi Naredi from Naredi Investments. Please go ahead. Mr. Ravi, are you there? Hello, Mr. Ravi, are you there?

Arun Maheshwari: Operator, let's move on.

Moderator: As is. We have our next question from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: Congratulations on a decent set of results this time and thank you for the opportunity. My first question related more to the 10% to 12% growth guidance that you've given, which basically translates into about 11 million to 13 million tons additional growth for next year. Just want to kind of get things in some perspective.

Our sense is that about 2 million, 2.5 million tons would have happened because of PNP and Fujairah in the last quarter. Between 7.5 million tons of growth happened just from that. It

seemed as if the guidance was kind of single digit for the remaining ports. Could you give us a sense of what is the split of this growth across your third party cargo ports and the other mature assets on an organic basis?

Arun Maheshwari: So if you look at the group company cargo grows as and when there's a growth in the capacity in the group company. And that's where the, and these are lumpy growth. These are not very every year there is no growth.

So there's a continuous growth on a scale of 5 to 10 years kind of scale. But where in the third party is a continuous growth momentum. If you have to, if you have to notice for the last four or five years what we have done. So the third party business continued to grow. Like we were 33% last year. We are 40% this year. We may try to improve from 40% from this year onwards. So probably we would like to aim closer to 45%. As we move forward, we will be there at around 45% by the next year end.

Coming to that what would be the incremental growth on this particular thing? I would say the group company cargo would remain where it was. It won't be increasing much because that is a lumpy growth. As and when the capacity improves in the captive cargo, then only it increases. So that is in works. Probably it will shape up next to next year. Where in third party business will continue to grow. So any infrastructure, if you have to look at, you have to look at, as I said earlier, it has to be looked on a time horizon. It cannot be looked at year on year basis. So we continue to maintain that. Though it is 10% to 12% for

next year guidance. On a sustainable basis, it would be around 15% to 17% CAGR.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

May 03, 2024

Page 8 of 9

Aditya Mongia: Understood. The second thing I just want to kind of clarify. How much is the ESOP cost provisioning for the quarter gone by?

Arun Maheshwari: What cost? Sorry?

Aditya Mongia: The ESOP cost provisioning for the quarter gone by. Have you given the numbers for this year? But if you could also give a sense of what the fourth quarter number.

Arun Maheshwari: Just a minute. INR34 crores.

Aditya Mongia: 34 crores. And the other question that I had was, given our best sense of assets that we have won in the recent past. Obviously, Fujairah is a high margin asset. But on the other assets, the Tuticorin one and the JNPA one, should one expect a similar kind of EBITDA margin profile as is being seen at a consolidated level right now? Or could there be meaningful differences?

Arun Maheshwari: So, I would say whenever we bid for any terminal, we definitely consider the IRRs before bidding it. So, I'm sure these assets are yet to get operationalized, whether Tuticorin or JNPA.

And as and when we get operationalized, probably you will see the similar kind of outputs from there. So, I'm fairly confident on that.

Aditya Mongia: Great. I have more questions. I'll come back into the queue. Thank you.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We have a follow-up question from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Priyanka Biswas: Sir, thanks for the opportunity. So, my question is we have seen recently commissioning by JSW Steel of, I think, close to another 5 million tons of capacity. So, why shouldn't we be seeing the group cargo going? Because as you were highlighting that as they expand capacity, there should be some lumpy volumes also adding to your mix.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes. So, the thing is that what you are seeing 5 million tons addition is at Vijayanagar Steel Plant. And that is largely catered by the ports of Goa, Ennore, Mangalore and Krishnapatnam. These are the four large major ports which serve them. So, Goa port is in the process of building the capacity. It is under, the shed is under construction.

So, it will take another 9 months to 10 months time for the shed to get completed. So, that volume of this additional 5 million tons will get impacted from there. Otherwise, our two other terminals are largely full. So, we don't have any overflow of cargo cannot be handled over there. So, once we have our Goa port completed in another 10 months time, those volumes will start reflecting over there. From existing 8.5 million tons, we are taking it to 15 million tons.

Priyanka Biswas: So, have we got the EC clearance for that? Because I think that was a hindrance for Goa, right?

Arun Maheshwari: So, we have an approval. All the relevant approvals are there with us. After the shed is approved, then we have to go to the local authority to get the clearance. Otherwise, all the clearance from MoEF is in place.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

May 03, 2024

Page 9 of 9

Priyanka Biswas: Okay. That's very helpful, sir.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, we have the management line disconnected again. We will quickly try now. Ladies and gentlemen, we have the management back with us. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes. Operator, you can take the next question.

Moderator: Okay. Thank you. We have the next question from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia : Thanks for the opportunity. I wanted to kind of check that beyond port operations and logistics operations, are there other means of work that the company is taking to investing? And I recall a previous discussion happening around slurry pipelines. I just thought I'd kind of check with you if any plans are incremental beyond logistics and maybe some sort of

other agencies that

you're looking forward to?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes. So, definitely. Thanks, Aditya, for asking this question. So, being an infrastructure company, anything which adds value to the port businesses or end-to-end logistics solutions definitely would export that. And if a slurry pipeline comes to our forte, we don't mind looking at and exploring that opportunity. Provided it is adding value to my existing businesses or its value to all our stakeholders.

If these two things are there, we are okay. Counterparty has to be with solid because slurry pipeline businesses are such, which are end-to-end. So, your counterparties have to be strong enough. So, we would look at all the aspects in case if we have to get this opportunity, then we would get into that.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. We have a last question for today from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI

Securities. Please go ahead. Ms. Nidhi, please go ahead with your questions. Ms. Nidhi, as we are unable to get through that, as there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar for closing comments. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: I would like to thank the management for giving us the opportunity to host the call. Sir, would you like to make any closing comments?

Arun Maheshwari: We are thankful to all the queries and asking the relevant questions, which really gives more insight about the company and the future and workings of the company. Thank you all and thanks for reposing the continuous confidence in the company and the management.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your line.

Call: Jul 2024

Page 1 of 13

"JSW Infrastructure Q1 FY25 Earnings Conference Call"

July 18, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN MAHESHWARI - JOINT MANAGING
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MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR - ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
July 18, 2024

Page 2 of 13

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to JSW Infrastructure Q1 FY25 Earnings Conference Call hosted by ICICI Securities.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing the "*" then "0" on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference to Mr. Mohit Kumar. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Thank you, Steve. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q1 FY25 Earnings Call of JSW Infrastructure.

To discuss the Results today, we have with us Mr. Arun Maheshwari – Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Lalit Singhvi – Whole-time Director and CFO and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda – Head, Investor Relations.

We will start with brief "Opening Remarks" by the Management which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Mohit. Good evening, everyone and welcome to our Quarterly Earnings Call for the period ending June 30th, 2024.

India's economy remains robust compared to other major economies driven by solid domestic demand, growth in manufacturing and continuous infrastructure investments. Around a month back and a half, India chose a new government with the forward thinking and energetic leadership of our Prime Minister. I believe the ongoing reforms and significant measures to

enhance the logistics sector efficiency and effectiveness will continue. At JSW Infrastructure, we have a clear vision of transforming the company into a complete logistics solution provider delivering cost-effective last-mile connectivity to our customers.

The acquisitions of a majority stake in Navkar Corporation, which owns container freight station, inland container depot in key locations aligns perfectly with our strategy to establish a nationwide network. This is the first step towards that. Additionally, it grants us access to extensive land resources within Mumbai metropolitan region and Gujarat for further JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 3 of 13

development and expansions of these facilities. The enterprise value of this acquisition stands at Rs. 1,644 crores and we expect to consummate the transaction by Quarter 3 of 2025.

I am pleased to share that we have obtained an acceptance letter from the South Railway Division for the construction and operation of Gati Shakti Multimodal Cargo terminal in Arakkonam, Chennai. The terminal has a superb connectivity to railroad and

in close proximity to the port of

Chennai and Ennore. This initiative is in line with the goal of creating a nationwide logistics network to enhance last mile connectivity.

On the "Growth Projects":

Construction of 30-million-ton Keni port is progressing well. The hydrographic and geo-tech studies have been completed. At JNPA liquid berth, pipeline construction and connection work is in full swing.

We have signed a concession agreement on 2nd July with Chidambaram port which is Tuticorin in Tamil Nadu to develop a new 7-million-ton cargo berth and further discussions are underway for equipment specs and ordering. In an effort to combat global warming and climate change, I'm pleased to announce our commitment to curtail our direct greenhouse gas emissions and achieve net neutrality by 2050.

Moving on to the "Operational and Financial Performances" for the period April '24 to June '24, the total cargo handled stood at 27.8 million tons. This is 9% year-on-year growth. Our third-party cargo grew by 48% year-on-year to 13.8 million tons and the share of third party in Quarter 1 of FY 25 increased to 50% in the overall mix cargo from 37% a year ago. Total revenue for quarter stood at Rs. 1104 crores, reflecting a growth of 20% year-on-year. EBITDA for the same period stood at Rs. 609 crores, which is 24% year-on-year growth and net profit stood at Rs. 297 crores.

With this, let me hand it over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take through the Financials and other details. Thank you.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Arun, and good evening everyone.

In Q1 FY25, the company handled cargo volumes of 27.8 million tons as compared to 25.4 million tons in the quarter ended June 23. This 9% cargo growth is mainly driven by the incremental volumes from the newly acquired assets PNP and Liquid Terminal, UAE. Also, the volumes at Paradip Coal and Iron Ore Terminal grew by 50% and 15% respectively. Cargo handled volumes at Dharamtar and Jaigad was impacted by a planned maintenance shutdown at Dolvi steel making facility of the anchor customer.

On a year-on-year comparison, Jaigad and Dharamtar volumes were lower by 1.2 million tons and 1.5 million tons. Third party cargo has increased to 13.8 million tons from 9.3 million tons representing 48% growth and share of third-party volume stood at 50% versus 37% a year ago.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 4 of 13

The growth of volume resulted in an increase in operational revenue for the quarter from Rs. 878 crores to Rs. 1,010 crores, a Y-o-Y growth of 15%. Other income for the current quarter is Rs. 94 crores as against Rs. 40 crores in June 23, mainly driven by increase in income from fixed deposits and gains of mutual funds. EBITDA for the quarter ended June '24 was at Rs. 609 crores from Rs. 491 crores in the quarter ended June 23, an increase of 24%. Strong EBITDA growth was mainly on the increased revenue. Depreciation was Rs. 135 crores and finance cost was Rs. 74 crores in the current quarter as compared to Rs. 95 crores and Rs. 71 crores respectively in the quarter ended June 23. Profit before tax stood at Rs. 392 crores which is lower by 5% year-on-year. It may be worth noting here that in Q1 FY24, finance costs included an unrealized foreign gain of INR 87 crores. If we remove the unrealized gain then PBT growth is 23% year-on-year. Similarly, PAT for the current quarter was lower by 8% at Rs. 297 crores and if we adjust for the unrealized Forex gain of last year, PAT growth is 14%. As of June, '24, we have a net cash of Rs. 195 crores and one of the strongest balance sheet in the sector. This coupled with steadily increasing annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue a growth plan to enhance our present cargo facility capacity to 400 million

tons by FY2030 or earlier .

With this , I request the operator to open the line of ques

tions .

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora: Just couple of questions. First is on the volume side. We 've seen Dharam tar and Jaigad volumes declining on a Y -o-Y basis and one of the reasons you have mentioned in the presentation also Dolvi plant shut down. So, what 's the status there now and could we expect improvement in the second quarter in these ports ?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, the entire shutdown period is over and the plant has been running full since the last 3 to 4 weeks now. So, we don 't see any such kind of reduction in volume in the rest of the year. So, this was the norm which will be coming up though, so this cargo drop is because of that shutdown.

Alok Deora: And also , we have seen a 9% growth in volume that 's primarily driven by the new contribution from the PNP as well as this Liquid terminal in UAE. So, for the full year now , what 's the volume growth we are looking at based on the run rate , the new ports also contributing and also Dharamtar and Jaigad?

Arun Maheshwari: So, we will maintain our guidance what we had mentioned earlier, 10 % to 12% kind of volume growth would be there for the full year full year. This we will be able to achieve that.

Alok Deora: Just one last question, so on Navkar, since we did not have a call after the acquisition, so just if you would spend some time on how we are looking to integrate this with our operations and also the CTO license which they have, how are we planning to use that or just some thoughts on that.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 5 of 13

Arun Maheshwari : Very pertinent question, because this is one of the forays . For any port company, it is important to have a complete last mile connectivity and logistic solution provider. So, we are this is the first step toward that. So, if you see our journey very closely, we have started from a captive cargo company we got from third party businesses then we got to two different product segments. Now these are different service segments which we 're getting into. So, this is the first step towards that, and it is a very strategic location near Mumbai and Gujarat, which has a very high potential business locations and with the kind of assets what they have apart from the strategic locations, they have their own trains, CTO licenses and ICD, CFS and PFT both all three are there . So, it adds value when we start integrating with our existing operations as well as the new opportunities what we get in the way for this. So, our whole vision is that we should become a complete solution provided from the port angle as well as from a distribution and delivery purposes. And this is what we intend to be. Maybe, another couple of years ' time we would like to increase this business more robustly and integrate with our existing other locations.

Alok Deora: So, once this transaction gets completed, how much time it could take for the integration?

Arun Maheshwari: So, this is the first piece of the entire growth journey what we have . So, many such opportunities either by building acquisition or by integrating with other solution providers , this could be a larger game. This is the first piece of that and once we consummate the entire deal by Q3 FY25, then we will start working on to that though we already have a blueprint ready. But I think in the months to come or the quarters to come, you will start seeing the results out of it.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Priyanka Biswas : So, coming to your question about inland logistics that Alok asked specifically on Navkar; can you give us a road map how exactly you plan to grow into Inland logistics because the way I believe is that when you get the Rs.

30,000 crore s CAPEX plan, this probably wasn 't within that. It seems like it is beyond that. So, what sort of CAPEX level can go for us to go into inland logistics? Any pipeline of further acquisitions? And furthermore, it seems that Navkar 's revenues were kind of flattish for a prolonged period. So, what are we going to do to actually bring this asset up ?

Arun Maheshwari: Mr. Biswas, thanks for asking this question. This segment is making sense provided you have some port assets as well as some you have inland logistics, some kind of visibility and the and the vision what you believe in India . The way the economy is growing, the way the kind of consumption centers are growing into the rural India and the entire India , it is not limiting to certain geographies, and this needs a wider network. We have studied the other geographies how they have grown on this particular sector, and we look at the other Indian companies the way they are looking at this sector. It is definitely a very high potential sector and this will be a synergy to the existing port businesses, so it is not that independently we are doing this, it is a well thought out when we are investing so much of pipeline of projects are there for developing the ports or the terminals or the other businesses on the port side that will not be very value

Page 6 of 13

towards that. Now as you said that in Rs. 30,000 crore s pipeline, this was not mentioned . So, we are seeing this as an opportunity which is coming up. It could be a lease model where the CAPEX would be very minuscule. It is not worth mentioning in Rs. 30,000 or any such opportunity which comes up like Navkar, we were we will not be averse to looking at those opportunities. If that happens then you know we can always , because the pipeline is enough ; the balance sheet is strong enough and if it is value accretive, we can definitely leverage our balance sheet to acquire any such opportunities . So, it is a moving target for us by which opportunity will come our way. But if I have to look at on the lease model, then it is not costly affair. The project costs are almost negligible. So, we can always develop that as well. But we would continue to grow in this particular segment either way of acquiring by way of developing ourselves or by way of synergizing with another such players within the segment. It would be a combination of everything. So, it's difficult to put a number of the project on such style of businesses today . Priyanka Biswas: Sir, would it be correct to say that since your company has broadly ROCE level of roughly 18%, so eventually also in the long term when you are developing this inland logistics network, so you would also have something of that as an aspirational ROCE broadly?

Lalit Singhvi: Priyanka, this is Lalit Singhvi. So, ROCE on an immediate basis may have some effect because of this CAPEX but over a period of time we don't see because any infra project when you put in the money or CAPEXs it tends to come down but as utilization grows and we are quite confident that utilization of this facility will also grow. There will be synergies with some group also; you know other things and actually grow the chain then utilization of Navkar assets will grow rapidly. And with this ROCE will again come down for say a few 2 years to 3 years when the capacities are there and utilization is lower, but we see long term ROCE of 18 %-19% will be there.

Priyanka Biswas: So, in the presentation, you had mentioned about the Arakkonam Gati Shakti terminal, and you have mentioned the anchor customer as well. So, if you can throw some more details like what is the strategic sense of Arakkonam because it does not seem to be within the container built assets.

Arun Maheshwari : S

o, the thing is that, see now we having Navkar with us and having bought the CTO license of Sical earlier. So, if we have to be logic sector with the last mile connectivity we need to have a network of such locations across India , length and breadth of India has to be covered by such things. Now we are fortunate that we are part of the group wherein the group is also growing very fast, and they also need this kind of network across India . So, Chennai was one such location. And incidentally Arakkonam was one such asset which was perfectly fitting into the requirements of one of our anchor customers. So, we said, okay, it's not a bad idea to build on to that because the location is very rewarding. There were many players who were bidding for it who arrived for it. The hinterland is very good over there . So, we can connect it over there and we can use our licenses and we can make this good for it. So, the anchor customer could also become the base cargo for this particular location, and we can build out to our businesses from there on as well in that location. So, it's a journey which we have to travel with all the locations and thereafter we have to imbibe with all the other value accretion port assets.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 7 of 13

Priyanka Biswas: If I can just squeeze one more in, so what I see is the Paradip coal asset. There has been a Q-on-Q drop in the volumes. Is it seasonal in nature or like or do we expect the volumes to come back to like 5 million tonne plus levels which we were doing in fourth quarter?

Arun Maheshwari : So, Q-on-Q, what happens is the power plants generally start stocking up in the month of February and March because the power demand peaks up in April - May and that's where you see seasonally it slightly goes up. But then if I had to see , the drop is not very significant , it's just about 0.7 million . So, if I have to see year-on-year because that would be the real comparison, which is a significant increase. So, I think the correct barometer in port access, especially when the monsoons are very heavy in the Q 1 second part and Q 2 full. So, year-on-year would be a right barometer to understand the volume movement.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Noel Vaz from Union Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Noel Vaz: Just follow up on Navkar, I think you had mentioned that there is a plan to improve the utilization of the assets. So, what additional CAPEXs are we expecting for this particular asset ?

Arun Maheshwari : Immediately , we do not see any additional capacities coming in for that particular asset because that asset completely have very good asset base over there. There are trucks, trailers, electric

cranes, they have containers, they have their own railways. So, it is well equipped like we do on a on any immediate basis if I have to look at it, we don't need to do any major CAPEXs over there. It is only just because of we will have a very strong management, very strong network of our other assets which we would like to utilize, and We will have a very focused approach. We see a very good traction in that particular thing. We have envisaged and we have done those studies, and we expect it to be a good, good addition to our assets.

Lalit Singhvi: Just to add that Morbi is still unutilized. It has just come into operations, and this will be utilized over a period of now onwards. So, this year and next year and all that. So, this is a brand-new facility which has just come into existence.

Noel Vaz: Okay, but if you're talking about taking these assets to full utilization, what is the rough timeline we are looking at?

Arun Maheshwari : So, in any of these assets full utilization because there is no capacity nameplate over there. So, how best you utilize those capital, like Morbi if I have to look at today, that facility started just

about 6-8-10 months back and the potential that to take it full will be maybe 2 years, maybe 3 years. It could be that kind of timeline. But then that is an amazing facility at a very strategic location where the cargo generation and consumption both are at the one location. So, nothing can beat that part. And Mumbai facilities are in the heart of Mumbai wherein hardly any 1 or 2 assets are there that will be rail connected in that region. So, this is one such facility which gives a very good reach to the entire hinterland from Mumbai by rail. So, these are the advantages which we have looked at and the cargo visibility is very clear at both the locations.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 8 of 13

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Dhananjai Bagrodia from ASK investment.

Please go ahead.

Dhananjai Bagrodia : Your OP margin, what would be the reason for the reduction in OP margin? What would be steady state OP margin you look at?

Lalit Singhvi : Operating margin is 14%. Operating margin reduction is 51.42, it is 51 with almost similar margin. 0.4 has come down because that Jaigad and Dharamtar as we said that cargo has come down because of this Dolvi facility shut down. So, there the margins are at around 65% and at our terminal margins are lower, so the average margin is 51 %-52%. So, this is the reason that cargo has dropped at our captive port where the margins are higher.

Dhananjai Bagrodia : And what would your third-party value for this quarter?

Lalit Singhvi : Third party revenue is around 49% in the total and group company is around 51% .In terms of revenue ?

Dhananjai Bagrodia : And so it would the CAPEX guidance would be similar Rs. 14,000 crores for the next 3 years?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, it is approximately that level 13,000 to 14,000 we plan to spend.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sai Sidhartha from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Sai Sidhartha : I just wanted clarity on the effective tax rate for the 1Q FY25 it has been around 24% wherein for FY24 it has been around 20%. Can we kind of get a guidance on how to look at the effective tax rate and why it is kind of showing higher in this quarter?

Lalit Singhvi : Tax rate what is happening is our income from other than non ATI is increasing. There are certain terminals where ATI benefits are over and that is the reason that effective tax rate is going up. So, this train will continue for some time because net credit is available in our books, and we are utilizing that. Till then we can't migrate to the new regime. So, that is the reason that tax rates are going up, I mean effective tax rate is going up.

Sai Sidhartha : Understood, sir. So, how do we look at the same for the future years ?

Lalit Singhvi : This is around 24 % or so and it will further grow go up a bit before when we migrate to the new regime.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Arpit Shah from Stallion Assets. Please go ahead.

Arpit Shah: Yes. I just wanted to understand more on the Navkar piece. What are your thoughts around the risks of DPD for the Navkar CFS business? And my second question would be, does the JSW crew have any kind of revenues with Navkar Corp currently?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 9 of 13

Arun Maheshwari: To DPD, challenges what DPD post onto CFSs across India is already factored now so. But I think there is no more downside we see rather upside from here on because whatever factor has to be done has been done and port has a limitation to handle the DPD. So, eventually we expect the cargo to flow back to CFSs to an extent. That is one part of it, but then CFS is not the only business what we are looking out of Navkar. It is much beyond that which we had mentioned in

our earlier strategy . Now coming to your second , is Navkar also handling the JSW

group cargo ,

very miniscule. I believe they handle somewhere around close to just about 3 % or 4% of their total revenue is JSW Group's, nothing beyond that today.

Arpit Shah: And you see that expanding going forward?

Arun Maheshwari: So, we being group company, we will definitely utilize our group strength for that matter because the locations are very strategic for JSW Group overall whether it 's steel or whether cement or anybody else. So, we would like to leverage those strength on a case -to-case basis which we have been working with the group. Let's see how we span it out in the days to come.

Arpit Shah: And the long-term aspiration would be what later 3 years - 5 years are? I know it 's a part of our big position that you want to build a complete logistics company, but how do you fill in Navkar today and what do you see after 3 years or 4 years and where does it fit into with the complete picture of JSW in long term basis?

Arun Maheshwari: So, if you have seen , we have been bidding for the new terminals, we have pipeline of building new ports as well and want to get into this logistics solution providing across India. So, this is as I said earlier in the call that this is the first step towards that. So, it will , I hope, and I expect, and I wish we will not stop here, and it will further grow from here on and we have to make a start somewhere and Navkar is the first step towards that, and we are looking through GCT happen thereafter and thereafter we hope that we will get more and more such opportunity or synergy or tie -ups in these lines .

Arpit Shah: And post the open offer, do you see that as an independent company, or will it be separately listed company or you looking to merge that into JSW?

Arun Maheshwari: That is too early to say anything now . I believe as the time passes , we will take a call and then we will inform all the concerned parties.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: A lot of questions been asked on Navkar , but just one more on that piece. Is the current ports and terminals that we have in our portfolio, how does Navkar as an asset aid in those ports and terminals that we currently have , that is number one ? And number two, is by when do we think that we can successfully turn around this asset and see good amount of revenue flows from these assets?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 10 of 13

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Nidhi. I believe there have been a couple of questions on this aspect earlier, but then I think , as I said, if you have a port, if you don 't have a logic company, then the question could be when can we have the logistic company? So, it is you have to start somewhere, and we have started over here. Now we have an aspiration to develop some other ports or some other bid for some other terminals in the nearby vicinity. We have our own group companies within the vicinity of this particular location, especially in Mumbai region . We don 't have any presence in Gujarat as a port or as a manufacturing entity. So, Morbi is a good entry point for us to get into the tie ups with the existing terminals over there which can add value to other terminals as well as to Mumbai region or any other types what we are looking here and there across India . So, it could be a larger game, probably the story may hold after some time. It is too early to comment and to give a glimpse of that. So, as the time is probably you will have a look at it now. Coming to the revenue, how fast it will grow ? Who knows JSW as a success as a company and a group, we have always been very aggressive in our approach, and we would like to turn it around or it is already a good asset. We need not turn it around. It is only we have to fill up those assets and with the group strength and with the network of our other

aspirations we would like to make it

a good success story within 2 years ' time, something like that if I have to look at it.

Nidhi Shah: And other thing on the financials, firstly, that staff costs have been down significantly this quarter whether we look at it quarter -on-quarter or year -on-year. So, what is the reason for that and is that something that is sustainable, that is number one . And number two is the other income has been significantly higher for the last 3 quarters as compared to before that , again will we see these levels of other income sustained for the upcoming quarters and years?

Lalit Singhvi : So, employee benefit expenses it, it was ESOP charges, the employees stock options was given to them and that is why there was provisioning for that which is actually now tapering off . It was you know last year we had a full year basis we had charged say Rs. 150 crores and quarter wide Rs. 41 crores were charged in Q1 of '23 and this '23-24 and '24-25 this time it is Rs. 16 crores. So, there is a Rs. 25 crores coming out of ESOP only when you compare this cost. And other income, it is increasing because we came out with IPO in September end and after that we got this IPO money which is lying in fixed deposits. So, that is the additional interest income, which is flowing in , this money is yet to be deployed. Major some part is deployed and some part is

still lying , so that is the region of other income being higher . Q1 FY24 there was no IPO. IPO came in end of September

Nidhi Shah: Last question would be the ongoing projects that we have currently , what is status of the 2 liquid berths that are in JNPT that is number one and two is that we already have terminal operations at Fujairah and Dibba, are we planning to do anything else outside of India in the form of terminals and ports?

Arun Maheshwari: So, on JNPA liquid terminal, if I understood your question correctly, when it is likely to start right?

Nidhi Shah: As in whatever is the update , what phase is it at currently?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 11 of 13

Arun Maheshwari: The engineering work is already in progression, and we expect this terminal to start operating by March 25. This is what we expect today. Hopefully We will be there in the timelines . Coming to Fujairah and Dibba port, those are in O&M. There is no asset base over there and we are running those ports very successfully and very efficiently . We are very concentrated towards India because it 's a growth story and it 's offering a very great opportunity for a company like us with a great balance sheet. However, we are not very averse to looking at overseas opportunity if it is very value accretive like what we did earlier with the oil tankers terminal what we bought in Fujairah, it is great value accretion for us in terms of balance sheet. So, any such good opportunity coming our way, we would definitely assess it , reevaluate it and if it makes sense, we won 't say no to any good opportunity which adds value to all our stakeholders.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: The first question I wanted to ask you was when I see the assets that are comparable Y-o-Y on an organic basis there appears to be declining volumes. Could you kind of give us a sense of how much was the impact because of the Dolvi stoppage this quarter? And if there was a same effect last year same quarter or any other quarter, if you could quantify that as well?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, good question , Aditya and happy to answer that. As you said, because of this quarter there was a shutdown in Dolvi , there was a drop in Group company cargo, especially Dolvi plant which impacted the Dharamtar and Jaigad . The total impact was close to about 2.7 to 2.8 million somewhere around that and incidentally that is the only

volume which came from the acquired

terminal which was not there in the same quarter last. So, had those shutdown not been there, the growth would have been 18 % to 20% . Just because of the shutdown and 3rd party coming in which was not there earlier , the growth is muted to 9%. Had this acquisition not been there, the growth would have been flat. So, this is what the overall scheme goes like.

Aditya Mongia: I just want to confirm just hopping on this question , what are the similar impact last quarter , is one of a shutdown or is it something unique to this quarter?

Arun Maheshwari: It is not, the shutdown is over. So, the plant became full production in June.

Aditya Mongia: Q1 FY24, which was last year same quarter, there was no such issue.

Arun Maheshwari: There was a shutdown last year same quarter .

Aditya Mongia: What would be the impact then sir if you can quantify? The way it was 2.8 million tons of volumes lost this quarter?

Arun Maheshwari: 2.8 port volume was lost because of the shutdown in Dolvi steel plant.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. So, I'm assuming the guidance still remains kind of unchanged for organic on an organic basis, they year being a flat year on the volumes ? Would that be fair?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 12 of 13

Arun Maheshwari: The guidance for the year is 10 % to 12% growth in the volumes for overall as the port currently is doing .

Aditya Mongia: And again, just trying to dissect numbers slightly better. You said about Rs. 25 crores of Y -o-Y increase in your numbers have happened because of the ESOP expenses going down. And whatever the other income is, another Rs. 50 crores is because of the IPO expenses, right is because of these savings, or the interest earned on the amount ?

Lalit Singhvi : Yes.

Aditya Mongia: So, if I take it again your PBT basically is broadly kind of flat on Y-o-Y basis? So, that's Rs. 75 crores increase that you reported otherwise . Can you just kind of clarify that Rs. 25 crores is the ESOP part of the benefit that is happening on your P BT and about Rs. 50 crores is the benefit on the other income side which is happening because of the IPO proceeds in there. So, irrespective , your PBT as of now isn 't kind of growing on a Y -o-Y basis. Wanted to check whether even this light or the remaining 3 quarters of year would be any different or similar?

Lalit Singhvi: See this benefit of this ESOP cost will be say Rs. 60 crores or so for full year. So, every Quarter

15-16 will come and last year full year we have charged around Rs. 150 crores. So, this will continue and the other income, the interest part that depends on the cash balances with us, we are going for Navkar and other things. So, that income may come down as we as we make payments towards that.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora : Just one question related to the previous question only. So, this guidance which we are mentioning is for this organic guidance or we are including the newer ports also because I mean in this quarter if you see, I mean even despite the plant shut down we have still done 9% and now we are talking about 10% only for the full year. So, just wanted to clarify that.

Arun Maheshwari: So, see this 9% growth year-on-year basis because last year at the same time the new acquisitions were not there in the last year. So, that's why the 9% growth is coming. And if I have to look at full year basis, 10 % to 12% is the overall growth with all the assets imbibed into it because these assets were acquired sometime in Q3 last year. So, those impacts considering last year was also partial impact was there in the volumes. But this year the full impact is coming and all in all the existing assets prior to these acquisitions or also adding volumes to our businesses because of the natural growth. So, the overall growth

would remain around 10 % to 12% of the volumes.

Alok Deora: Got it. And the since this Dharamtar and Jaigad would be up and running or are already up and running, the margins would move back towards the normalized ?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, definitely. We don't see any doubts about that, rather it will improve because the new acquisitions are slightly better.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

July 18, 2024

Page 13 of 13

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question for today's Conference Call. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, everyone. And it was indeed a great pleasure to interact with all of you once again and good to interact and good to have more questions. And we will keep coming to the market giving more guidance and looking forward for your active participation. Thank you.

Moderator: On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

Call: Nov 2024

Page 1 of 16

"JSW Infrastructure Limited
Q2 FY25 Earnings Conference Call"
October 28, 2024

MANAGEMENT : MR. ARUN MAHESHWARI – JOINT MANAGING
DIRECTOR AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER – JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. RINKESH ROY – PRESIDENT – JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – WHOLE TIME DIRECTOR AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
LIMITED
MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD INVESTOR
RELATIONS – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 28, 2024

Page 2 of 16

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to JSW Infrastructure Limited Q2 FY25 Earnings Call hosted by ICICI Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar : Thank you Shlok. Good evening. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q2 FY25 Earnings Call of JSW Infrastructure. To discuss the results today, we have with us Mr. Arun Maheshwari, Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Rinkesh Roy, President, Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole Time Director and CFO, and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head Investor Relations. Without much delay, I will now hand over the call to management. We'll start with brief opening remarks by the management, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you Mohit. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. Welcome to our quarterly Earnings Call for the period ending September 30, 2024. As you know, this will be my last conference call with you all from JSW Infrastructure. I want to start by expressing my gratitude to each one of you and to the JSW management for this opportunity. Also joining us today is Mr. Rinkesh Roy, who will be taking over from me as a Joint Managing Director and CEO on November 7th of 2024.

Rinkesh has been associated with the Government of India since 1992 as an IRTS officer, bringing over 30 years of experience in ports, logistics, railway operations and shipping. He has

held the position of Chairman at major ports such as Paradip, Visakhapatnam, Tuticorin, and Kamarajar Port at various times. He has also served as the Chairman of the Dredging Corporation of India. I firmly believe that his extensive and deep expertise in ports, logistics, and railways will propel JSW Infrastructure to newer heights.

Moving on to the operational and financial performance of the quarter for the period July 24 to September 24, the total cargo handled stood at 27.5 million tons. This is 16% year-on-year growth. Our third-party cargo grew by 48% year-on-year to 12.7 million tons and the share of third-party increased to 46% in the overall mix from 36% a year ago. Total revenue for the quarter stood at INR1,088 crores reflecting a growth of 22% year-on-year.

EBITDA for the same period stood at INR607 crores, which

is 22% growth year-on-year and

net profit for the period was INR374 crores, a growth of 46%. During the quarter, 36 million tons per annum Brownfield capacity expansions at Jaigarh Port and Dharamtar Port were approved by the board of the respective subsidiary companies. The total capex of INR2,359

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 28, 2024

Page 3 of 16

crores plan includes mechanical, civil and electrical work for the new berths and additional infrastructure such as railway siding for Jaigarh Port to boost third-party cargo movement. The expansion at both ports is expected to generate an additional cargo handling volume of approximately 27 million tons per annum. Construction at both ports is anticipated to be completed by March 2027. I am pleased to share that we have emerged as a winning bidder for the development of a Greenfield port at Murbei in Maharashtra. The port is designed to be an all-weather, multi-cargo commercial port. The proposed port is located near major highways such as National Highway 8 and the State Highway Boisar Road and rail corridors such as Delhi - Mumbai - Trunk Rail Route and the dedicated Western Freight Corridor.

On October 11th, we successfully completed the acquisition of Navkar and assumed control of its operations. We are now in the process of integrating the best practices that we practice in our existing operations. At JNPA, we have received clearances from the relevant authorities to manage additional liquid cargo. This means we can handle more liquid cargo even while the pipeline work is ongoing.

Overall, we are making significant progress on our growth projects, aiming to increase our capacity from current 170 million tons per annum to 288 million tons per annum by FY28 and 400 million tons per annum by FY30. With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take you through the financials and other details for the quarter.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Arun and good evening everyone. In Q2 FY25, the company handled cargo volumes of 27.5 million tons as compared to 23.7 million tons in the quarter ended September 23. This 15% cargo growth is mainly driven by the volumes at Mangalore Coal, Paradip Coal and Ennore Coal which grew by 87%, 17% and 15% respectively on Y-o-Y basis and the incremental volumes from the newly acquired assets PNP and liquid terminal at Fujairah UAE.

Third party cargo has increased to 12.7 million tons from 8.6 million tons representing 48% in growth and the share of third-party volume stood at 46% versus 36% a year ago. The growth in cargo volume resulted in an increase in operational revenue for the quarter from INR 848 crores to INR1,001 crores, a year-on-year growth of 18%. The other income for the current quarter is INR87 crores as against INR47 crores in September 23, mainly driven by increase in income from fixed deposits and gains on mutual funds.

EBITDA for the quarter ended September 24 was at INR607 crores from INR499 crores in the quarter ended September 23, an increase of 22%. Strong EBITDA growth was mainly on account of increased revenue. Depreciation was INR 134 crores and finance cost was INR75 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR101 crores and INR75 crores respectively in the quarter ended September 23.

PBT for the quarter ended September 24 stood at INR554 crores from INR328 crores in the quarter ended September 23, higher by 69% year-on-year. Similarly, PAT for the current quarter was higher by 46% at INR 374 crores as compared to INR256 crores in September 23. As of September 24, we have a net cash of INR87 crores and one of the strongest balance sheet in the sector.

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 28, 2024

Page 4 of 16

This coupled with steadily increasing annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue the growth plan to enhance our present cargo handling capacity to 400 million tons

s by FY 2030 or earlier. With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions.

Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Ketan Jain from Aventus Spark. Please go ahead.

Ketan Jain: Hi, sir. My first question is on the forex gain or loss item reported in the P &L. If you could speak about it a bit like how is it derived and are we net long on USD or are we net short on USD exposure?

Lalit Singhvi: Sure. So, we have our revenues coming in the dollar also, the vessel related charges we get in the revenue. So, this revenue is around 17 % to 18 % of our total revenue and our foreign currency, the bonds what we have with us. So, if you look at our net outflow versus inflow, our inflows are much higher than our outflows. So, we have got a natural hedge because of dollar income. So, we follow IndAS 109 hedge accounting wherein we account future cash flows which are discounted at forward interest rate and then they are matched with the spot rate of dollar loan.

So, with this accounting, every quarter they are again restated and based on those discounting rates, the amount goes to OCI instead of PNL. So, this is basically accounting where you will see that every quarter they are reinstated.

Ketan Jain: So, every quarter it gets marked to market and that comes to the PNL from OCI.

Lalit Singhvi: Absolutely.

Ketan Jain: Yes. So, my next question is on Navkar. From when are we going to start consolidating Navkar's financials into our financials?

Lalit Singhvi: We have taken over from 12th of October. So, from there to 31st March, it will be counted in our books.

Ketan: Okay. Understood. Thank you. I will go back to the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas Exchange. Please go ahead.

Priyanka Biswas: Yes. Thank you, sir for the opportunity. And my first question is regarding, let's say, because you highlighted about the Murbe port. So, can you please share some details on what sort of ramp up we should be expecting like what should be the initial cargo and what are the royalty rates for this? So, if you can shed some details?

Arun Maheshwari: So, this port is just about 100 kilometers North of Mumbai. And because we have our production units in Vasind, Tarapur and Dolvi. In addition to that, the hinterland is very rich. There are gas and pipelines running through it. As I said the Western dedicated freight corridor and the national highway also abutting that entire place. So, overall, it gives a good potential because Mumbai is

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 5 of 16

becoming more and more congested. Jaigarh is also reaching to its increasing capacities and we see that further capacity enhancement can be done at a different port.

So, with that keeping in mind, we have gone for this port, and we look forward to develop this port in another 4 to 5 years' time. We have applied for all the approvals and now we are in the process of getting all the things in place. Initial capacity would be 33 million tons per annum.

Overall, it would be the capacity can be increased further. So, as we move forward probably we can talk about it. The royalties are all subject to when we sign the concession agreement, probably we can come out in open, and we can mention about it.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay, sir, if I may ask like last year you did something like INR20 billion in EBITDA broadly and you have a lot of growth projects that are supposed to come on stream in late FY 27 and over FY 27 to FY30. So, if I have to take the EBITDA potential for this project, what sort of EBITDA can we be looking at, let's say, around FY 28 or FY30? So, if you can shed some color on that?

Arun Maheshwari: So, see, any Greenfield port as you know, the ramp up takes a bit more time. So, it will

be

difficult to put a number onto the EBITDA numbers of FY 28 or 29 in the first year of operation.

But once we get all the clearances in place, once we have the concession agreement all signed up, thereafter we'll have a realistic date of operations, and we can probably give a color to the numbers. So, just bear with us for another one quarter or two quarters. By the time we get all the approvals in place. I think that would be more appropriate from our side to give a number by that time.

Priyanka Biswas: And sir if I can just squeeze one more in.

Arun Maheshwari: Yes.

Priyanka Biswas: So, for the second half of FY25 so that is this year, how do you see the volumes panning out?

So, seasonally 2Q is weaker, but then how do you see the volumes ramp up and specifically at which ports, if you can shed some light?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, Mr. Biswas, thank you for asking this question. See, typically, as you rightly said quarter 2 is generally weaker, but fortunately for us this year quarter 2 has been very strong, very good as compared to previous years. So, the overall growth guidance, I believe for the year if I have to

look at it, it will be around 10% on the volume front. And similarly, the revenue and EBITDA and everything flows through that. So, I think for the year, we can consider the guidance of about 10% on the volume front. And similarly, we'll get adjusted.

Priyanka Biswas: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora: Hi, sir. Good evening. Just a couple of questions, so, first is on, Jaigarh and Dharamtar port. So, we were expecting some improvement on a Q-o-Q basis, but it's still kind of subdued. So, any thoughts on that because this was something which was quite weak in the first quarter and just a minor improvement we've seen in the second quarter. So, is it like a normalized growth rate from here on in these two ports?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 6 of 16

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Alok. I believe in the first quarter results we had given; we had explained that time because there was a quarter 1 drop was there on the volume as compared to the previous years. That was largely because of there was a planned shutdown of JSW Steel at Dolvi Works, which had impacted the volume at Jaigarh as well as Dharamtar. So, that was a quarter 1 impact which cannot be recouped because once the production loss was there, it is a loss. So, that is having an overhang on the quarter one performance, H1 performance of Jaigarh as well as Dharamtar port. Going forward, because this largely handles about 90% Dharamtar or 85% handles captive cargo, and Dharamtar is 100% captive cargo. So, the growth which is coming at JSW Dolvi plant will have a real impact on this growth volume for which the capacity enhancement work is going on. So, recently like the board has approved an investment of close to about INR2,400 crores on both the ports. That is largely to increase the capacity at these two ports to support the expansion of JSW Steel at Dolvi Works, which will essentially happen in FY 27 or somewhere around the middle of FY28.

So, that's where the real volume of the physical cargo volume we expect about 27, 28 million ton flowing out of that expansion. So, that will be the real growth. And in between we will have an LPG terminal starting which we had stated at the time of IPO, that will be additional volume. We also expect LNG terminal to start operating, physical volume will start flowing in. So far as we are getting - we are getting the revenue out of those terminals, but the physical volume will start flowing in the moment LNG terminal starts operating from that. So, these are the upsides available.

Another upside is that the sugar export, which was discontinued last year, will also likely to start this year.

ear. So, that will be additional flow of cargo. So, we see overall a decent growth. The guidance remains intact for overall as a company and Jaigarh and Dharamtar as a port individually as well.

Alok Deora: Sure. And, sir, if I just see this 2030 roadmap. So, now with Murbe port also we are getting a LOI. So, we are pretty much identified or rather kind of we have the LOI for a lot of these expansion plans in place except for that 49 million tons of potential projects which will come by?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes.

Alok Deora: So, this number of 400 should be pretty achievable?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes. So, if you look at that presentation out of which 288 million tons by FY'28, all the construction is going on or everything is in place. From 288 to 400 million tons journey Keni is already signed for the land acquisition and all the approvals are getting in place now. On top of it, Murbe we have now got an LOI. So, that approval process will get into shape. The identified project of 49 million tons which are defined and identified which will come to the market and give the details about it as and when it gets signed or gets into paper somewhere.

So, when we are mentioning 400 million tons, it is very much in sight. And we don't see any ambiguity or anything which we will not be able to achieve 400 million tons which is apart from that any bidding comes into the government terminals, which we have not considered in this or

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 7 of 16

any acquisition happening throughout. So, those two elements would be on the upside over and above 400 million tons by FY'30.

Alok Deora: Got it. So, anything comes up now - so this 288 could also be higher or this is like whatever project now come?

Arun Maheshwari: If we successfully bid any of the terminals or we acquired something in between, that would be

over and above this. So, these are all defined and identified projects for which we are working on. The construction is going on or the approval processes are in the process and all this stuff. So, we don't see any uncertainty in this 400 million ton journey. It can only improve from here on.

Alok Deora: Got it. That's all from my end. Thank you and all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Paras Jain from HSBC Bank. Please go ahead.

Paras Jain: Sure. Thank you. All the best for your next visit. It was pleasure working with you.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Paras.

Paras Jain: Yes. I have one picture question on your growth expansion. Is it fair to say that given the increased commodity prices, cost of capital labor, all the future Greenfield projects, all being equal, would likely to achieve a lower IRR than your existing portfolio? And how are you thinking of balancing Brownfield and Greenfield expansions going forward or given another USD1 billion of share sale down and you will be more focusing on the Greenfield expansion to deploy the excess cash flow that you have?

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Paras. You have asked a very detailed question. I'll try to answer everything on that.

So, the projects which are coming on to stream are all very thought off. It's a blend of captive, it's a blend of third party, it's Greenfield, Brownfield terminal. It's a mixed bag of everything.

So, we don't see anything, which is slipping out of our way. JSW as a group is also known well for its execution capability.

And so far as we have delivered all our projects on time, whatever we have committed to the market in the last several years, we have done that. So, we are very hopeful. That's why we in our presentation, we make it dark green, light green and grey color so that we have our control on those projects. So, I think we will be well on time in delivery. Maybe a quarter here or there could be a timeline shift. Otherwise, we are pretty sure about it.

Coming to the total volume

growth, I think 65% to 70% is the general utilization in the port industry of the capacity. So, you can take an inference on the cargo with those capacity enhancement as and when we get it. So, this would be our guidance on this subject.

Paras Jain: Got it. Just to follow on it, is it fair to assume that IRR on those projects would be somewhat lower than your existing portfolio?

Arun Maheshwari: No, not really so. Generally, typically Greenfield ports are better in terms of IRR. It's only heavy on capex. And because of as we do the more and more utilization, the IRR keeps on improving.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 8 of 16

Our ROCE also goes up for that matter. And typically, as I said IRRs are better and all our approvals internally also our guidance is 16% project IRR what we consider. So, that is the guidance basis by which we pursue a project, or we start going for a project. So, this has been a general guidance for us for any project which we take for execution.

Lalit Singhvi: So, Paras, I would just like to add that whatever Greenfield projects we are taking where we have a cargo visibility. So, that is our great advantage whether in terms of anchor investor or any other investor. So, in our case once the project is ready, our ramp up is normally very fast.

So, once I reach the level of 60% utilization, my ROCE comes to around 18% or so. So, ROCE is linked to the utilization. In our case, utilization would be quite fast because the locations what we identified will give us a fast ramping up.

Paras Jain: Okay. That's very helpful. Thank you so much.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Paras.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Hi, thank you so much for taking my question. I would like to ask mainly on the capex for the JNPT terminal, the Tuticorin terminal, the Jatadhhar Port and the slurry pipeline. So, how much capex was undertaken in first half of the year and how much we are planning for in the rest of the year for these four projects?

Lalit Singhvi: So, Tuticorin will take 18 months to complete, capex is around INR600 crores and JNPT capex is INR100 crores, and it will take 12 months. And Mangalore container will take six months, and it is already under construction, some cranes have already arrived. So, its total cost is INR150 crores.

Nidhi Shah: I was mainly asking how much capex have we already incurred in the first half and how much is yet to be incurred?

Lalit Singhvi: First half what we have spent is mainly in the Mangalore container where we have spent around INR40 crores. Total capex all put together because that is - no this is the total capex what we have spent on all projects put together is around INR383 crores. So, this is not only Tuticorin terminal and container. There are other capex going on at Jaigarh, Dharamtar, Goa. All these things, LPG all put together in the first half is close to say you can take INR400 crores we have spent.

And now what we are going to spend in the second half, we have already spent 4th September in Navkar where we have already paid around INR1000 crores to the promoter. And open offer is getting closer although we have not received any major response in that. And the slurry pipeline what we are acquiring, we are in the process of acquiring where we expect to pay around INR1,700 crores to JSW Steel for the work already done because they have already completed more than one third of the project. So, those things are lined up for the second half apart from the regular capex what we have spent in INR400 crores. So, those types of spend will continue in the second half.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 9 of 16

Nidhi Shah: All right. Could you also give me the royalty for PNP port? So, how much revenue shall we be paying on that?

Arun Mahe

shwari: This is as per the state policy MMB which is about INR42 to INR43 per ton kind of cargo. So, this is what we per ton of cargo we share over there with the government.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you so much. If I could just lastly ask one question, one broad based question on what do you think is the outlook this year and the next year for bidding in terminals and minor ports both?

Arun Maheshwari: So, Nidhi, this is a difficult question to answer because we do not know which are the terminals would be coming up for bidding, but as a company, we being one of the largest terminal operators in India, we would continue to look for such opportunities where we can bid for more cargo terminals because we feel this is a very good way of increasing our cargo profile and the reach.

As and when any terminal comes up, we definitely look at it. And if it really makes sense for us in terms of IRR, in terms of product profile and geography we would be participating in all such opportunities. So, as of now we do not have an idea how many such terminals would be coming up for auction, but as and when it comes we will definitely participate in it and we will give a suitable guidance to the market accordingly.

Nidhi Shah: All right. Thank you so much for taking my question and all the best for the rest of the year.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, Nidhi

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Yes. Good evening, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. So, first question on Navkar. If you could give us some broad trends in terms of how do you see Navkar acquisition playing out over the next 3 years to 5 years? What kind of thought process do you have in terms of revenue and margins? What kind of business can we expect?

Arun Maheshwari: So, Navkar is definitely one big step we have taken in terms of making it a complete port and logistic solution provider to our end customers. It's a step towards catering to the last mile connectivity to the customers because it increases the stickiness of the customer to the port. That is one thing. The way India is growing, the way India has a lot of movement of cargo is happening and probably will be going the way the other economies have gone. From 4 trillion to 10 trillion, definitely we'll have more and more cargo movement happening.

And we felt that last mile connectivity, having a control on logistics will definitely give us an upper hand as compared to any other service provider in this industry on a standalone basis. So, this is one step towards that. We are likely to get into this area more and more deeper, more and more outreach and not limited only to two or three locations. Our intention is to spread out most of the geographies of India. And we have been actively scouting all those opportunities and we have been assessing it. We will give guidance to the market as and when any opportunity fructifies in reality. And definitely, we will advise all of you.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 10 of 16

As of now, giving any guidance on the revenue and EBITDA on Navkar would be difficult from this table, but we will revert very soon, maybe January, we will be able to give a fair color on that because we just took over on 11th October and now our management is sitting there and we are assessing all pros and cons and everything, what all we can do. More about it than what we thought because we see this as a great opportunity, good location and very, very good traction is what we are already getting a feel over there. So, I think a fair assessment would be given by January.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And the second is in terms of the acquisition. So, how do we see in terms of, given the capital what we have, what kind of cash flows we will generate? You will be more inclined

towards support or

the logistics? What kind of, I mean, what are the differences between the two in terms of ROCE?

Arun Maheshwari: So, ROCE is definitely a resultant at how well we utilize the assets and all. But currently, which is about 18% for us, whether to port or logistics if your question is that, we would remain committed to both the verticals. Logistics is our new vertical. So, definitely we would like to grow it as much as possible. And we have a very clear roadmap how we want to grow it because of our outreach within India, how we want to spread out. Port remains a focus area because that's a base industry for us.

And anything moves around port only for us, whether it's a port connectivity project or last mile connectivity or anything. So, port any opportunity coming to the port sector definitely we'll be looking very closely to it. And last mile connectivity or logistics will be moving around our existing assets or any other value-added assets which comes independently of it.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just last question, if I may with respect to the Fujairah terminal. If you could guide us in terms of how the scale-up has been, what kind of revenue EBITDA we are generating out of this particular location?

Lalit Singh vi: So, Achal, we have, say, 15 tanks and all are rented now for one year. And it has been much higher than what we had anticipated because rentals have pumped up and then at a higher rate, we have logged in say for one year. So, we spent that USD 187 million and we are looking at EBITDA of \$34 million. So, that way it is giving us a good return. And the market is again very tight there, supply is less, and demand is more. So, we foresee that in the foreseeable future, this will continue to give us a strong result.

Achal Lohade: And does it also present an opportunity to do any acquisition in this particular location, sir? Is there any opportunity available?

Lalit Singh vi: Yes wherever we go, if there is an opportunity at a good price if we get it. So, we can add up to have a efficiency of scale, etc. So as and when if anything comes up, we will certainly have a look at that.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Thank you so much and I will fall back in the queue, sir. Thank you.

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Achal.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 11 of 16

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Dhananjai Bagrodia from ASK Investment Managers. Please go ahead.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Hi, sir. Congratulations on the set of numbers. I wanted to ask you what is the third-party revenue number for this quarter?

Arun Maheshwari: Third-party for this quarter is 46%.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: No, the revenue, not volume-wise.

Lalit Singh vi: It is the INR470 crores is the revenue from third-party.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: INR470 right?

Lalit Singh vi: Yes, INR470 crores.

Arun Maheshwari: That is close to the proportion of the volumes.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. So, that means effectively...

Arun Maheshwari: Because our total revenue was INR1,011 crores out of which INR470 crores is about 46%.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. So, that means effectively our JSW Group business has 0% growth this year and this is mainly because of steel volumes decrease year-on-year?

Arun Maheshwari: Yes, Dhananjai your question is right, and we had given a guidance in the beginning of the year, if you were on the call that JSW Steel is generally a lumpy growth. Whenever the project starts, that is where the lump growth happens. And we had mentioned that the third-party business would be close to about 50% this year and this will remain 50% for maybe next year or it may go slightly up next year.

But the moment JSW Steel production starts happening a new project, then the captive cargo goes again high. So, it would range between 45% to 55% somewhere in between that, whether it's captive or third-party. It will figure

in that range. So, JSW Steel captive cargo will see a jump in FY 2027.

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay, sure. And sir, regarding the slurry pipeline, any thoughts on how the numbers could look? Will it be completely captive, or do we have any other customers also there?

Arun Maheshwari: So, first of all, we are waiting for formal approvals from both the shareholder side. So, once we get those shareholder approvals then we'll get into those agreements. However, giving a color to it this is a dedicated pipeline. However, we are allowed to do a third-party business on this because it is connecting mine area to the port area. We'll have to work on the nitty-gritty because such pipelines are very dedicated corridors, wherein the input and output points are very much

stable.

So, how best to utilize for the third party is what we are exploring. And once we get a very stable buyer or input provider or user of this pipeline, we'll definitely explore that part of it.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28 , 202 4

Page 12 of 16

Dhananjai Bagrodia: Okay. Sure, then I'm done with my question. Thank you so much.

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Dhananjai.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital. Please go ahead.

Ankita Shah: Yes. One quick question. Is there any kind of a slowdown in volume in the Southwest port or is it just seasonality?

Arun Maheshwari: No. So, -- yes, Ankita, thank you for asking this question. See, we are in a capacity expansion mode at the Goa port. We had given a guidance earlier this year that we are making a covered shed over there to increase the capacity from 8.5 million tons to 15 million tons. So, by the time because it's an operating terminal and if you have to do the operation as well as do the construction, so we have to compromise on some of the volume.

So, this compromise of volume is largely to increase the capacity. So, it was known at the beginning of the year that this is what was going to happen. We are still doing better than the budgeted volumes. But, yes, I agree, as compared to previous year, it has dropped. But this was a planned drop. It was to increase the capacity of the terminal.

Ankita Shah: Got it. And, sir, I wanted to understand this larger thought process behind the Murbe port, which is going to be very close to Vadhavan Port both Greenfield. So, what is the thought process? Will it be competing against each other? Will this be a 100% captive cargo port? Can you just throw some light on that?

Arun Maheshwari: So, I think this port has been on our wish list for almost 7 8 years . It's not today's development which we have been working on it. And Vadhavan has been also there for 15 20 years now, I believe in the government mind. So, the locations are so superb. Anyway, in any case we have two production units nearby to this port and Dolvi is also there, which can further increase. And Jaigarh, Dolvi, this is a combination today.

Tomorrow, we would like to have Jaigarh, Murbe and Dolvi as a combination. On top of it, that port is very close to the national highways and the Western dedicated freight corridor, as I said earlier. And that would be a deep sea water port. It would be like 18 meter, 20 meter kind of draft port and the hinterland is also very rich over there. So, it would be a combination of captive plus commercial port wherein we will handle part of the cargo in the captive front. It will be liquid, gas and other products over there.

So, Wadhwan is coming over there which is a very ambitious project. And we really look forward to that kind of -- because that will further increase the ecosystem in that entire area. So, I think these are two independent projects as what we look at it. We have our own rationales of making this port. And Wadhwan is largely for container or liquid gas wherein we would also like to have some bulk cargo happening

at these ports . So, we have to have our own supply chain

control. And we want to have this port coming as early as possible. Wadhwan has taken quite a number of years before it got onto the approval side. So, we hope that, you know, we'll be able to make this port well in time.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28 , 202 4

Page 13 of 16

Ankita Shah: Got it. Thank you and wish you all the very best and Happy Diwali.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you Ankita.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: Good evening everyone. Thank you for the opportunity. I think most of the questions have been answered. Just a few bookkeeping questions. Could you give us a sense on the tax rates and where should things be stabilizing? Because it seems that in the last two quarters, the tax rates have -- implied tax rates have meaningfully gone up?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, Aditya. So, the tax rate as you see, it is definitely effective tax rate is higher compared to what we had in Q2 24. So, this is mainly three things. One is that our 80IA, as I explained last time also 80IA benefits are now coming down. And non 80IA income is rising. And apart from that, there were one or two more things that happened during this period. One is you can see that our forex gain INR155 crores lower . So, that has affected the full rate of tax. This is a deferred tax, but that is also part of this tax. And similarly, we have got other income, if you see 47 versus

86. This is again at a full tax rate. So, these are the two things.

Third is again because of some finance bill which has affected some capital gains also where this indexes and benefit has been removed. So, INR15 crores is out of that. So, all these things put together, the rate has come to 32% or odd against the last year, but this one time will not be there in subsequent quarters. But at the same time, since 80IA income is coming down and non-80IA is coming up. So, the effective rate would be now will be going high only.

Aditya Mongia: Okay. So, is this 25% a good assumption to be making or can things be higher than that as well?
Lalit Singhvi : Sorry.

Aditya Mongia: Is 25% a good assumption to be taking incrementally?

Lalit Singhvi : Yes. So, you can consider 25% rate.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. And again, just to clarify, I have somewhere heard 10% growth guidance, just kind of double-clicking on that. And I thought it was more like 13%, 14%, low teens or so that was guided earlier? I just thought I would clarify on that aspect. What should one be looking through for volume growth for this year?

Arun Maheshwari: So, the guidance was 10% to 12% of what we have been mentioning about it. And because of this shutdown which did happen, that's why we have tapered it around 10%. So, I think we maintain our earlier guidance with a margin of about 1% to 2%.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. That's clear. I also wanted to get a sense of as in a lot of projects are on the verge of starting Jatadhar, Keni and then Mumbai. Specifically, on Jatadhar and Keni what is the status right now? As in, has the capex already started or is it completely yet to start? And how do we think through in that light, FY26, in terms of capex numbers? I'm asking so because it's important
JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28, 2024

Page 14 of 16

to set a benchmark for us to kind of see the progress of these projects. That's going to yield meaningful data over time?

Arun Maheshwari: So, Keni is progressing extremely well, as per our expectations on our timelines. So, all the approvals and all those meetings are happening. And we expect we should get in all the clearance within one to two quarters from today and thereafter the construction will start on that particular project. So, Keni is completely on, as per the timeline as what we

envisaged. Maybe a quarter

ahead of the timelines, what we thought so initially.

Jatadhar all the approvals have been in place. There have been some delays in signing the construction agreement, which we expect should be signed within November or so. This is what the expectations are, and I think we are all set to start the construction over there because this will be largely under our control, all the status. All the approvals are already in place, whether it's environment forest or land and other stuff. So, the moment it is there, our dredges are ready. All the scheme of things are fully done over there. So, the first project to come on stream in terms of construction probably will be Jatadhar. We are just waiting for the signature of the concession agreement, which should happen within this month or so -- within the next month or so.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. And just a final comment from your side. Given these sound bites coming from JSW Steel of some deferral in the capex for Vijayanagar, does it really impact us in terms of timelines for Keni or how should one think through it?

Arun Maheshwari: No. This is very independent capex to that because as such Keni has big hinterland. The total hinterland of Keni is about 65 million tons. And we are building this port of phase one of 30 million tons and out of 65 million tons, almost 35 to 40 million tons is independent cargo as compared to JSW Vijayanagar. So, we are completely nowhere dependent on Keni port for JSW cargo in any which case.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. That clarifies. Thanks a lot for the responses and these are my questions. All the very best to you.

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Aditya.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Shreyans Daga from Barclays. Please go ahead.

Shreyans Daga: Hi, thank you for the opportunity. I have one or two questions. So, at Jaigarh and Dharamtar Brownfield expansion, can you mention what are the timelines and when are you expecting to complete them?

Arun Maheshwari: So, we are expecting these projects to be completed by March 27 which is about 30 months from today. And this will be in sync with the capacity ramp-up at JSW Steel Dolvi. So, we are syncing it along with that. And that project is going on a very, very stable pace. So, we are okay to go ahead with the construction of them. So, the work has already started at both the locations whether Dharamtar or Jaigarh port. So, 30 months from today.

Shreyans Daga: Okay. And how much capex is earmarked?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

Arun Maheshwari: Close to about INR2,400 crores is what the guidance and approval what we got from the board. And we expect to complete the entire project within that guidance.

Shreyans Daga: Okay. Thanks. My next question is so at the time of IPO, the promoter shareholding was close to 85% and you need to bring it down to 75% by next two years. So, I know you are previously guided to primary issuances. So, are you expecting anything within FY25, FY26?

Lalit Singhvi: So, we still have time. So, it's one year in the past, two years are still left. So, we have not yet decided about the timing part of it because today we are already sitting on cash. So, as and when capital need arises or within the timeline anyways we have to do it. So, it is yet to be decided.

Shreyans Daga: Okay, thanks. That's it for me.

Arun Maheshwari: Thanks, Shreyans.

Moderator: Thank you. We will take the last question from the line of Bharani from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Bharani: Can you throw some light on the status of the Navkar deal like how much have we spent, how much yet to be spent?

Lalit Singhvi: So, Navkar promoter stake of 70.37 %. We have purchased at say around INR1,000 crores and EV value is INR1644 crores. So, that is the total thing and out of that open offer we have

not got

any response as such. So, it remains at that level only.

Bharani: Okay. So, we are expecting to spend for the open offer by end of this year?

Lalit Singhvi: So, open offer is already closed. That was open for 10 days and just got closed on Friday. So, this is all over and what we understand that around maybe less than 2,000 shares have been given. So, prices are much higher than the open offer price. So, it didn't elicit any response.

Bharani: So, should we take the final percentage stake in Navkar that we will end up with for this year at around 74%?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So, it remains same whatever we have purchased from the promoter, 70.37 %.

Bharani: Okay. My second question is on the performance of Navkar in the first half. Can you give some colour on what is the revenue EBITDA PAT for the first half of FY25 so far?

Arun Maheshwari: So, thanks for asking this question. I believe we had clarified in one of the questions earlier that we will come back to you with Navkar because we just took the control on 11th October. So, we will come back to you by January with a clear roadmap how we are looking at it because whatever we have thought, it looks better than that. So, it is better to give guidance with a clear thought and getting into the deep management. So, January calls probably we can give an update on this particular subject.

Bharani: Okay. So, I was not asking for the full year number, maybe the first half number?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 28 , 2024

Arun Maheshwari: We have taken over on October 11th. So, I think our management control starts from that date. So, that is where we will be.

Lalit Singhvi: So, second half result will only be consolidated in our book. The first half in any case is not relevant for us.

Bharani: Okay. No, I am trying to understand the trend basis the first half number that we are aware of, I am just trying to see how much will be the full year number that is the reason?

Arun Maheshwari: We are still awaiting those.

Vishesh Pachnanda : Bharani see Navkar is a listed company. So, the results are already out in the public for the first half, and we have taken control on 11th October. So, we digest the information and then we get back to you on the guidance.

Bharani: Okay sure. No problem.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you Bharani.

Moderator: Does that answer all your questions. Mr. Bharani.

Bharani: Sure. Yes. I am done.

Moderator: Thank you. As there are no further questions, I would now like to hand the conference over to the management of JSW Infrastructure Limited for closing comments.

Arun Maheshwari: Thank you, everyone. Thank you for imposing so much of confidence on JSW Infrastructure and making it so interactive call. This being my last call from here, nevertheless this is a festive season. I wish all of you a great Diwali, great festive times and your continued support to Mr.

Rinkesh Roy, who has a very very extensive experience in this field. And I am sure you will extend the same support and guidance to them. Mr. Rinkesh Roy is here with me.

Rinkesh Roy: Good evening everyone. I am Rinkesh. A very Happy Diwali to each one of you and your families. Wish you all the best. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you sir. On behalf of ICICI Securities, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2025

Page 1 of 17

"JSW Infrastructure Limited and Navkar Corporation
Limited
Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call"
January 28, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RINKESH ROY – JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR
AND CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER – JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – WHOLE TIME DIRECTOR AND
CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
LIMITED
MR. ARUN SHARMA – CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER –
NAVKAR CORPORATION LIMITED
MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD INVESTOR
RELATIONS – JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. MOHIT KUMAR – ICICI SECURITIES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
January 28, 2025

Page 2 of 17

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Moderator: Ladies and Gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Q3 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of JSW Infrastructure Limited and Navkar Corporation Limited hosted by ICICI Securities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Mohit Kumar: Good evening. On behalf of ICICI Securities, we welcome you all to the Q3 FY '25 Earnings Call of JSW Infrastructure Limited. To discuss the results today, we have with us Mr. Rinkesh Roy, Joint Managing Director and CEO; Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole Time Director and CFO; Mr. Arun Sharma, CEO, Navkar Corporation Limited; and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head, Investor Relations.

Without much delay, I'll now hand over the call to the management to start with brief opening remarks, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Rinkesh Roy: Thank you, Mohit. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. Welcome to our quarterly earnings call for the period ending December 31, 2024. As this is my inaugural interaction with you all as Joint Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer on this platform, I'm quite enthusiastic about the future growth prospects of JSW Infra.

I'd like to outline my top three priorities: number one, to ensure the advancement and successful completion of our expansion plan to 400 million tonnes per annum by FY 2030 or before

encompassing greenfield, brownfield and other growth projects within the stipulated time and budget.

Number two, to significantly scale up the logistics business segment, targeting a top line of INR8,000 crores by FY '30 and an EBITDA margin approaching 25%. The objective is to expand the business on an asset-light model to achieve an industry-leading ROCE. Number three, to continuously seek out value-accretive inorganic opportunities.

Now moving on to the operational and financial performance. For the period April '24 to December '24, the total cargo handle stood at 85.7 million tonnes, registering an 11% year-on-year growth. Third-party cargo mix grew by 45% year-on-year to 41.7 million tonnes and the share of third-party increased to 49% in the overall mix, up from 37% a year ago.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 3 of 17

Total revenue for the 9 months ending December '24 stood at INR3,

457 crores, reflecting a

growth of 22% year-on-year. The total EBITDA for the period stood at INR1,885 crores, which is 22% year-on-year growth and net profit for the period was INR1,006 crores, a growth of 21%.

Now specifically on the developments during the quarter, at JNPA, we have obtained approval from the relevant authorities to commence interim operations, and we handled nearly 90,000 tons of liquid edible oil this quarter. Similar efforts are in progress at Tuticorin dry bulk terminal and we anticipate receiving clearances to begin interim operations soon.

The cargo handling capacity at the Mangalore coal terminal has been increased to 8.1 million tonnes per annum, up from 6.7 million tonnes per annum. At PNP port, the capacity increased to 8 million tonnes per annum from 5 million tonnes on the back of dredging activities, while the environmental clearance is in place for 19 million tonnes per annum. Thus, the total capacity of the company increased to 174 million tonnes per annum, up from 170 million tonnes per annum.

I'm pleased to share that the global ESG risk rating agency, Morningstar Sustainability has rated JSW Infrastructure Limited as low risk on ESG. This rating from a globally reputed agency confirms our belief, ability and commitment to manage ESG risks as part of our overall business strategy.

With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi, our CFO, to take us through the financials and other details.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Rinkesh, and good evening, everyone. Let me first talk about our port business. In Q3 FY '25, the company handled cargo volumes of 29.4 million tonnes as compared to 28.1 million tonnes in the quarter ended December '23. This 5% increase was driven by the increased capacity utilization in the coal terminal at Paradip, the contribution from PNP port and liquid storage terminal in UAE.

The growth was partially offset by the lower cargo volumes in the iron ore terminal at Paradip.

Third-party cargo has increased to 14.3 million tonnes from 10.9 million tonnes, representing 31% growth and share of third party volume stood at 49% versus 39% a year ago. The growth in cargo volume and change in volume mix resulted in 13% increase in operational revenue for the quarter from INR1,063 crores.

Operational EBITDA for the port segment stood at INR570 crores up from INR480 crores, an increase of 19% strong EBITDA growth was largely driven by the increased revenue. We have consolidated Navkar Corporation Financial with effect from October 11, '24, as a result of total revenue of the company stood at INR1,265 crores and the total EBITDA stood at INR670 crores reflecting a year-on-year growth of 24% and 20%, respectively.

Consolidated depreciation was INR138 crores and finance cost was INR97 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR108 crores and INR67 crores, respectively in the quarter ended December '23. Given the sharp depreciation in the INR and change in the yield curve, we have

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 4 of 17

recognized mark-to-market unrealized loss of INR156 crores. This is essentially a noncash charge and in line with guidelines of Ind-AS 109 on hedge accounting.

As a result, profit before tax for the quarter ended December '24 stood at INR276 crores as compared to INR307 crores in the quarter ended December '23. PAT for the current quarter grew by 32% at INR336 crores as compared to INR254 crores in the same period last year.

As mentioned by Rinkesh, we are scaling up our logistics segment based on the foundation of Navkar business. Hence, we have allocated close to INR9,000 crores of capex till FY '30 and aspire to achieve 25% EBITDA on a top line of INR8,000 crores. The expansion aims to build

on the Navkar acquisition to develop a robust pan-India logistic network for last-mile connectivity.

As of December '24, we have net debt of INR827 cr

and net debt to EBITDA is 0.4x and

one of the strongest balance sheet in the sector. This, coupled with steady increasing annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue our growth plan to enhance our present cargo handling capacity to 400 million tonnes and parallel growth of our logistics business with a top line of INR8,000 crores by FY 2030.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions. Thank you.

Moderator: The first question is from the line of Mr. Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities.

Achal Lohade: Sir, first, on the volume part, if you could help us understand how do you see the volumes going out given our twin ports Jaigarh and Dharamtar combined have been seeing a muted growth, given the JSW steel capacity utilization? How do you see that evolving in 4Q as well as FY '26 and maybe over the next couple of years? And then I'll ask a follow-up question.

Rinkesh Roy: As you are aware, the Jaigarh and Dharamtar ports, they're primarily serving Dolvi steel and Dolvi steel plant is currently expanding from 10 million tonnes per annum capacity to 15 million tonnes. So this lumpy growth will come once when this plant gets commissioned, which will be in around '26 and/or '27, mid '27. I think that would be the place where we will see a lumpy growth coming.

Lalit Singhvi: So till then, I would like to add that we will continue to have our regular growth based on our capacity, which is at 66%.

Utilization, we can go to 75%, 80%. So this will be largely coming from third-party growth. So this year also, you can see that we have reached composition up to 49%, which was earlier 39%. So this growth of say we have given a guidance of 10%. This will continue to be there till we have our expansions coming into the picture.

Achal Lohade: Understood. So essentially, what you're saying is that the current volume momentum should continue until the new capacity gets added in Dolvi steel. And at the company level, we are maintaining 10% volume growth for FY '25. Have I understood right, sir?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 5 of 17

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So if you are looking at the quantity side, it will continue as per our guidance. But our revenue and EBITDA will certainly grow much faster because we have other businesses also now into the play, take it for Navkar or any other acquisitions possibilities also is there, which we are working upon. So this would be a different than our regular growth in the cargo.

Achal Lohade: Understood. The second question I had, if you could highlight excellent scale-up on Fujairah, 2 million tonnes for the quarter. Is that a new run rate we should work with? And how are the margins? If you could give some sense on -- in terms of the EBITDA for Fujairah from annual run rate perspective?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. This should continue because the market is good for the tank farm business. So we expect this to continue and EBITDA margins for this type of business is typically high at 85% plus. So this is a very good acquisition for us, and we are further pursuing such possibilities in the times to come.

Achal Lohade: Understood. If I may ask a follow-up question. In terms of the in terms of the logistics capex guidance, can you help us understand how do you look at this particular aspect of the business. You've said you will expand Navkar business, if you can throw some more light, given the capex seems to be fairly large one. And when you say asset light, I'm just a little lost here, you're saying you will spend INR9,000 crores for INR8,000 crores revenue with a 25% margin that comes to about 20%, 22% ROCE. So if you could just tie these points, sir.

Lalit Singhvi: So partly, I'll answer and partly Rinkesh will further elaborate on the logistics business. So what I'm saying that -- on this side, what will come to Navkar, Navkar will

continue to grow, and as

we are building a parallel network or an alternate network pan-India basis, so Navkar will certainly get benefit of it. So you know that we have made a platform above Navkar, which is JSW Port Logistics company. So there will be a lot of growth coming through this platform. Navkar balance sheet, whatever it can take, it will go to Navkar and rest of this will go to the port logistics company.

So spending of this INR9,000 crores, what we have planned till FY '30 will be partly at Navkar and partly at other labels at this platform which we have created. So as regards to the ROCE and all that, 20% or 22% ROCE, this is basically, we are going for low-cost options, which Rinkesh will further explain to you.

Rinkesh Roy: You see, you have to look at Navkar as a stepping stone into the logistics industry. And from here, as Mr. Singhvi said, the logistics part of the network, the network planning is more

important than anything else in logistics. So what we have planned is setting up close to 15, 20 terminals across India. So that Navkar also gets access to the terminals and its cargo also increases as part of a bigger network. That is number one.

Number two, we're trying to leverage the group's cargo into this Navkar and the pan -India logistics platform that we have. So we will create base cargo for further movement. Number three, the current structure of creating an ICD or an asset is quite expensive. So what we are looking at is that apart from greenfield projects we'll be also looking at Gati Shakti terminals of JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 6 of 17

the railways in which we don't have to buy the land. We get land on lease from the railways and you can set up a similar terminal and also leverage our own sidings, group sidings as well as have strategic tie-ups with major importers and exporters.

So in this strategy, we will be creating the same assets at a much lower cost. So this is on the terminal part. Secondly, a large part of our capex will also go into either leasing of rakes or purchasing of rakes, a mix of which -- an ideal mix we'll be calculating and moving ahead. So this will be broadly the strategy that will be followed.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Lokesh Maru from Nippon India Mutual Funds.

Lokesh Maru: Just one question. So revenue is obviously growing faster than volume growth within the core ports business, let's say, 8% volume growth, about 13% top line growth. So could you please help me understand the realization part where are we seeing this hike in realization?

Lalit Singhvi: See this year, if you see in this quarter, one is Navkar, one quarter almost has come 11th October to this, where the cargo is not included because in Navkar is a logistics business, so only revenue or EBITDA comes. So that has come, which is not linked to the port cargo. And this oil tank terminal, which we have in UAE, so that has come into the picture where the margins are 85% plus.

So this has enabled that revenue and EBITDA are much higher compared to our port cargo where EBITDA margins are, say, 50%, 52%, 53%. But here, it has 85% revenue business has come in.

So this has made us that revenue and EBITDA are much higher than the throughput.

Lokesh Maru: Sir, just one more thing. So this 50 terminal plan on logistics side, this is something new, right, mentioned first time on the call, could you please elaborate what is the plan, maybe in some bit more details?

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from BNP Paribas.

Priyanka Biswas: Sir, my first question, actually going on to the previous question that was asked. While I understand that the realizations have been kind of similar at the port end of the business. But what I see is that the EBITDA per tonne has improved significantly. So can you tell me like -- is this number sustainable? Or should it improve from here even more? Can you just throw some color on that, let's say, in the subsequent quarters?

Lalit Singhvi: So it is the last question of mix, Priyanka, so this will continue if we go in the same way. The port business EBITDA will remain the same. But if you -- as this Navkar business gets added, and you know that Navkar and logistics business typically is a much lesser percentage and combined one would definitely be a bit lower than what we have been reporting for the port business, and that is why we are going for now segment-wise reporting.

So we'll be giving logistics separately and port business separately. And as I said earlier, port has shown a higher number because last year, that oil tank business was not there and this year JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 7 of 17

oil tank business has come. This is included into the port business, and that is why the EBITDA margin is higher.

Priyanka Biswas: And sir, what I see is that there has been sharp falls in the iron ore volumes, which you had also highlighted in your media releases. So can you elaborate on the reasons why it is so? And when exactly can we expect these volumes to come back?

Lalit Singhvi: The iron ore prices are cyclical and right now, the prices are a little lower. So it has affected a bit on the export side. So this -- as and when we have seen in the last few years that this in a year also, there is a cycle. Sometimes it is good and then exports are higher. So some people have in between stopped and some large players have, again, restarting those things. So we feel that in the next quarter, it should come back.

Rinkesh Roy: So at Paradip and Odisha sector, there were some stop and start with two major customers stopping in the last quarter for various reasons. So they are all -- they've all restarted now. So we -- and these are part of the iron ore market. So they generally, you will understand that if the

prices are good, then people start moving more. So this is one thing which we'll be facing and will be overcoming.

Priyankar Biswas: And just adding on. So, just like you had highlighted that with the INR90 billion capex for logistics, you should get something of an EBITDA of something like INR20 billion by FY '30. Similarly, can you tell for the INR300 billion capex originally that you had planned for the ports part particularly, what sort of EBITDA that capex should lead to by FY '30, like a comparable number?

Rinkesh Roy: So most of our project appraisals that we do are based at a minimum of at least 16%. So that you can take as a sure short guidance that it will never be below those numbers.

Lalit Singhvi: And I said earlier also that since greenfield projects are more where there is no revenue sharing. So I'm looking at EBITDA margins going from, say, current level of 52%, 53% operational EBITDA margin, they are going to 58%, 59%. So -- and that is mainly because the share of greenfield is more unless we are able to get more terminals from the government privatization, which we don't know today how much will come because that only decreases because there is a revenue sharing there. So more or less, this -- based on this guidance, you can estimate the number.

Priyankar Biswas: Just one more if I can squeeze in. This is regarding to particularly on JSW Steel. So in each of the quarters, in the past 3 quarters, we are seeing some sort of maintenance or some things around there. So should we expect such a thing to also occur in, let's say, 4Q or FY '26? Or should we have more of a normalized run rates for...

Rinkesh Roy: If you see that JSW Steel generally, they have been meeting and they have been targeting also the peak capacity. So the maintenance schedules, they will all be a normal part of a process. So I don't think we should be reading too much into that. The only thing we should be looking at is whether JSW

Steel is meeting its target.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 8 of 17

Lalit Singhvi: There is a past track record of JSW Steel running the capacity at quite high level. So based on that, we expect that capacity utilization should continue.

Priyankar Biswas: And sir, on the JSW Logistics side of things. So can you give us some idea like how the capex be spread out? So for example, during your INR300 billion capex you had given, that INR130 billion would be till FY '27 and the rest would be from FY '27 to '30. So what should be the spread out of the INR90 billion capex that you plan for JSW Logistics?

Rinkesh Roy: So broadly if you see on this INR9,000 crores already INR1,100 crores has gone into Navkar acquisition. Okay? And then on top of that, we will be adding -- these are the approximate numbers and currently at a very, very ideal stage. These have not been fleshed out into exact numbers.

But broadly, GCT and terminal development should give us -- we should be spending another INR3,000 crores, another INR3,000 crores on rig acquisitions or leasing and for containers, it would be that for specialized containers too and other types of containers that will be developed, we are looking at a capex of around INR1,500 crores and on other activities would be another INR500 crores. So this would be broadly the numbers that give or take, it will vary, but this would be broad trend.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal.

Alok Deora: Just had a couple of questions. So first is on the logistics revenue targets. So we are targeting INR8,000 crores revenue by FY '30 and if I just look at the ports number, if we just take a growth rate on the current run rate, so that would again be the current INR4,000 crore annual revenue could double in the next 5 years. So would it be a situation where we are almost at 50%, 50% in terms of ports and logistics?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. It looks like based on the current plan of going into a big way the logistics network, so this would be around it. So you are right that INR4,000 crores to INR5,000 crores we'll be spending on the port sector and INR1,500 crores to INR2,000 crores on the logistics sector.

Alok Deora: No. I meant the size of the business by FY '30. So your revenue from logistics will be INR8,000 crores by that time, your revenue from ports would be around a similar amount?

Lalit Singhvi: No, that should be much higher, not INR8,000 crores. By FY '30, it will be much, much higher actually.

Alok Deora: And this -- the capex, so you broadly mentioned some of the areas. But how do we see -- how are we looking at this business because we are talking about here a 25% sort of margin here, which is similar to, say, what Adani Logistics is doing, for example. But do we see the business to operate as a standalone business? Or it would be kind of provided as a blended service to ports. If you could just throw some light on that?

Rinkesh Roy: You see -- if you see all major port or terminal operators, they gradually move into the logistics part of the area because this is a core adjacency to the port or terminal business. Number one,

what it does, it ensures stickiness of the customer. Number two, you are looking at not being a stand-alone port or a stand-alone terminal operator, but being in a larger play of the logistics business, in which the last mile connectivity up to the hinterland or the ICD plays a very big role.

And number three, apart from synergizing with our ports, our greenfield ports that we are coming up with, along with the other opportunities in the major port terminals that we'll be looking at, we are also synergizing with our group cargo. So to just give you an example, JSW Steel has a humongous spend on logistics. So even if we capture and synergize

with them for a smaller percentage, at least 15% to 20%, that itself will be around 40%, 50% of the revenues and EBITDA that we are projecting. So this synergy of group cargo, of the port terminal as well as having the pan-India presence and logistics, this will be a natural progression from ports and terminals into logistics.

Lalit Singhvi: So just to add that the model will continue to be the same like a port. So base cargo here again will come from the anchor customer because they have a lot of that outbound cargo, which goes from all part of the country, say, from South or also from West, also from Delhi till Delhi and North. So our base cargo for this logistics will also come from that basis, and then we'll top it up with the third-party customers. So that works very well for our port also, and that will work very well for our logistics play also.

Alok Deora: Got it, sir. And just if you mentioned about the sharp jump in margins going ahead where operating EBITDA moves from 53% to 58%. Just a couple of minutes if you can spend how that would happen because that's a big jump, which we are talking about without a significant change in the portfolio of cargo handled. So just a minute if you can spend, that would be helpful.

Lalit Singhvi: Sure. So as I said that if you look at my 174 million to 400 million tonnes journey, so most of the investment is going into the greenfield ports, okay? So whether it's Keni or Murbe or Jatadhar they all are greenfield or wherever we are expanding, say, Jaigarh or Dharamtar and all that, where the EBITDA margins are 65% to 70% because there is no revenue sharing with the government.

Today, my ratio is around 50-50 between the terminals and the major ports and in private ports. So the margin profile is 52%, 53%. But my composition of cargo from the private ports is going to increase as we reach towards 400 million tonnes. So that itself will give my EBITDA margins to go to 58%.

Alok Deora: And just last question, if I may. So when in FY '28, '30 when you scale up the logistics business as well, which would be more like a 20%, 25% margin and you also have the ports business scaling up with slightly higher margins. So blended margins could still be at around of 53%, 54%. Is that understanding correct? Because that logistics business will also be...

Lalit Singhvi: No, no, no, it will be higher. I said my port business will have a much larger chunk of the share in the total business. So this will be much higher, even if it is 15%, 20%, that should be around

55% -- it will not be less than that as per the current arrangement of 400 million tonnes. If I go further into the private terminals and the major ports, then composition may be different because there, we have to share revenue. But as far as the plan which we have rolled out of 400 million tonnes, it will be around 55%.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

Aditya Mongia: Firstly, I wanted to get a sense that on a Y-o-Y basis, could you tell us the movement of some ease of expenses booked inside employee cost?

Lalit Singhvi: So ESOP expenses mostly has been provided. I'll just see the -- exact this thing, how much is left out. One second, just give me that -- FY '25 is INR15 crores and FY '26 is INR25 crores further to be done. That is all left now, INR40 crores is total left.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. No. What I was just trying to get a sense of was on a Y-o-Y basis, how much would have been the savings at an EBITDA level because of lower ESOP costs and how much are the operational kind of element over here? So your EBITDA has grown from INR370 crores to INR440 crores Y-o-Y from the ports operation, so that's been a INR70 crore increase. I'm just trying to kind of decipher, of the INR70 crores, how much came in because of lower ESOP expenses

ses Y -o-Y?

Lalit Singhvi: Just one second , I'll just give you the exact number. Give me a second.

Management: Aditya, let me come back to you after this call.

Lalit Singhvi: We will give you the exact number.

Management: We'll provide you this number.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Again, just a clarification as in if I see your presentation and derive numbers for the logistics business, it seems to be INR120 crores, INR130 crores kind of top line from logistics and maybe 11%, 12% EBITDA margin kind of number. Are these broadly kind of stable numbers to project at least in the very near term? Obviously, over time, you will become a much larger margin company in logistics but like 11%, 12% is it a good starting point from a margin perspective over here...

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, this will -- we are looking at some improvement in the margin in the next year itself. We have some low -hanging fruits where we can improve the margins. There are some investments are required to increase the revenue and which will increase the margins also because you know that Morbi facility was just started a year back.

So it has not reached to the breakeven utilization itself. So fixed costs are quite heavy. So once we are able to utilize this capacity a bit more and this Navkar, this Panvel facility in any case because of our Dolvi requirements. So these are the low -hanging fruits, we expect next year itself to give good results.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 11 of 17

Aditya Mongia: And just last question, as in you've talked about FY '25, but FY '26, what could be a reasonable growth guidance? Taking into account the fact that Dolvi constraints may continue and bulk of the inorganic elements are already captured inside FY '25. Could we still think through a high single -digit growth or would it become challenging to go at that, please?

Lalit Singhvi: See, that's why I'm saying that we should look now revenue and EBITDA numbers for our growth and the normalized growth without any acquisition, we said it would be similar to what we have seen this year. That is assured. Beyond that, may come from the cargo numbers may come as we go for some acquisition. But definitely, with the improvement in Navkar and other things, the revenue and EBITDA profile would be much better than this number. We may come back during the March quarter, further refinement on this.

Aditya Mongia: I just probably kind of harp on this aspect, see the problem, at least with me as an analyst is that your organic trends on growth are suggesting a decline happening on a Y -o-Y basis in the past few quarters. And the growth has been driven more by the inorganic components and obviously, complements to the company to get those opportunities inside and more will come?

I'm just trying to get a sense that for the existing assets that you have, how do you see through growth panning out? Because the number today appear to be kind of fairly soft on a growth perspective. So where does the U-turn happen and from where? Just helps us kind of build the numbers more precisely, incrementally?

Rinkesh Roy: So if you look at the board profile , two terminals, that is JNPA and Tuticorin. While they'll be commissioned, JNPA we are looking at the first quarter of '25 and Tuticorin later on. The biggest advantage that we are having is these terminals are allowed for interim operations. So a lot of growth we expect to come even during the interim operations at these two terminals.

Similarly, Paradip coal terminal, there were certain issues at the coal fields on major law and order issues. So these have been all sorted out. So on the port sector itself, we are quite upbeat that we'll be able to increase volumes there. At least, we're looking at double -digit growth, which earlier my predecessors had also told you. So this would be the growth that we expect to see in '25, '26.

Lalit Singhvi: S

o you know that EQ terminal, we have capacity, 30 million tons. We are still yet to utilize those capacities. We are less than 20 million tons at the moment. So there is a scope there and a lot of coal requirement. So there were some constraints and they are getting resolved. So there, this particular terminal, we expect a good growth. And as we said, Tuticorin and JNPA interim operations have been initiated because berths are already there. And we need to -- parallelly, we will be doing all the investments which are required.

So this will further add to our this thing. Covered shed of Goa would be ready by this March end. So there, again, we have -- we were earlier concerned by the pollution authorities. And as per their requirement, we have set up the covered shed. So Goa will give us further additional cargo. So there are opportunities of these terminals, which will give additional cargo, even if we have a flat growth at JSW Steel's cargo.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 12 of 17

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Arpit Shah from Stallion Asset.

Arpit Shah: Yes. I just wanted to understand, did we have any contribution from the JSW Group in the Navkar business this quarter?

Lalit Singhvi: Arun will explain to you from Navkar.

Arun Sharma: Yes, JSW has been our customers even before the takeover also. So right now, current 15% revenue comes from JSW Steel. So that is a contribution what we get from JSW Steel. And further, it is -- we are in discussion with JSW Steel to further top it up.

Arpit Shah: 15% or 50%? 1 -5 or 5 -0?

Arun Sharma: 1-5.

Arpit Shah: And I just missed the numbers on the INR9,000 crores breakout, which you did for the logistics business, how much was the terminals, how much was for the leasing, I just missed that number.

Can you just list it down again, please? I'll just repeat my question. You all said INR9,000 crores breakup of capex in the logistics business, if you just can list down that numbers again?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So basically, this includes whatever we have spent for Navkar, which is around INR1,000 crores or so. And then we talked about that we are -- we will be setting up GCT terminal where it will be low cost where the land is given by the government. So we only have to pay the lease charges. So that would be another, say, one third of total will go there. And the other investment would be into the rakes, containers and other facilities to make the GCT work.

Arpit Shah: So that will make that number INR6,000 crores, right?

Lalit Singhvi: No, no, INR9,000 crores. So we said the GCT itself would be around INR3,000 crores. Navkar is already INR1,000 crores, so INR4,000 is gone. Rest of the money will go into the rakes, containers and other facilities.

Arpit Shah: And just one last strategic question that I had, why are we not making Navkar as the logistic arms for the group? Like is it possible to keep the structure very clean instead of doing one piece here, maybe the logistics piece and Navkar and other piece like in the JSW Port Logistics business. So is it possible to keep the structure clean where Navkar could be leading the logistics business for our group and the JSW Infra could be leading the ports division for the group. Just wanted to understand any insights on that?

Lalit Singhvi: Sure. We'll explain to you. So we have already created a platform, which is called JSW Logistics -- Port Logistics company below JSW Infra. And Navkar has been acquired by JSW Port Logistics Company, not by JSW Infra. So we are very clear that we are making a platform for logistics business under JSW Port Logistics Company. Because Navkar balance sheet is not that big, which can take that load of INR8,000 crores, INR9,000 crores.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 13 of 17

So it's -- we have made in this way that there are -- there will be many

more companies we may

further acquire -- I mean, ICDs or CFSs or any other new acquisition under this platform. So all this put together, our idea is to strengthen that platform. But Navkar will continue to get benefit because of the network which we are creating. And as per their balance sheet, what they can take, that will go to Navkar.

Arpit Shah: But are there any fund infusion plans from the group to Navkar because there is scope to improve the stake from, let's say, 70% to 75%. So there is a chance where you could probably increase stake and make the balance sheet a little healthier than what it is currently?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. At the moment, we are not contemplating any change in the shareholding structure of Navkar. They will definitely have good cash flows. And we said that there will be the benefit of anchor customers, increasing their cargo with Navkar. That was a prime reason also because their location is like that where the anchor customers will enhance their business. So once their cash flows are increasing, and then we can always expand whatever possible within the Navkar.

Arpit Shah: Any guidance for FY '26, '27 on the EBITDA front for Navkar?

Lalit Singhvi: That will come back by the March quarter. We will come back and give the guidance for Navkar at that point.

Rinkesh Roy: But it will be definitely much, much better than what it is right now.

Lalit Singhvi: No, no, that is there because we have already given that the triggers would be group cargo, low-hanging fruits, wherever a lot of -- a bit of whatever investment immediately needed will be done. So all this put together will give a good growth in their revenues and EBITDAs.

Arpit Shah: And what kind of utilization we have on these assets as of now?

Lalit Singhvi: Arun will explain to you.

Arun Sharma: So as far as EXIM business is concerned, EXIM business is concerned at Navkar, at this Panvel facility, all 3 facilities put together, we are doing close to around 15,000-odd TEUs, which is -- if I see it takes the dwell time of a week, which is going on right now, a week to 10 days, we are operating at 80% of -- 80%, 85% of utilization.

With the domestic containers, domestic volume getting in and the volume of domestic containers going up, that remaining utilization level of 20%, which is left out, we are taking care of from the domestic containers. As far as the Morbi capacity utilization is concerned, there is a good headroom which is available. And we are -- we can say we will be -- we are operating at around 25% to 30% at Morbi.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Kunal Shah from DAM Capital.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 14 of 17

Kunal Shah: Just a couple of things on the logistics spread. So the INR8,000 crores revenue number for the logistics, right? So -- and this is also built up on our assumption to capture the JSW Group domestic freight expenditure, I mean, the wallet share, right?

So could you just guide how much over time could this be captive versus third -party or your assets? So I'm just trying to understand that the INR9,000 crores capex, how much is sort of earmarked for your group capex basically just to capture that bit of wallet share.

Lalit Singhvi: So it's not earmarked capex -wise, as per their requirement, say, we said 15 to 20 GCT centers we may plan over a period of time. So obviously, since we will have a base cargo coming from anchor customers as per their requirement, we'll be doing it, setting up those facilities, and we'll top it up with a third -party cargo.

So as JSW Steel, overall, you can take a number of say, INR15,000 crores to INR20,000 crores is the inbound and outbound logistics costs. So as we said, even if we are able to take a part of that, even if 25% also we are able to take, so that is a good number, which this logistic arm can consider in this INR8,000 crores revenue.

Kunal Shah: And secondly, you briefly highlighted upon this with respect to the investments in Navkar Corp but it's quite strategically located to your Dolvi facility and your end consumers. Now is there a chance that -- I mean, just trying to understand what would be the quantum of investment into this particular entity because it's a separately listed entity. Could you give any sort of flavor over here? And in case if the balance sheet is not supportive for such a big capex, could there be ICD from JSW Infra?

Rinkesh Roy: So here, let me put things in perspective. Here, the growth strategy that Navkar we are looking at is getting -- generating better efficiencies at the existing terminals. That is number one.

Number two is kind of utilizing the space available and the land available to create more capacity and spread. And thirdly is leveraging the group cargo to generate new circuits. So where you can, again, on the return flow, capture new customers. So this is a part of a bigger strategy that we are looking at. And the investments are primarily in more of movable assets, which can be leased also.

So you may not have a capex of purchasing a rake, you can lease a rake also. So this would be broadly the strategy that we are following. And if you look at what we have done at Navkar, earlier Navkar used to have 9 rigs -- 8 rigs. And currently, we have jumped it up to now 11 rigs through leasing. So the capacity of Navkar is being increased through various strategies.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Ankit Shah from Elara Capital.

Ankit Shah: Just one question, sir, on the hedging cost. So what is our total exposure? And is this hedged at the quarter end date and this will be done every quarter?

Lalit Singhvi: Forex exposure, you mean to say Ankita? So this -- we have 1 bond of \$400 million, another \$120 million is another loan, which we have taken for funding our UAE terminal. So there, in JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 2025

Page 15 of 17

any case revenue and expenses are in dollars only. So for this \$400 million, we have enough dollar income with us. So there is a natural hedge.

If you look at our profile, that VRC charges are paid in dollars, our 17% to 18% of our total revenue is in dollar denomination. So we are dollar surplus. So we follow hedge accounting as per IFRS and based on that, the part of that will come to OCI and part comes to the P&L. So that is accounting, which we follow, and this is basically a noncash entry.

Ankit Shah: Got it. So do you do this on this \$400 million of exposure?

Lalit Singhvi: Absolutely. Absolutely, yes.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Koundinya Nimmagadda from Jefferies.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Only one question, sorry for harping on the margin part. I mean you spoke about roughly 25% kind of margin from the logistics side. And on that basis, if you still need a 50% plus kind of margins, logistics should not be more than maybe 25%, 30% -- 20%, 25% of your business, which should warrant about 6x to 8x rise in your ports revenue growth vis-a-vis about 2x to 2.5x

rise in the capacity. So can you help me understand this math, sir. How are you confident of you still maintainin g this margin profile at 50% plus?

Lalit Singhvi: See, as I said that our margin profile is set to increase because all the investment what we are contemplating is towards greenfield port, where the margins are 65% to 70%. And capacity is being increased f rom 174 million to 400 million. So one is your growth of the cargo itself. Second is the margin profile will go to 65%, 70% types in the port business.

So this -- and if you look at the revenue of port business, it will be much higher what we stand today. So even at INR8,000 crores of, say, port terminal business, which will give 25% of EBITDA, our margin profile of -- combined margin profile will still i ncrease from th

e current level.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Sir, let me ask it differently, by FY '30, where do you think you'll confine your logistics business revenue to as a percentage of total mix?

Vishesh Pachnanda : Sorry, come again?

Koundinya Nimmagadda: So I was asking at INR8,000 crores revenue from your logistics business, I mean, what would that be as a percentage of total revenue that you are targeting?

Vishesh Pachnanda : See, the way we are looking at it is our port business is different, right? So w e have given guidance from 170 million to 400 million tons. It is 2.4x in cargo. So which is also 15% CAGR. If cargo is 15%, obviously, the volume because the profile is also changing, we will be into liquids, we will be into containers.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 202 5

Page 16 of 17

So the profile wi ll also switch and hence, the revenue CAGR would be north of 20% to 22%.

Logistics is altogether a different ball game, where we have given total revenue of INR8,000 crores and then EBITDA margin of 25%. So this has to be seen separately and then A plus B.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Eshwar Arumugam from lthought PMS .

Eshwar Arumugam: Most of the questions have already been answered. But I do have two more. So from the synergistic benefits you see from the logistics business and the shipping business, how much do you expect the shipping growth to be more than the broader market growth -- JSW growth?

Lalit Singhvi: So you are talking about the port business in JSW Infra?

Eshwar Arumugam: Because of -- you are projecting a 22% growth be cause of a change in mix, like you're getting into liquid and you are getting into containers, how much more growth can you expect because of gain in market share for example?

Lalit Singhvi: Market share, we will always be ahead of the growth in the port s ector. As we said, port sector is much lower growth of -- it may be like GDP types of growth. But we will be growing much faster backed by our own strength of the anchor customer, which is already growing by, say, 15% CAGR, then from the privatization of t he major ports terminals, which will further give us the growth to us because we'll be very aggressive in securing those terminals as we are the largest concession holders in India and our regular natural growth. So all put together, cargo growth would be there.

And secondly, our EBITDA margins are slated to go higher because we are going much into our private ports where the EBITDA margins are much higher, 65%, 70%. Then we are going into the liquid where the margins are like 85% type of things, which we are -- right now, our UAE terminal is giving that much of margins. And then future, we are looking at the container also that with Murbe coming in, we'll go to the container side also. So all put together will give us a good revenue CAGR growth.

Eshwar Arumugam: So how much would be the margin for the container business?

Lalit Singhvi: The container business will give the similar type of growth, which we are getting at these ports, private ports. It is 60%, 65% type.

Eshwar Arumugam: And is there any plan to merge Navkar into JSW Infra?

Lalit Singhvi: No, at the moment, we are not contemplating any this type of structure. So , as and when we have anything, we will come back to you.

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Mr. Eshwar Arumugam, if you have any further questions, please rejoin the queue. The last question is from the line of Vaibhav Shah from JM Financial Limited.

Vaibhav Shah: Sir, what kind of capex plans are we looking for the next three years, FY '25, '26 and '27? And of that, what would be i n the port business and what would be in the logistics business?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

January 28, 202 5

Page 17 of 17

Lalit Singhvi: So port business for the next three years, we are looking around INR15,000 crores of investment. And for logistics busine

ss, INR1,000 crores is already spent and we might invest, say, another INR3,000 crores or so during the next three years.

Vaibhav Shah: Do you mean '26 to '28 or '25 to '27?

Rinkesh Roy: If you see the figures, we have to spend around -- we're looking at spending around INR8,000 crores in the next five years including the INR1,100 crores we have spent to pick up Navkar. So broadly in line with that, it would roughly translate to around INR2,000 to INR2,200 crores per annum. But it will vary depending on the various needs and opportunities that come up.

Vaibhav Shah: Sir, so INR15,000 crores mentioned for the ports business that is over FY '25 to '27 or '26 to '28?

Rinkesh Roy: Mostly the ports that we are looking at...

Lalit Singhvi: FY '28, we said by FY '28, we'll be spending this INR15,000 crores.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that brings us to the end of the question -and-answer session. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for the closing remarks.

Rinkesh Roy: I wanted to thank you all for your very lively and active participation, and we look forward to regular interactions with you apart from these investor calls. And I hope we'll be coming out with more better results in the years to come. Thank you.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you all.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, that brings us to the end of the conference. On behalf of ICICI Securities Limited, you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2025

Page 1 of 15

"JSW Infrastructure Limited
Q4 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call "
April 30 , 202 5

MANAGEMENT : MR. RINKESH ROY – MANAGING DIRECTOR AND
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JSW Infrastructure Limited
April 30, 202 5

Page 2 of 15

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the JSW Infrastructure Limited Conference Call hosted by Nuvama Institutional Equities. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen -only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Achal Lohade: Thank you. On behalf of Nuvama Institutional Equities, we welcome you all to the Q4 FY '25 Earnings Conference Call of JSW Infrastructure Limited. To discuss the results today, we have with us Mr. Rinkesh Roy, Jt. Managing Director and CEO; Mr. Lalit Singhvi, Whole -Time Director and CFO; and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda, Head, Investor Relations. Without much delay, I'll now hand over the call to the management to start with brief opening remarks, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Rinkesh Roy: Thank you, Achal. I'm Rinkesh. Good evening, and thank you all for joining our earnings call for the quarter and the year ended 31st March 2025. The overall global growth landscape is marked by uncertainty leading to significant volatility across business environments, financial markets, commodity markets, supply chains and capital flows.

Despite global challenges, India has remained one of the fastest -growing major economies, supported by robust domestic demand, a stable monetary policy and a focus on infrastructure development. Government initiatives aimed at enhancing manufacturing logistics are generating new opportunities across various sectors, including ours.

The government is undertaking significant measures to enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of the logistics sector. Both Central and State Governments are collaborating to increase the nation's total port handling capacity from the current 2,700 million tonnes per annum to 3,500 million tonnes per annum by 2030 and 10,000 million tonnes by 2047.

In line with this vision, the involvement of private players is being progressively expanded through PPP terminals. Major ports in India, which are owned by the Central Government account for over 50% of the country's port capacity with a substantial portion yet to be privatized. This presents a tremendous opportunity for a business enterprise like ours to leverage and expand our operations.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 3 of 15

I want to

emphasize that JSW's Infrastructure business remains largely unaffected by the current trade uncertainties. However, we are diligently monitoring the evolving trends and emerging developments to ensure they are appropriately addressed in relation to our business model.

Looking ahead, we remain optimistic about the future and confident in our ability to navigate these challenges while seizing new opportunities for growth. As communicated earlier, I will continue to focus on my top 3 priorities. Number one, to ensure the advancement and successful completion of our expansion plan to 400 million tonnes per annum by financial year 2030 or before, encompassing greenfield, brownfield and other growth projects within the stipulated time and budget.

Number two, to significantly scale up the Logistics business segment, targeting a top line of INR8,000 crores by FY '30 and an EBITDA margin approaching 25%. The objective is to expand the business on an asset-light model to achieve an industry-leading return on capital employed.

And number three, to continuously seek out value-accretive inorganic opportunities. In that respect, FY '25 was a year of strategic progress for us and achieving various milestones for our company. We have made significant progress in the journey towards the completion of our expansion projects to reach a capacity of 400 million tonnes by FY 2030 or before.

Now, specifically on the developments during the quarter. At Tuticorin and JNPA, we have received approval from the relevant authorities to begin interim operations. Consequently, we have handled approximately 0.9 million tonnes and 0.1 million tonnes, respectively, this quarter. Following the timely completion of the construction of the Covershed at South West Port Goa, I'm pleased to announce that the cargo handling capacity at Southwest Port has increased from 8.5 million tonnes per annum to 11 million tonnes per annum. This has resulted in the company's total capacity increasing from 174 million to 177 million tonnes per annum.

Further approvals have been sought to increase the total capacity of the Goa terminal to 15 million tonnes. We have successfully completed the acquisition of the slurry pipeline and signed a long-term take-or-pay agreement with JSW Steel. Currently, 180 km out of the 302 km pipeline work has been completed, and we are on schedule to finish the construction by March '27.

Moving on to the operational and financial performance. For the year '25, the total cargo handled stood at 117 million tonnes. This is a 9% year-on-year growth. Third-party cargo grew by 34% year-on-year to 57.3 million tonnes and the share of third-party increased to 49% in the overall mix, a jump from 40% a year ago.

Total revenue for the year ended March '25 stood at INR4,829 crores, reflecting a growth of 20% year-on-year. Total EBITDA for the period stood at INR2,615 crores, which is a 17% year-on-year growth and net profit for the period was INR1,521 crores, a growth of 31%. The Board has recommended the dividend of INR0.80 per share, representing 40% of the face value.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 4 of 15

With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi, our CFO, to take us through the financials and other details.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you, Rinkesh, and good evening, everyone. Let me first talk about our Port business. In Q4 FY '25, the company handled cargo volumes of 31.2 million tonnes as compared to 29.9 million tonnes in our quarter ended March '24. The 5% increase -- volume increase was primarily driven by the robust coal demand in the coal terminals at Mangalore, Ennore, and Paradip and was also fueled by the start of interim operations at Tuticorin Terminal and JNPA Liquid Terminal. The growth was partially offset by the lower cargo volumes in the iron ore terminal at Paradip.

Third -party cargo has incre

ased to 15.5 million tonnes from 14 million tonnes , representing 11% growth and share of third -party volumes stood at 50% versus 47% a year ago. The growth in cargo volume and the change in volume mix resulted in a 5% increase in operational revenue for the Port segment for the quarter from INR1,096 crores in FY '24 to INR1,152 crores in FY '25. Operational EBITDA for the Port segment stood at INR626 crores from INR581 crores, an increase of 8%. The EBITDA growth was largely driven by the increased revenue.

We have consolidated Navkar Corporation Financial in the previous quarter with effect from October 11, '24. The total consolidated revenue of the company stood at INR1,372 crores and total EBITDA stood at INR730 crores, reflecting a year -on-year growth of 14% and 7%, respectively.

Consolidated depreciation was INR140 crores and finance cost was INR94 crores in the current quarter as compared to INR134 crores and INR75 crores, respectively, in the quarter ended March '24. Given the changes in INR and subsequent changes in the yield curve, we have recognized a mark -to-market unrealized gain of INR86 crores, and this is essentially a non -cash charge and in line with the guidelines of Ind -AS 109.

As a result, profit before tax for the quarter ended March '25 stood at INR581 crores as compared to INR417 crores in the quarter ended March '24. PAT for the current quarter grew by 57% at INR516 crores as compared to INR329 crores in the same period last year.

During FY '25, the company undertook capital expenditure amounting to INR2,444 crores, which was directed towards the acquisition of slurry pipeline as well as towards various ongoing and new projects. In addition, during the year, company successfully completed the acquisition of Navkar Corporation at an enterprise value of INR1,596 crores.

For FY '26, the company plans to invest approximately INR5,500 crores with a significant portion around INR4,000 crores allocated towards the Port business and INR1,500 crores earmarked for the Logistics segment. As of March '25, we have net debt of INR1,471 crores with a net debt to operating EBITDA of 0.65 and one of the strongest balance sheet in the sector. This, coupled with steadily increasing annual operating cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue a growth plan to enhance our present cargo handling capacity

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 5 of 15

to 400 million tonnes and certainly grow our Logistics business with a top line of INR8,000 crores by FY 2030.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. We will now begin with the question and answer session. The first question comes from the line of Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities.

Mohit Kumar: My question is, with the government looking to free up the pricing for existing concession, what do you make of the draft proposal?

Rinkesh Roy: So, we have been in agreement with this, and we have been pursuing along with all other associations that this comes to fruition very quickly because this is with the evolution of TAMP , the regulation on prices should have also been removed.

Mohit Kumar: So, this is -- broadly it is as per industry liking the adjustments on the revenues and formula which you have agreed as per the adjustments?

Rinkesh Roy: No, it is -- you see finally in the end analysis the -- although the pricing is free, you can only charge up to what the customer or the market can bear. It's not something that it's for the industry to charge exorbitant rates because there are -- most of the port sector, the companies have 2 port solutions. So that I don't think will be a major issue that people will be pricing themselves very exorbitantly.

Mohit Kumar: Understood. Sir, my second question is, can you please explain the nature of investment in Logistics business of I

NR15 billion, which you have earmarked for FY '26?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes. So, there is, I know -- we have acquired Navkar and Navkar also, they have not invested in last 2 years. So, we see lot of low -hanging fruit. So we will be investing -- Board has approved around INR170 crores to be spent in Navkar. Then we are looking to -- as per our plan of INR9,000 crores, we have spelt out. We are increasing -- we are placing some orders for the rakes .

So, that would be a substantial investment, what we are looking around INR600 crores in that. And then there are GCTs and there are some acquisition possibilities, which we are right now working. So all put together, we are looking at INR1,500 crores to be spent during this year.

Mohit Kumar: Understood. Last question, sir, on the volume, especially Dharamtar and Jaigarh, I think they are flattish for the last couple of years. Is it fair to assume that we'll see some growth in FY '26 ?

Rinkesh Roy: See, as we said earlier also, at our -- these locations, we are depending on the group cargo, and

group cargo, we will have a growth -- lumpy growth. So, they are running at a particular capacity so till the new capacities come in, we will remain at the same level. So it was little subdued last year, but it is almost stable. You can say that the cargo will remain there. So our growth is coming from third -party cargo.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 6 of 15

So '27, '28, we are expecting quantum jump and both these steel plants, still we have capacity from 10 million to 15 million tonnes . And that will give benefit of, say, around 12 million to 15 million tonnes at our Dharamtar and Jaigarh ports. So, if you take all this together, the growth would be quite good on a CAGR basis. But if you see on year -on-year basis, it will remain stable.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Priyankar Biswas from BNP Paribas Exane.

Priyankar Biswas: Sir, can you provide some guidance or color if you can, let's say, what sort of cargo volumes we can expect in F Y '26 and potentially what sort of logistics revenue you will be targeting to clock in FY '26?

Rinkesh Roy : So, broadly, we are looking at a 10% growth in Port volumes and the revenue in the Logistics business, we are looking at around 50% growth.

Priyankar Biswas: So 50% growth is at the entire logistics, not just Navkar, so total?

Rinkesh Roy : Total.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay. And sir, one more thing that a lot of our growth outlook is also -- so a more future growth when it comes, it also is, hinges on berth privatization at major ports. So, are there anything we are seeing in the near -term pipeline? So, let's say, next 1 year?

Rinkesh Roy: So, already 2 expression of interest have come out. One at Kolkata Port, one recently at Paradip. So this, we are expecting this process to be speeded up in the coming months.

Priyankar Biswas: So, any idea of what can be the sizes of this, like if we have to factor in?

Rinkesh Roy: Broadly, we are looking at concessions coming out in the range of -- at least 30 million to 40 million tonnes per annum in the -- on a per annum basis in the next 1 or 2 years.

Priyankar Bis was: And just one last question from my side. So, in the fourth quarter, just like in the previous year, was there any take -or-pay type of revenues? And also, can you also give the ESOP charges in FY '25 and possibly what you see in FY '26?

Lalit Singhvi : Yes. So, like every -- last quarter, whatever the take -or-pay quantities are assessed and then revenue is earned. So in this quarter also for our LNG berth at Jaigarh Port, so revenue was booked on the take -or-pay basis. On the ESOP charging, again, the co st in this year was much lower compared to last year, as we said earlier. So it was lower by INR20 crores in Q4.

Priyankar Biswas: And would there be any charges in FY '26 ESOP?

Lalit Singhvi : So FY '26 wil

I be just INR25 crores. For the full year. So now it is -- almost everything is already charged off.

Priyankar Biswas: And sir, at Jaigarh, can give that take -or-pay quantum if it's possible. That's the last question.

Lalit Singhvi : It's around INR80 crores.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 7 of 15

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

Alok Deora: So, just had a few questions. First is on the port side. So, this iron ore volumes particularly have been lower even in this quarter, which it was the same thing in the last quarter as well. So where do we see that going for Paradip iron ore volumes because that's coming at around 2 million tonnes .

Rinkesh Roy: So, during the last quarter, if you remember, when we had spoken that time, Vedanta mines had not come on stream. So they have n ow come on stream. So -- and there were issues on pellet exports because of low prices. So this will be a slightly volatile market. We'll not be able to kind of exactly predict the nature of this because primarily a large part of this mov ement is for the export market.

So, we will be watching the trends. But broadly, right now, there is some demand that we have seen that most of the forecasts are for \$100 of pricing, which is a good enough pricing for movement of iron ore.

Alok Deora: Sure. And sir, you started your comments with about global uncertainty and challenges in supply chain and -- so, how do we see the movement in volume shaping up ahead? I mean you also mentioned about the 10% growth in cargo volume for FY '26. So is that like a base case scen ario or could there be any downside or upside risk to that number? Just wanted your thoughts on that?

Rinkesh Roy: So broadly, if you see, we cater to steel, energy and others. This is our broad mix of cargo

handling. In steel, if you see, most of the movement is for domestic use, except for some quantity that moves at Paradip. So, our impression is that with the duty safeguards also coming in for steel imports, we foresee that the steel market will be doing well. So, on the cargo front, we have nothing to fear there.

On the energy front, we are seeing that there is a huge demand for energy and coal being the primary base for that. So there also, we are not foreseeing any major change. And lastly, on containers, we have a very small exposure to -- at Mangal ore, and that is also, if you see the trend of traffic there is primarily to South Africa or the Middle East. So we really don't foresee much of challenge in this uncertainty. And that is what I had pointed out that we are pretty confident on this guidance that we have given.

Lalit Singhvi: So, 10% guidance is on a conservative basis only, and it is -- no way it will affect with the current tariff issues which are going on. So it is a very conservative guidance. So I don't foresee any issue in that.

Alok Deora: Got it, sir. Just one last question. So in the logistics business, I mean, we are incurring losses at this point primarily due to Navkar consolidation. So how do we see this moving ahead in terms of -- you mentioned about the revenue being 50% higher in '26. How do we see the profitability moving, because we have taken it now and it's been almost 2 quarters? Have we got the synergies

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 8 of 15

getting in place now or our expertise getting into that or it will take some time before we kind of turn also profitable?

Lalit Singhvi: See, we have just finished 6 months. So, we see lot of opportunities in the logistics sector and Navkar will certainly do well. In fact, whatever was their accounting practices and our practices, there were certain cleaning up required, certain provisioning were required. This is all one-time, which has all been done with this current year ending.

So, their normalized EBITDA

A, if you look at it, it was anyway INR50 crores, INR55 crores. So, because of this cleaning up, they ended with sort of a INR10 crores EBITDA. And with -- now, since we have aggressive plans for logistics sector, we are looking for 50% plus revenue growth. And EBITDA will also have a quantum jump from the normalized EBITDA, which I talked about. So we see a lot of scope going there and our overall logistics play in which there are a lot more things to happen, so Navkar will also get synergy of that.

Rinkesh Roy: We are looking at, at least an EBITDA of INR100 crores at Navkar in the current financial year.

Lalit Singhvi: So, with 50% revenue increase and EBITDA levels -- from normalized EBITDA, it may go almost double. So lots of opportunities are there in the logistics sector.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities.

Achal Lohade: Sir, just wanted to understand, for achieving this INR8,000 crores revenue in logistics, what kind of capital employed are you looking at? What kind of further capex are we looking at?

Lalit Singhvi: So, Logistics, we have set a plan that we'll be spending, say, INR9,000 crores overall in 5 years, INR1,000 crores almost spent. And this year, we are contemplating to spend another INR1,500 crores. So our plan is by FY '30, we'll have INR8,000 crores of revenue with INR2,000 crores of EBITDA. And we see this happening with the -- with current year itself, we are exploring certain opportunities will start giving EBITDA from the current year itself.

Achal Lohade: Right. And in terms of the time line for the greenfield project, if you could just highlight how are they tracking, what stage of approval are we for each these? Can you set...

Rinkesh Roy: The major projects like let us say, Jaigarh and Dharamtar expansion, they are already on track and work -- civil works have already started at both places. Similarly, JNPA liquid terminal, we should be looking at commissioning it by July, August this year. So we are on track there. At Tuticorin, we are looking at doing it -- Tuticorin, we are looking at completion by Q4 of FY '26. Mangalore container terminal expansion, again, we are on track. We should be doing it by Q2 of '27. Goa, as I told you, it's completed. LPG terminal at Jaigarh targeting by June '26. And Keni Port already, we are looking at applying for the regulatory clearances from environment. Jatadhar, the concession agreement should be signed by this quarter.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 9 of 15

And we should look at completion by March '27. And slurry pipeline also, it's -- as I told you, it's going on around 200-plus kilometers have been welded, 180 has been lowered, and we look at its completion by March '27. So these are the major projects which were supposed to come up before March '27. So we are more or less on track on these projects.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And can you just clarify a little bit with respect to this 10% volume growth? How

much are you building from the third parties and how much would be captive growth or captive could be more -- group cargo could be more flattish?

Rinkesh Roy: So here, our growth, we are looking at -- you see the interim operations at these 2 terminals at JNPT and Tuticorin, this will be giving us around 50% of that growth. The rest 50% will come from better utilization of capacities, primarily at Paradip coal terminal and at Goa. So the -- as was told by our CFO also that since the capacity expansion at Dolvi steel plant is from 10 to 15 will be the place where we'll have a lumpy growth.

Lalit Singhvi : So the rest all will remain more or less at similar levels. So next year's third -party cargo will obviously further increase from the current level of 50% because most of the growth is coming from third -party in the next year's plan.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And just 1 l

ast question. With respect to -- there were certain media articles about the green energy projects, which we are looking at. If you could elaborate a little bit on that? So what kind of processes and what kind of capital can we see deploying there?

Lalit Singhvi : So, at Jaigarh Port, we are looking at these opportunities and a lot of -- there is a lot of interest from various companies to set up green ammonia type of stuff. So we are very keen. And once we have something here, we can always plan to have it in Keni also. So things are being seen by the various interested parties. And as soon as something materialize, we'll keep media updated.

Achal Lohade: So is it fair to say that whatever capex we'll do it will be obviously basis the customer's needs? So it's not that we'll set up capacity and wait for the customer. Have I understood...

Lalit Singhvi : No, no, we are not setting up. We are just enablers. This gives business to the port.

Rinkesh Roy : Better utilization of our waterfront is what we'll be looking at.

Achal Lohade: Understood. Any material capex is not expected on these counts, is that right?

Rinkesh Roy: No. Unless there is a guaranteed traffic that we see. Otherwise, we are not looking at it.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital.

Ankita Shah: Sir, only 1 question on margins. Given that the mix is going to change, also you're expecting improvement in the logistics segment. So how is margins expected to pan out in FY '26 -'27, given that our port expansion is going to be more back -ended? So how the consolidated margins expected to pan out?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 10 of 15

Lalit Singhvi: See, now we have to look at the segment reporting. So port margins will remain, say, around 52% or so. And our logistics, we are aiming around 15% margin. So we'll have to see separately.

If you look at the combined one, it has to come down because logistics will always be like this.

And we are looking at over a longer period of time, even logistics margins going up to 25%.

-- but currently, if you look at immediately, which is 12%, 13%, it will go to 15% by next year.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Koundinya Nimmagadda from Jefferies Group.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Sir, a couple of questions from my end. Firstly, on the third -party volumes, I mean, you did speak about FY '26, but on a sustainable basis, what should be the growth that we could -- we can look at it over here maybe? Because, I mean, till 9 months we saw strong growth with addition of new ports and then this quarter it's only 11%. So on a sustainable basis, what is the number that we can look at it over here? If you can also briefly touch base upon the key industries that drive this growth? That's the first question.

Rinkesh Roy: Okay. So here, basically, if you see the growth that we are looking at in '26, 70% of it will be primarily from third -party, 30% will be group. So that is what will be the ratio in the coming...

Lalit Singhvi: The incremental growth.

Rinkesh Roy: Incremental, that is from 117 to another 10% that we're looking at. And in the long -term basis, we -- between -- till the Dolvi plant expansion comes on stream, you will be having a higher percentage of third -party vis -a-vis the group cargo. And once it comes on stream and the other projects like slurry pipeline, Jatadhar are coming on stream, you will be broadly seeing a movement back towards more of group cargo. So that will be kind of varying in the range of 55% to 45%. In this range, it will be moving up and down as and when the projects get commissioned.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Sir, can you speak a little bit about the catchment area or the industries that will give you this growth over here because adding port is 1 part and then getting volumes through for that port is a different thing, right? So t

hat's where I was trying to understand?

Rinkesh Roy: So, primarily, if you see the government is now promoting something called rail -cum-sea route movement of coastal cargo, especially for energy needs across India. So there, the key getaway, energy getaway for coal is Paradip. And that is where our Paradip terminal comes into play for the energy requirements across South India.

And now we're looking at Western India and North India as well. Similarly, iron ore catchment

area, the main mines are in Odisha. And if you would have seen our entire long-term strategy has also been to have a terminal at Paradip, as well as to add the slurry pipeline to Jatadhar to further augment and reduce transportation costs for every customer, including the group customer.

Then on the receiving side, we have Jaigarh, Dharamtar and Tuticorin is on the receiving side.

So these are agents and Ennore. So these are agents strategically located points, which are

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 11 of 15

serving mostly cement or energy plants. So both of which go hand-in-hand with the movement of steel.

So the moment the steel production and steel requirements go up, this also starts moving up. So broadly, if you see our terminals are very strategically located to ensure this volume growth, not only now, but also in the future.

Lalit Singhvi: So basically, if you see our terminals, most of them are running at a capacity of 80% to 100% capacity utilization. This is primarily because the location is like that, the interland is very nearby. They all developed. So we don't foresee any problem in getting cargo.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Understood, sir. Very clear. Sir, my second question is on the logistics front. So we have this large plans of INR8,000-odd crores revenue and also taking up margins from 14%, 15% currently to 25%-odd.

So I'm just trying to understand how do we plan to offer cost-effective logistics because ultimately, even for the end customer, it makes sense only if the logistics cost that we offer cost comparative vis-a-vis with our existing vendors with third-party vendors even if it's JSW Steel. So how do we intend to offer this logistics solutions also at cost-effective level and also increase the margins for us?

Rinkesh Roy: So I'll just give you 1 example that we are looking at strategizing this growth in an asset-light model. So our main targets are getting into Gati Shakti terminals where we don't have to spend a huge capex on building the railway sidings or purchasing land on -- at very expensive rates. So that is the first part of it is the terminal capexes, we are looking at a way lower than what the industry generally does.

Number two, we are looking at powering these terminals through group cargo wherever they are available. And this through a combination of rates, additional containers and new terminals, which move into the right market.

Lastly, we are looking at reducing the empty return ratio of this rate so that on return, we get third-party cargo and other cargo so that the entire model sees to it that we are able to reduce the final cost for the customer.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Understood, sir. The last one bookkeeping question. When can we pencil in this 15 million ton net per annum for Goa 1Q FY '26? Or will it be further delayed from that?

Rinkesh Roy: We'll -- already, as I told you from 8.5 million to 11 million, we have already done. And this is a part of a process. And hopefully, this should be done in the next 2 quarters at least.

Koundinya Nimmagadda: Two quarters. Sure, sir.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 12 of 15

Aditya Mongia: I'll go ahead with my questions. The first one I pick up is on logistics. I think we talked about the INR600 crores plus kind of quant

um the country for this segment on rates and it's kind of compared to what CONCOR does on a regular basis. Just trying to get a sense, is this more domestic kind of business that you are trying to set up on the logistics front kind of ties in with your strategy...

Lalit Singhvi: Absolutely. This is domestic growth would be much higher what we have planned in next year in Navkar.

Aditya Mongia: Yes. So these rates that you are going to kind of get will be used for the domestic business, right, more than EXIM, right?

Rinkesh Roy: Yes.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. The second question that I had was more on Dolvi. I wanted to get a sense from you that post it becoming 15 million tonnes of capacity and that's giving us a fairly solid growth in fiscal '28. Is there scope to grow the asset further from there? Because -- or would the same thing happen again that you will scale up a volume in a single year and then the growth may taper off?

Rinkesh Roy: Okay. So there at Dolvi, you are -- I think it will be moving in tandem with the expansion. So

after that, it will be always a lumpy growth. One time it will come and after that it will start stabilizing at that. There's no other magic that can be done to get something extra there.

Aditya Mongia: Yes. So essentially, the question was that, beyond 15 million tonnes, can that asset grow at all? Is there a limitation to where it stands because, obviously...

Lalit Singhvi : No, I understood your question. So when we reach to 10 million, it was very difficult to think of going to 15 million. So we have reached 15 million. So there is always a possibility that because this brownfields are always easier to implement, cost-effective, as well as time-wise also, greenfield is always difficult. So there could always be a possibility of going further from 15 million also.

Vishesh Pachnanda : And just to add, Aditya, when this plant was acquired by the anchor customer in 2011 or '12, it was 2 million tonnes and a lot of people questioned at that time whether it will go to 5 million. And now then it went to 10 million and now it is progressing to 15 million. So things turn out, there will be land acquisition nearby and the things kind of change. So right now, for recasting what will be the figure is difficult for us.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Could you also share the ports revenues and EBITDA for the full year and its comparison versus last year? This makes it easier to compare numbers because logistics coming inside of otherwise.

Lalit Singhvi : So if you look at FY '25, so you want to look at the port sector. So port sector, if you look at quarter-on-quarter, you're looking at YTD.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 13 of 15

Aditya Mongia: Yes, for the FY '25 would do. Yes.

Lalit Singhvi : So FY '25, as I said, throughput is 9% increase. Revenue -- total revenue we talk is 13% increase. EBITDA is 15% increase. Operational EBITDA is 14% increase, PBT is 25% increase and PAT is 33% increase.

Vishesh Pachnanda: And just to add, it's also given on Page 12 of our investor presentation, you will have financial performance for ports for the quarter, as well as full year.

Aditya Mongia: Maybe a final question. This was asked earlier. So just trying to get a little bit more color. So JNPT and Tuticorin's could contribute how much in the full year next year? Would it be a 5 million tonne plus number that one should be expecting?

Lalit Singhvi : Yes, certainly, it's exceeding that.

Aditya Mongia: About 5 million, 6 million tonnes should easily come from these assets, right?

Lalit Singhvi : Yes, sure.

Aditya Mongia: That clarifies. And maybe the last final thing over here. When you say 50% increase in logistics, I am assuming over a full year number of INR400-plus crores, right, is the guidance?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, full year number is around INR485 crores. So from there, we are looking 50% increase.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Ketan Jain from Avendus Spark.

Ketan Jain: Yes. Sir, I had a question. So recently in February, we read a news article saying that there is infrastructure plans to enter into airports, probably buying a stake in some airport in Bengal.

What is this about, sir?

Lalit Singhvi : So this was just a discussion stage at some platform in West Bengal this was (#line was cut)

Mohit Kumar : Thanks for the opportunity once again. So my question is, can you please help us with the update on the expansion of steel plant in Dharamtar? Is it fair to assume that the steel plant will come by March '27 or Q1 FY '28?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, yes. So this is scheduled for March '27. On the conservative side, we are talking about September '27, but work is progressing well. So we will be ready from port side by March '27 in any case. So we hope that we'll get full year. Otherwise, if it's something a few months here and there, to that extent, it might be different.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Ketan Jain.

Ketan Jain: My question was on the airport, sir?

Moderator: Sorry to interrupt, Ketan. Could you be a little louder, please?

JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 14 of 15

Ketan Jain: Sir, my question was on the airport thing in Bengal you are answering.

Lalit Singhvi : Yes. So, see, being a large group, there are many proposals keep coming. So we have not evaluated anything on the airport or not in discussion on the Board. So, if there is any such things, if we decide, we will certainly go for -- then inform the media or investors. But at the moment, there is no such proposal or no such discussion. This was something came up and it was stopped. So nothing has progressed on that.

Ketan Jain: Understood. Sir, also, can you provide me with adjusted PBT and PAT numbers for 4Q and FY '25?

Vishesh Pachnanda: Ketan, we can connect off -line. I'll give you the adjusted numbers. Is that fine?

Ketan Jain: Yes, yes. Okay. Fine. Not a problem. And sir, just 1 last question. As you said, we've expanded on the Goa capacity. So do we see a growth in volumes in FY '26, more than say 5% at Goa?

Rinkesh Roy: Yes. We have told you that it will be -- Goa will be a part of the growth in this year.

Lalit Singhvi: Goa, we have been always 100% capacity utilization we have seen because there is no doubt of cargo there being the cheapest cost option for Vijayanagar. So we expect similar trend for the -
- whatever the 11 million tonnes they have -- now we have got the approval. So this should be near to that.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Veenit from Investec.

Veenit: Yes. Sir, a few months back, there have been media articles around JSW Group entering into other type of metals, including copper. How that can help JSW Group, JSW Infra, in particular?

What opportunities would lie there if we were to tap into?

Lalit Singhvi : So it's quite far today, the JSW Group is contemplating for going for copper, but how much capacity and all those things. So, as and when they come up, if there's a nearest port, if they are nearest port, definitely, we will have an opportunity to add that cargo into our port.

Veenit: Understood. And sir, what could be the ratio of input to output? For instance, in case of steel, we require anywhere around 2.5 million, 3 million tonnes of input in form of iron ore and coal.

What will that ratio be in terms of input to output?

Lalit Singhvi : No. We have not gone in that -- those details as of now. So as and when there is a concrete proposal, we'll certainly come back to you.

Moderator: The next question comes from the line of Nikhil Rungta from LIC Mutual Funds.

Nikhil Rungta Sir, I just have 1 question on Navkar. Sir, you mentioned like you'll be investing around INR170 crores this year. And on the sales side, 50% growth, EBITDA of

INR100 crores at least. But one

of the statements which you made was next year, you have much bigger plans for Navkar. So if JSW Infrastructure Limited

April 30, 2025

Page 15 of 15

I have to look from 2 to 3 years perspective, what type of CAGR can we look at and on the revenue side and the EBITDA side?

Lalit Singhvi: No, no. When I said next year we'll go big, this is basically on the overall logistics play. So, Navkar is a part of overall logistic play. So Navkar, we have given guidance of next year only.

We'll come back on further future years separately. But what we said when we'll invest INR1,500 crores, this will be a larger logistic play. As far as Navkar is concerned, we have -- Board has approved INR170 crores of investment as of today.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question for today. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments.

Rinkesh Roy: So thank you, gentlemen, for your time. And I'd like to conclude that despite all the uncertainty in the global market, we are very confident of the guidance given to you of 10% growth in port volumes and the logistics part of it, which is primarily internal. And we are very sure that we'll be meeting the guidance given for the year '26. Thank you, gentlemen.

Moderator: Thank you, sir. Ladies and gentlemen, on behalf of Nuvama Institutional Equities, that concludes this conference. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Jul 2025

Page 1 of 14

"JSW Infrastructure Q1 FY -26 Earnings Conference Call"

July 22, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RINKESH ROY – JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR & CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – WHOLE -TIME DIRECTOR AND CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD, INVESTOR RELATIONS , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
MODERATOR : MR. ACHAL LOHADE – NUVAMA INSTITUTIONAL EQUITIES

JSW Infrastructure
July 22, 2025

Page 2 of 14

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Moderator : Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Q 1 FY26 earnings conference call of JSW Infrastructure Limited hosted by Nuvama Institutional Equities.

As a reminder all participants' lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing '*' then '0' on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Achal Lohade from Nuvama Institutional Equities. Thank you and over to you, sir.

Achal Lohade : Thank you. Good evening, everyone. We have with us Mr. Rinkesh Roy – Joint Managing Director and CEO, Mr. Lalit Singhvi – Whole-time Director and CFO, and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda – Head, Investor Relations.

Without much delay, I will now handover the call to the management to start with a brief opening remarks, which will be followed by Q&A. Over to you, sir.

Rinkesh Roy : Thank you, Achal. Good evening and thank you all for joining our earnings call for the quarter ended 30th June 2025.

The global economy is in a phase of recalibration, facing subdued growth and rising

uncertainties. Recent US tariff hikes on key trade partners have disrupted investments and significantly impacted developing economies. Amid geopolitical tensions and shifting supply chains, India stands out for its resilience, stability and forward-looking economic approach. With inflation under control and fiscal consolidation progressing, India is well-positioned to achieve over 6.5% growth in FY26. Supporting this outlook, the RBI adopted an accommodative stance in June '25, cutting the repo rate by 50 basis points to 5.50%. Backed by easing inflation and strong fundamentals, this move is expected to boost liquidity, reduce borrowing costs and drive investment across sectors.

India's port sector remains central to its trade and infrastructure ambitions. In FY26, the government has ramped up efforts to privatize, modernize and expand port capacity while enhancing connectivity and digitizing operations.

At JSW Infrastructure, we are focused on scaling our cargo handling capacity from 177 million tonnes per annum to 400 million tonnes per annum by FY2030 or earlier, while building a strong pan-India logistics network. Growth will be further driven by opportunities such as privatization

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 3 of 14

of terminals at major ports and value-accretive inorganic expansions in port and related infrastructure.

As part of this strategy, we have secured a letter of award from the

Shyama Prasad Mukherjee

Port Authority for the redevelopment of Berth 8 and mechanization of Berth 7 and 8 at Netaji Subhash Dock, Kolkata, enhancing our container handling capacity.

In line with our logistics expansion goals, our resolution plan for NCR Rail Infrastructure Limited has been approved under the insolvency process and we have received a letter of intent from the resolution professional.

Regarding our growth project, progress at Keni Port continues as planned with a public hearing scheduled for August. On the 302 kilometers iron ore slurry pipeline project, 214 kilometers of welding and 192 kilometers of pipeline lowering have been completed. The project remains on track for completion by March '27. At Murbe Port, hydrographic and geotechnical studies have been successfully completed. The EIA report has been submitted for the process of public hearing. For the Jatadhar project, the anchor customer has signed the concession agreement, and the novation agreement is expected to be finalized shortly. Work on the JNPA Liquid Terminal is progressing well and we are confident of completing the project within this quarter.

Moving on to the operational and financial performance for the period April '25 to June '25, the total cargo handled stood at 29.4 million tonnes. This is a 5% year-on-year growth. This growth aligns with our historical trends where cargo volumes in the second half of the year typically exceed those in the first half. We remain on track to achieve annual guidance of 10% volume growth over the last year.

Our third-party cargo grew by 8% year-on-year to 15.3 million tonnes and the share of third-party stands at a record high of 52% in the overall mix from 50% a year ago.

Navkar Corporation has delivered an outstanding performance in the first quarter of FY26, highlighted by a strong recovery in operational volumes and a return to profitability.

Total revenue for the quarter stood at Rs. 1,314 crores, reflecting a growth of 19% year-on-year.

EBITDA for the period stood at Rs. 671 crores, which is a 10% year-on-year growth and net profit for the period was Rs. 390 crores, implying a 31% growth.

With this, let me hand over to Mr. Lalit Singhvi to take us through the financials and other details.

Lalit Singhvi: Thank you Rinkesh and good evening, everyone.

Let me first talk about our port business.

In Q1 FY26, the company handled cargo of 29.4 million tonnes as compared to 28.1 million tonnes in the quarter ended June '24. The 5% volume increase was primarily driven by strong

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 4 of 14

performance of coal handling operations at Ennore, PNP and Paradip. Robust performance at South West port and Dharamtar Port along with interim operations at the Tuticorin terminal and JNPT Liquid Terminal also contributed to the growth. The growth was partially offset by lower cargo volumes at Iron Ore terminal at Paradip and third-party volumes at Jaigarh port.

Third-party cargo has increased to 15.3 million tonnes from 14.1 million tonnes representing 8% growth and the share of third-party volumes stood at 52% versus 50% a year ago.

The growth in cargo volume and the change in volume mix resulted in an 8% increase in operational revenue for the port segment for the quarter from 1,010 crores in Q1 FY25 to Rs. 1,086 crores in Q1 FY26.

Operational EBITDA for the port segment stood at Rs. 561 crores , up from Rs. 515 crores an increase of 9%. The margin has improved to 51.7% from 51% a year ago.

Navkar Corporation delivered strong operational and financial results in Q1 FY26. Total EXIM cargo volume reached at 81,000 T EUs representing a robust growth of 31% year -on-year growth. Domestic cargo volume stood at 2,75,000 metric tonnes , up 11% compared to the same period last year.

The revenue from operations rose to Rs. 138 crores , reflecting a 17% in

crease year -on-year.

EBITDA climbed to Rs. 20 crores showing substantial improvement while net profit turned positive at Rs. 2 crores a significant turnaround from loss of 13 ye ars in the previous year following our recent acquisition.

Total consolidated revenue of the company stood at Rs. 1,314 crores and total EBITDA stood at Rs. 671 crores reflecting a year -on-year growth of 19% and 10% respectively. The EBITDA growth was lar gely driven by the increased revenue.

Consolidated depreciation was Rs. 143 crores and finance cost was Rs. 91 crores in the current quarter as compared to Rs. 135 crores and Rs. 74 crores respectively in the quarter ended June '24.

Given the changes in the INR and subsequent changes in the yield curve, we have recognized a mark -to-market unrealized gain of Rs. 36 crores. This is essentially a non -cash charge and in line with guidelines of Ind -AS 109.

As a result, profit before tax for the quarter ended June '25 stood at Rs. 473 crores as compared to Rs. 392 crores in the quarter ended June '24. P AT for the current quarter grew by 31% at Rs. 390 crores as compared to Rs. 297 crores in the same period last year.

The aggregate financial commitments across all growth projects encompassing awarded work orders and procurement of materials stand s at approximately Rs. 3,000 crores.

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 5 of 14

As of June '25, we have a Net Debt of Rs. 1,246 crores with net debt to operating EBITDA of 0.54x and this is on e of the strongest balance sheets in the sector. This coupled with steady growth , annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue a growth plan to enhance our present cargo handling capacity to 4 00 million tonnes and paralle l grow our logistic business with a top line of Rs. 8,000 crores by FY2030.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for questions. Thank you.

Moderator : Thank you very much. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. The first question is from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal. Please go ahead.

Alok Deora : Hello, sir. Good evening. Just a couple of questions. So, first is on the volume growth. So, it's been low single digit for us and we have guided for nearly 9 %-10% volume for this year. So, how do we see that number now shaping up because there will be a big catch up for in the remaining part of the year?

Rinkesh Roy: We still stand by our guidance of 10% for the entire year. And we are seeing very good trends also. So, we still stand firm on that guidance of 10%.

Lalit Singhvi : Alok, t ypically, if you see, our second half is always higher than the first half. If you see last year also and every year it is like this because the first half is a monsoon affected, and the seco nd half is always typically growth increases. So, we are fairly confident and the 2nd Quarter also starting July itself is showing a good trend. So, we are confident of covering up whatever the shortfall of the first half and the second half for sure.

Alok Deora: Got it. And, sir, this employee cost actually has come down quite sharply Q -o-Q and even Y-o-Y, just any color on that?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, you see that our ESOP charge that is continuously reducing. Quarter -on-quarter it is reducing. Most of the ESOP charges are already factored in. So, this quarter also if you see compared to last year is lower and again Q4 also is much lower. So, basically it is the employee cost including ESOP has come down.

Alok Deora : Okay. So, this going forward this number run rate could kind of continue.

Lalit Singhvi : Yes. So, this will not go up. In fact, this ESOP charge will further come down.

Alok Deora: Sure. Just last question. So, logistics business we saw around Rs. 131 crore s of growth last quarter and now it is around Rs. 138 crores . So, how we should see this number shaping up for this year and next ye

ar?

Rinkesh Roy: So, broadly we are looking at around Rs. 700 to 800 crores revenue in the entire year and we are looking at aro und Rs. 100 crores EBITDA for the year '26 and mostly our plans are in place and we are following those plans and we should be achieving these results.

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Alok Deora : Got it. I will come back in the queue for more questions. Thank you, sir. All the best.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Mohit Kumar: Good evening and thanks for the opportunity. My first question is on the volumes at Jaigarh and Dharamtar. The volume numbers have been continuously declining for the last 3 to 4 years, right?

In fact, we did 12.1 million tonnes in Q1 FY23, if my memory serves correctly. Last year we did 9.8 and this year again we are at 9.8. Despite the underlying steel production growth, especially in this quarter from JSW Steel at 6.5%. So, can you please explain this anomaly?

Lalit Singhvi: One is you see this, our group cargo as we discussed earlier also will always have a lumpy growth. Whenever the capacity additions come, then there will be a quantum jump. Till the capacity is same, so last few years you see capacity is almost similar and now it is going up and it is primarily serving to the Dolvi Steel plant if you look at Jaigarh and Dharamtar. So, Jaigarh - Dharamtar is serving to steel and it was almost steady. What you have seen decline was primarily due to the last quarter again there was some maintenance shutdowns in earlier period also, in this period also. But if you look at in current quarter, this Dharamtar has not gone down. There is a growth of 7% or so in the Dharamtar. It is only Jaigarh which has shown a little decline, which was primarily one is some third-party cargo also got reduced because MOP and this Urea one, last quarter government has not placed the orders and this is coming up in the subsequent quarter. And little bit of we are seeing that this growth of JSW Steel will cover it up. So, Q2 onwards you can see that they have now booked this iron ore import in a large vessel which can come only at Jaigarh. So, we are seeing that traction coming from July month itself. So, whatever is the shortfall will get covered in the Q2 onwards. So, we do not foresee there is any issue coming from our group cargo perspective.

Rinkesh Roy: If you broadly see this, if you put Jaigarh plus Dharamtar together, they have broadly been doing 43 to 46 million tonnes of cargo every year. That is the range at which it operates. And this year will be operating at the higher end of the range, we will be targeting around 45.8, 46 million tonnes.

Mohit Kumar: Understood, sir. Thank you for detailed answer. My second question on Kolkata Container Terminal. I think the entire Kolkata handles around 0.8 million TEU. And if I remember correctly, Kolkata has won 0.4 million TEU per container and Kolkata is looking to expand. I think it is in the process of bidding out another 0.9 million TEU. And I think a bid is due in the month of July or August. The question is, if the price discovery of Rs. 4,678 per TEU is very - very competitive given the hinterland potential. Can you please help us explain this price discovery and how do you see the volume coming at this port?

Rinkesh Roy: So, as you rightly pointed out that Kolkata, the other bids that will be coming up, you have already now got a base price here, whatever we quoted for the project earlier. So, we feel that it's a very competitive price, keeping in view that the other projects are going to come up. And if you understand Kolkata and that area better, most of the cargo is very sticky in nature that it JSW Infrastructure
July 22, 2025

serves the hinterland is very -very close to the port area. So, we don't foresee that with better

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efficiency is being brought into play and better turnaround of vessels at the port. With the port also looking at taking up new efficiency measures in increasing throughput across the port, we don't foresee much of a challenge in being competitive.

Mohit Kumar: Will take it offline. The third question, can you please help us the details of the Anchor Agreement to sign Jatadhar? What is the take -or-pay agreement and for how much volume?

Lalit Singhvi: Yes, Jatadhar, we have yet to sign the novation agreement, but there is a assured cargo coming from them. This is slurry line pipeline is getting attached to this port. Slurry pipeline has already got the take -or-pay agreement which will trigger from 1st of April '27. And the entire cargo which is coming through slurry pipeline will get transported through this port only. So, cargo is assured here. So, absolutely there is no issue of any dearth of cargo for this port.

Mohit Kumar: Okay. If the concession has been signed in June '25, the anchor customer, you mean that this is sub-concession, right? That's what you mean.

Lalit Singhvi: No. It is a concession only. It will get novated in our name. So, then it will be a full -fledged concession in our name because the concession provides that it can be novated to any of the group company. So, under the provisions of the policy and concession agreement, it will get novated to us. There is no such thing that we have to share anything. It will be completely in JSW Infra name.

Mohit Kumar : Understood. Thank you, sir and best of luck.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Priyanka Biswas from JM Financial. Please go ahead.

Priyankar Biswas: Good evening, sir. So, my first question is, what I observe is that there is a divergence between the volumes at Dharam tar and Jaigarh. Typically, they tend to move in line. I mean, like one is increasing, the other increases. So, why is this divergence this time? Like Jaigarh volumes are not keeping pace with what is happening at Dharam tar. If you can explain that.

Lalit Singhvi: Priyankar, as I said that there was some third-party cargo also, there is a dip. So, you are looking at the total cargo of Jaigarh which is dipping. So, the major part, if you look at 0.3, out of that 0.15 is third-party cargo. So, that I explained that MOP and urea thing, the government has not issued the order which was there in the earlier period. And this is coming in the 2nd Quarter.

And then there is a small gap of 0.15 which will get covered in this. There are certain ships which were to come in this quarter. They got shifted to this current quarter in July. So, July itself, there is a traction, and a lot of import booking has been done by JSW Steel in a larger ship which will bound to come at Jaigarh port. So, that will cover it up.

Priyankar Biswas: So, sir, if I understand correctly, if that be the case, then would it be fair to say that on a full-year FY26 basis, at least our group volumes would be similar to like what it was in FY24?

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 8 of 14

Lalit Singhvi: Absolutely. It should be, we expect a little better than last year.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay. And, sir, just adding one more question. So, what I see is NCR Rail, you have acquired recently. So, what is the rationale for that acquisition and how it will translate into revenues and EBITDA going forward?

Rinkesh Roy: So, this, as we told you earlier, that we are looking at building up a pan-India logistics network and primarily serving with the anchor base of steel cargo and then looking at IC Ds and containers for return cargo. So, keeping that in mind, this is one of those terminals we had identified to fit into our overall pan-India logistics plan. We see a big market in the nearby area and it also serves as a gateway to the NCR region. And location-wise, it's located bang on near the Eastern DFC

terminal DFC

as well as it is at the entry of the Western DFC. So, keeping all that in mind, we had found it to be a very strategic location and that's why we had zeroed in on this. So, it's part of a bigger network. So, it will start giving its EBITDA as and when we form the network in full.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay. And, sir, just one more question, if I can squeeze in. Regarding the terminal privatization at a major ports. So, of course, you got this Kolkata order, but are there any other ports, at least in the very near term, that is in FY26, which you may be interested in and may come up for near-term bidding?

Rinkesh Roy: So, what we have been given to understand is that many ports have already are getting or in the process of getting clearances for the various terminals. One is in Kolkata, which the outer terminal and the inner harbor of Netaji Subash Dock, these are all also coming up for further privatization bids. Similarly, we are also getting new bids coming up at Paradip. So, this process will be ongoing, and we will be participating in this, evaluating them and looking at all these terminals.

Priyankar Biswas: Okay, sir. That's broadly from my side. In case I have more, I will come back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Veenit from Investec. Please go ahead.

Veenit: Good evening, sir. Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, a couple of questions. One is, what is the status on the approval for expansion of capacity at South West from 11 to 15 million tonnes?

Where are we on the approval there?

Rinkesh Roy: So, here we have been, or we will be applying to the State Pollution Control Board for further increasing this capacity. We have already got the EC for 15 million tonnes and the subsequent part of increasing the capacity is now at the state level. So, we are pursuing this, and we expect the decision to be taken soon.

Veenit: Okay. Understood. And sir, at Jaigarh LPG Terminal, we have seen frequent delays in terms of timelines. Initially, we had started with Jan '26 as the timeline, which then got pushed to June '26 and now we are looking at FY27 year-end as the completion date. And even at Tuticorin, we

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 9 of 14

have pushed our timelines by a quarter. What is happening there and what gives you assurance that there will be no further delays at these locations?

Rinkesh Roy: So, first of all, let me talk to you about Tuticorin. So, Tuticorin, all the orders for piling, the machinery, the conveyor, everything has been placed and already piling works have started for the conveyors and the orders for the ship unloaders have been placed. So, these were the two main orders that had to be given. So, that is on track. We have just taken guidance for another three months because we got the final LOA at March '25 this year. So, that was the main reason. We had expected it to come somewhere between December and Jan. So, that actually pushed it by another quarter. So, that was the main reason. And LPG project in Jaigarh, the PESO approval

we got was slightly delayed. So, keeping that, these are all statutory approvals that need to be in place before we can undertake the project. So, that was the prime reason. But now we are on track and I think we should be completing it on schedule as we have given the guidance or before that.

Veenit: Understood. And, sir, last question from my end. For the NCR Rail resolution, if you can speak about any consideration which has to be paid out here, what could be the revenue potential of this asset? How should we think about this over the next 3 to 5 years?

Rinkesh Roy: So, as I explained to you, it's a part of a strategic fit of individual terminals in a pan-India logistics network. So, the development of the network itself is of kind of more important than looking at the individual terminals giving their EBITDA. So, keep

ing that in mind, it's very early days to

predict the exact numbers. And I think Lalit can talk about the considerations.

Lalit Singhvi: So, this is Rs. 467 crores is the amount for which we have bid for this. And as we said that once the grid is complete because we have to create 25-30 centers across the country, right from Arakonam Chennai, going up to NCR. So, we have got readily available this asset, which is very near to Eastern DFC and Jewar Airport and everything. So, that is a very good asset and we are looking for creating through GCT or stress assets or build our own. So, out of this, once we are getting something like this, which is readily available, it makes sense for us. So, as we have cargo availability from the group also, as we said, the base cargo will be coming from the group for this network. And then we will look for the possibility of getting a return cargo and all those things. So, over a period of time when the grid is in place, so that will certainly give us the desired ROCE which we are looking from the logistics sector.

Veenit: Understood. Thank you so much, sir, for this. Thank you.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Aditya Mongia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Mongia: Good evening, everyone. I hope I am audible to all. I will go ahead with my questions. The first question that I had was, something that others have also asked. The Jaigarh and Dharamtar, in Fiscal '24, did about 47 million tonnes. And we will end FY26 as per your guidance at 45-46. A simple question that I want to ask you is that what is the scope of third-party volume growth of these assets and is it as limited as numbers would suggest over the last few years? And similarly, JSW Infrastructure
July 22, 2025

Page 10 of 14

is captive taking a leg down because of its numbers looking bad or is it third-party which is broadly being absent over there from a growth perspective?

Lalit Singhvi: See, Aditya, as I said that Jaigarh and Dharamtar is serving primarily to Durgam steel plant, and it will have a lumpy growth. So, till the capacity additions come from 10 to 15 million tonnes, it will remain almost similar level and 1 or 2 million here and there it may be fluctuating. But coming to this year, we expect that it will be on the higher side, and it will be higher than last year's number. It will not be less than last year's number. So, we expect from Q2 itself we are seeing the traction because this year we are importing more because iron ore prices are lower. So, we see big shifts coming in from the month of July itself. So, whatever the shortfall is there, it will be covered up.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. Maybe a length of question over here. Is there any change in the sourcing pattern of the captive customer which is leading us to see slightly weaker numbers on the captive side?

I ask so because in a 2-year basis it seems to be declining quite meaningfully and just wanted to kind of check whether there is any change in sourcing pattern for any of the raw materials that the captive customer requires for itself.

Lalit Singhvi: See there is no such thing that any big numbers coming in. As I said, it is only a few millions here and there out of that 45 to 47 or 48 million the cargo what they need for running their 10 million tonnes capacity and it is going to be increased. So, cargo is going to come. It is a matter of year or 2 where you are seeing this problem. As they go to 10 to 15, their requirement will further increase. So, whatever the Mumbai anchorage they are getting it which is around say 10 million is the ultimate what they can do. So that is the only thing that 1 or 2 million here and there in Mumbai anchorage keeps fluctuating. So that is the only difference. Otherwise, there is no such thing which can affect our volume growth at Jaigarh to Dharamtar.

Rinkesh Roy: So broadly the

last 2-3 years trends have been to operate between 43 million to 46.5-47 million tonnes. That has been the broad range. And this year we are very sure and the guidance is for 46 million plus keeping both Dharamtar and Jaigarh together.

Aditya Mongia: Understood. I will move on to the next question. Just wanted to get a sense that this Ennore bulk terminal has done close to 3 million tonnes this quarter whereas is the capacity for the full year is about 9.6. Could you help us better understand how to see through the growth from this 3 million to 9.6?

Rinkesh Roy: I think you are confusing it with Ennore Coal. So, it is Ennore Coal is actually 9.6 and that is

going up to 11. So, we are broadly on track also. So, there is no issue on that.

Aditya Mongia : And can it expand beyond 11?

Rinkesh Roy: No, with the current setup, it will not expand beyond 11. So we have got the EC for 11 and that is what we are looking for.

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 11 of 14

Aditya Mongia: Okay. The final thing from my side, I just wanted to check the asset, the port volumes break-up that you give for the quarter somehow add up to be a slightly higher number than 29.4. That is one confusion, it appears to be 29.7. So, is there some inter-segmental things happening over there? I just want to clarify this. And part B of the question, somewhere in the footnote one talks about Tuticorin volumes not being there of about 0.6 million tonnes. So, should one be adding 0.6 million to your overall numbers and then taking through the annualized numbers? Just wanted to get a better sense of those two things.

Vishesh Pachnanda: No, Aditya, this is Vishesh. So that footnote is for the information purpose that Tuticorin in the last quarter was also considered in the standalone JSW Infrastructure Limited. So, one should not add or subtract that 0.6. That is just for the information.

Aditya Mongia: Okay. And there's some small discrepancy of 0.3 million tonnes. It's small, but it's like 1% of growth, so if you could just.

Vishesh Pachnanda: That discrepancy, I can come back to you once I get back.

Aditya Mongia: Sure. Those are my questions.

Vishesh Pachnanda: One more thing is there. We report numbers in million tonnes. So it might be rounding off or some casting at particular plant. So that at particular port, that could be also an issue. But I can come back to you.

Lalit Singhvi : So, Aditya, Vishesh will come back on this, if there is any issue, he will come back.

Aditya Mongia: Thank you so much. Those were my questions. If there's anymore, I will come back in the queue.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Ketan Jain from Aventus Spark. Please go ahead.

Ketan Jain: Thank you. Good evening, sir. I just have one question. What is the expected commissioning of the recently won terminal at Kolkata?

Rinkesh Roy: So, this will be, I think, 18 months from the award of concession. So, it will take some time for the conditions precedent to be completed. And from there, the clock will start ticking. So, we will be somewhere, let us say, October. So, 18 months from the concession, which may take another 4 to 6 months to get the concession. Around 2 years you can take from now.

Rinkesh Roy : August 26, Q2 of '27.

Ketan Jain : Okay. Understood. Thank you.

Moderator : The next question is from the line of Mohit Jain from Deven Choksey. Please go ahead.

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 12 of 14

Mohit Jain : Hi, sir. Good evening and congratulations on the good set of numbers, especially on the logistic side. Sir my question is for Navkar Corp only. So, what is the current capacity division across your three CFS and one IC D, particularly the Morbi IC D, which I guess previously was operating at below 30%. Please correct me if I am wrong. And when do you expect them to reach at the optimal level

of 70 %-80%? And one last thing on this, based on your existing infrastructure, what is the peak annual revenue potential, assuming net full utilization 80 %-90% across all three facilities?

Rinkesh Roy: So Morbi, if you see, we have been continuously going on an upward trend and the critical benchmark was crossing 5000 TEUs per month. So that we have done in the last quarter and we are maintaining that. Plus the mix of a major part of it you should realize is how much of empty and loaded ratios we are looking at. That ratio has improved in Morbi. So that gives a lot of better returns for us. And at the full 80 %-90% capacity utilization, we should expect around Rs. 800 to 850 crores top-line for these three or four terminals. And as you increase the rate fleet, that should be cross-touching. So, one part is the terminal and you increase the rate fleet, it should touch around 1000 Cr.

Mohit Jain: Alright, so just to follow up on this, so you said in the beginning, I guess, we are expecting around Rs. 750 to 800 crores in the logistics side this year. So that's around 80 %-90% only and I am assuming that most of the contribution is coming from Navkar. So, do you think we will reach a good utilization of Navkars this year? And next year, we need to look for some organic or inorganic expansion in terms of IC Ds?

Rinkesh Roy: Absolutely. We will have to add to the kitty somewhere one or two more terminals, especially in the Western Circuit, where it will be more of a logical fit for Navkar. Otherwise, we will be looking at expanding its growth.

Mohit Jain: Alright. And one last thing, one last question from my side since, sir, we have guided on the entire logistics space of Rs. 8,000 crores of revenue by FY30 and 25% EBITDA margin. And what I am assuming is that our logistics segment is now bifurcated between Navkar and Gatishakti. Please correct me if I am wrong.

Rinkesh Roy: No. I think it's all part of, Navkar is also a part of this entire fit.

Lalit Singhvi: So, we have a JSW Port Logistics company, and this Navkar is acquired by this Port Logistics Company. So, under Port Logistics Company, like Navkar, we will have many more such verticals coming in either through GCT or through stress asset buyout or building new one. So, what we are talking is the total logistic business when we say of investment of Rs. 9,000 crores or sales of Rs. 8,000 crores over a period of 5-6 years. So, this will be grown like that. So, Navkar, whatever Navkar can absorb, basis their balance sheet will come under Navkar. Rest, most of the things will come under the Port Logistics Company.

Mohit Jain: But this Rs. 8,000 crores, Navkar is a part of it, right?

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 13 of 14

Lalit Singhvi: Navkar is a part of that. Absolutely.

Mohit Jain: And sir, just to follow up on this, will Navkar be a very huge contributor to this Rs. 8,000 crores like above 50%-60%?

Lalit Singhvi: No. It can't be like that because the Navkar balance sheet doesn't permit that much. You know the balance sheet of Navkar. So, whatever the way EBITDA is improving now, you can see that EBITDA is improving substantially. So, whatever you can absorb basis net debt to EBITDA of our guidance, we will keep investing in this. But obviously, their balance sheet is not that strong that they can take that much of the load.

Mohit Jain: Got it. That answers my question. Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: Yes. Thank you so much for taking my question. Sir my first question is that we recently signed an MoU with the Konkan Railway for rail siding from Bhoke Railway Station to Jaigarh. So, could you just give some color on how binding is the agreement and where are we expecting this rail siding to come in and what is the potential timeline?

?

Rinkesh Roy: So, this is one of the nearest railheads to Jaigarh port. It's around 20-25 kilometers away from Jaigarh port. And number two, this railway siding is built on a deposit work basis so that we are funding the entire project and the Konkan Railway is to execute it for us. So they will be doing it in a period of again 1.5-2 years' time. And much of our rake logistics that we are building up, so this will also come into play at Bhoke siding. So, you can have tank containers, containerized traffic, fertilizer cargo moving from this Bhoke siding.

Nidhi Shah: And are we expecting a rail line from Bhoke to the port? Like what will be the situation of cargo from the port to the railway siding? Is it going to be here?

Rinkesh Roy: That we are not taking up right now. So, this will be outlet for rail bound traffic for Jaigarh port on the Konkan Railway network.

Nidhi Shah: Alright. Also, we can see that the realization per tonne on cargo has gone up about 2% this quarter Y-o-Y. Is that due to a price rise or due to a mix? And if you have taken a tariff hike, then what is normally the time when the company takes a tariff hike?

Lalit Singhvi: So, we have been able to increase some prices this year. Like Goa, we have increased. Then the coal terminal also we have increased. So wherever there is a possibility, otherwise WPI based in any way we are able to increase, but WPI was not that high. So, wherever it is not WPI linked, we have been able to increase substantially.

Nidhi Shah: Alright. Thank you so much. Generally, what is the time period when you take this tariff hike? Is it in Q4 or Q1?

JSW Infrastructure

July 22, 2025

Page 14 of 14

Lalit Singhvi: No. It is normally April to March. So, in Q1 itself, we increase whatever we can increase.

Nidhi Shah: Alright. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we take that as the last question for today. And I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments.

Rinkesh Roy: So, as we have gone through the results and the detailed questions from you all, I would like to reiterate again once more for the persons attending this conference that we stand by our guidance of 10% growth in throughput. And that is on an annual basis. And as has been explained to you, historically, H2 is greater than H1. And the trends are quite good in July. So, we are quite confident of meeting this guidance. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Nuvama Institutional Equities, that concludes this conference. Thank

you for joining us and you may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Aug 2025

(no extractable text — likely a scanned image PDF)

Call: Oct 2025

Page 1 of 15

"JSW Infrastructure Limited Q2 FY '26 Earnings
Conference Call "

October 16, 2025

MANAGEMENT : MR. RINKESH ROY – JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR &
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE
LIMITED
MR. LALIT SINGHVI – STRATEGIC ADVISOR & BOARD
MEMBER , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. NAGARAJAN J – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER , JSW
INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MR. VISHESH PACHNANDA – HEAD OF INVESTOR
RELATIONS , JSW INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. ALOK DEORA – MOTILAL OSWAL FINANCIAL
SERVICES LIMITED

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 16 , 2025

Page 2 of 15

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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the JSW Infrastructure Limited Q2 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call , hosted by Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode . There will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes . Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal an operator by pressing "*" then "0" on your touchtone phone.

Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Mr. Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you, and good evening, everyone, and welcome to the 2Q FY '26 Earnings Call of JSW Infrastructure.

We have with us today Mr. Rinkesh Roy – Joint Managing Director and CEO; Mr. Lalit Singhvi – Strategic Advisor and Board Member; Mr. Nagarajan J – Chief Financial Officer; and Mr. Vishesh Pachnanda – Head of Investor Relations.

I would now hand over the call to the Management to provide some opening remarks, and then we can proceed to the Q&A. Thank you, and over to you, sir.

Rinkesh Roy: Thank you, Alok. Good evening and thank you all for joining our Earnings Call for the Quarter Ended 30th September 2025.

The global economy continues to navigate a complex terrain. While trade volumes have remained resilient in the first half of 2025, geopolitical tensions and evolving trade policies,

especially from the US, have introduced new uncertainties.

Amidst this turbulent backdrop, India has emerged as a resilient and stable economy, underpinned by a forward-looking policy framework. The country's pro-growth stance remains intact with the RBI introducing a series of measures aimed at stimulating credit expansion. With inflation under control and fiscal consolidation progressing, the RBI has revisited India's GDP growth forecast upwards from 6.5% to 6.8% for FY '25-'26, signaling confidence in the country's economic trajectory despite prevailing global headwinds.

India's port sector remains central to its trade and infrastructure ambitions. In FY '26, the government has ramped up efforts to privatize, modernize and expand port capacity while enhancing connectivity and digitizing operations. At JSW Infrastructure, we are steadfast in our commitment to expanding our cargo handling capacity from the current 177 million tonnes per annum to 400 million tonnes per annum by FY '30 or earlier. This vision is being actively pursued through a series of strategic investments and development initiatives, particularly in greenfield port projects that are set to redefine India's maritime landscape.

October 16, 2025

Page 3 of 15

One of the key milestones achieved this quarter was at Keni port in Karnataka, where we successfully concluded the public hearing in August, an important step in the regulatory approval process. Similarly, Mumbai port in Maharashtra has made notable progress with the EIA report submitted in the previous quarter and a successful public hearing held in this month. These developments mark significant regulatory advancements and pave the way for construction activities to commence in the near future. Together, the progress at Keni and Mumbai ports reflect our focused execution and reinforces our commitment to building world-class port infrastructure across strategic coastal regions.

Notably, JSW Infrastructure stands out as the only port company in India currently engaged in the simultaneous development of three greenfield ports, Keni and Mumbai on the West Coast and Jatadhar in Orissa on the East Coast. These strategically located projects represent a combined capacity of 93 million tonnes per annum in their initial phase. This exceptional scale of infrastructure development reflects our unwavering commitment to strengthening India's maritime capabilities and meeting the evolving demands of trade and logistics through modern future-ready port assets.

Our 302 iron ore Slurry Pipeline project continues to advance steadily. As of now, 218 kilometers of welding and 195 kilometers of pipeline lowering have been completed. The project remains on track for completion by March '27. And once operational, it will significantly enhance the efficiency of iron ore transportation. Meanwhile, the construction activities at Jatadhar port are in full swing with contractors mobilized at the site and 4.5 million cubic meters of dredging being already completed, with the total work completion target of March '27.

At the JNPA liquid terminal, construction is nearing completion and commercial operations are expected to commence soon. Growth will also be propelled by opportunities in the privatization of terminals at major ports. As part of this strategy, we had earlier announced the receipt of a letter of award from the Syama Prasad Mookerjee Port Authority for the redevelopment of Berth 8 and mechanization of Berth 7 and 8 at Netaji Subhash Dock in Kolkata. Building on this milestone, we have now signed a 30-year concession agreement to operate the container terminal, which will have a handling capacity of 6.3 million tonnes per annum upon completion. This redevelopment is poised to significantly enhance container handling efficiency in the region, strengthening our presence on the Eastern Coast and contribute meaningfully to India's growing maritime trade. In line with the logistics business expansion plans, which is anchored in our strategy to build a robust pan-India logistics network that supports seamless multimodal connectivity and enhances operational efficiency across key ports and terminals and domestic movement of cargo.

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 16, 2025

Page 4 of 15

We have acquired a brownfield rail siding in Kudathini, Ballari, Karnataka. The site spans over 86 acres, and the facility is being transformed into a state-of-the-art multimodal logistics park featuring advanced land infrastructure, container handling systems, a rail freight terminal and a fully equipped inland container depot. Commercial operations are expected to begin within the next two to three months with a phased ramp-up. The total capital expenditure for the project is estimated at Rs. 380 crores, including Rs. 57 crores for the acquisition. This investment will be deployed over the next few years to fully develop the site into a comprehensive logistics hub. On the operational front, JSW Infrastructure handled 58.2 million tonnes of cargo during

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16, 2025

the

period April to September '25, marking a 4% year -on-year growth. This growth was significantly impacted by subdued cargo volumes at the Paradip Iron Ore Terminal, which saw a shortfall of approximately 3.4 million tonnes due to challenging macroeconomic conditions in the iron ore export market. In the absence of these headwinds, the Company's overall growth would have been closer to 10%.

Navkar Corporation, part of our group, delivered a standout performance in H1 FY '26, marked by a strong recovery in operational volumes and a return to profitability. Our operations and maintenance contracts in the UAE at the ports of Fujairah and Dibba have delivered exceptional operational performance. Notably, the port of Fujairah is on track to exceed its minimum cargo volume commitments, reflecting strong throughput and efficient handling. This outperformance positions us to benefit from a share in the profitability generated from the incremental cargo, further enhancing the commercial value of our engagement at the port.

To sum up, most of our domestic and international operations are running efficiently and nearing or exceeding their optimal capacity with the exception of the Paradip Iron Ore Terminal. Overall, on a consolidated basis, our total revenue was Rs. 2,686 crores for the first half of FY '26, representing a 23% year -on-year growth. EBITDA for the period stood at Rs. 1,387 crores, marking a 14% increase, while net profit reached Rs. 758 crores, reflecting a strong growth of 13%.

With this, let me hand over to Mr. Nagarajan – our CFO, to take us through the Financials and other details.

Nagarajan J : Thank you, Rinkesh, and good evening, everybody. Let me first talk about our port business.

In Q2 FY '26, the company handled cargo volumes of 28.9 million tonnes as compared to 28 million tonnes in the quarter ended September '24. The 3% volume increase was primarily driven by strong performance in SWPL, Jaigad port and Dharamtar port. Additionally, interim operations we started at Tuticorin and JNPA liquid terminal, which contributed positively. Despite the strong contributions from key ports, growth was moderated by a 2.1 million tonne shortfall during the quarter at the Paradip Iron Ore Terminal, driven by weak seaborne iron ore export market conditions. Without these headwinds, overall growth would have been closer to 10% on the cargo volumes.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16, 2025

Page 5 of 15

Group cargo increased to 15.7 million tonnes from 14.8 million tonnes, a growth by 1 million tonne, representing a 6% growth. And share of group volumes stood at 54% this quarter versus 52% a year ago. The third -party volumes had a marginal decline of 1% Y-o-Y, mainly attributable to the weak cargo volumes at Paradip Iron Ore Terminal. The growth in cargo volumes and the change in volume mix resulted in a 10% Y -o-Y increase in operational revenue, which stood at Rs. 1,103 crores in Q2 FY '26.

Operational EBITDA for the port segment was at Rs. 585 crores, which was up from Rs. 521 crores, an increase of 12 %. Above that, the margin also improved to 53 % from 52% a year ago on the back of strong operational performance at private ports led by Jaigad, SWPL and Dharamtar.

Talking about the logistics part :

Navkar Corporation delivered strong operational and financial results in Q2 FY '26. Export cargo volumes reached 79,000 TEUs, representing a robust 20% Y -o-Y growth. Domestic cargo volumes stood at 394,000 metric tonnes, up 46% compared to the same last year. Last year, the number was around 270,000 tonnes. Revenue from operations for Navkar rose to Rs. 163 crores, reflecting a 20% jump Y -o-Y. EBITDA climbed to Rs. 25 crores, showing substantial improvement, while net profit increased to Rs. 4 crores, a significant turnaround from a loss of Rs. 2 crores in the previous year.

Total consol revenue for the company stood at Rs. 1,372 crores and

total EBITDA inclusive of

other income stood at Rs. 716 crores, reflecting a Y -o-Y growth of 26% and 18%, respectively.

The EBITDA growth was largely driven by increased revenue from higher EBITDA yielding assets, SWPL, Jaigad and Dharamtar. Consolidated depreciation was Rs. 149 crores versus Rs. 134 crores in previous year. The increase is mainly on account of consolidation of Navkar Corp and capitalization of covered shed project at SWPL Goa. Finance cost was Rs. 99 crores in the current quarter as compared to Rs. 75 crores, respectively, in the quarter ended September 2024, increase is attributable to higher net debt.

During the quarter ended September '25, we recognized an unrealized FX loss of Rs. 5 crores, primarily driven by fluctuation in the dollar -rupee rate and also changes in the yield curve. This is primarily a non -cash accounting adjustment in accordance with IndAS 109. In contrast to the same quarter last year, we recorded an unrealized gain of Rs. 155 crores. As a result, PBT for Q2 FY '26 stood at Rs. 463 crores compared to Rs. 554 crores in Q2 FY '25. However, excluding the impact of these non -cash adjustments in both periods, the underlying PBT would have

reflected a Y-o-Y growth of 17%.

The ETR for the quarter stood at 20 %, significantly lower than 33 % in the same period last year. This reduction is primarily attributable to recognition of tax credit related to ESOPs and also adoption of tonnage tax for our four MDCs at Jaigad port. The tonnage tax concept came in this year, so it will start from FY '26. PAT for the current year declined by 1% at Rs. 369 crores as compared to Rs. 374 crores in the same period last year.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 6 of 15

I am also pleased to share that our company has achieved a significant financial milestone as we have been assigned an investment-grade rating of BBB -minus from BB -plus with a stable outlook by both S&P Global Ratings and Fitch Ratings. This recognition reflects the strength of our financial fundamentals, disciplined capital management and resilience of our business models.

Coming to the CAPEX part now, the aggregate financial commitments across all growth projects encompassing the awarded work orders and procurement of materials stood at Rs. 3,300 crores. So, that means almost Rs. 3,300 crores of capital commitments we have done. And the spend in the first half of this financial year stands at Rs. 902 crores for CAPEX .

Coming to the ratios now :

As of September 2025, we have a net debt of Rs. 1,810 crores with a net debt to operating EBITDA on a trailing 12 -month basis of 0.75 and one of the strong balance sheets in the sector. This, coupled with steadily increasing annual cash flows from the current asset base, we are well positioned to pursue a growth plan to enhance our present cargo handling capacity to 400 million tonnes per annum and parallelly grow our logistics business with a top line of Rs. 8,000 crores by 2030.

With this, I request the operator to open the line for Q&A.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question -and-answer session. Our first question comes from the line of Sumit Kishore from Axis Capital. Please go ahead.

Sumit Kishore: Good evening, sir. Thanks for the opportunity. My first question is in relation to the port business volumes, which have been up about 4% in the first half. Would you like to revisit your guidance for the full fiscal in terms of growth? And also, if you could comment on the port realization per tonne, which seems to have gone up almost 7% year -on-year during this quarter , is it because of the mix of JSW Group being higher? That's my first question.

Rinkesh Roy: So, as you were hearing that the main losses we suffered was on account of Paradip Iron Ore Terminal. And what we are observing is that generally, as a rule, we do far better in H2 than in H1. So, that will be

a good driver for growth.

Second part would be that iron ore prices are now roughly firming up in the market and the trends that we are observing in October is far better than what we saw in September. And at the same time, we are seeing a robust growth at the group level. So, these three factors what we are seeing , should help us to have a far better growth than what we saw in H1. However, the exact numbers we are looking at , keeping these factors in mind, we are looking at something between 8% to 10%. But again, a lot of it depends on how the iron ore market will pan out in the coming days.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 7 of 15

And on the realization part, as we had explained, so these are coming at our three major private terminals, especially at Jaigad and Dharamtar and also at Goa, where we are giving more additional cargo -related services. So, even with the same volumes, we are getting a better margin on giving additional cargo -related services.

Nagarajan J : So, just to add to Rinkesh's point on the second question. So , almost we can say Rs. 265 crores uptick is there in the revenue from operations on a Y -o-Y basis, if you look at, of which Rs. 162 crores is Navkar. So, we take that out, leftover is around Rs. 100 crores. Out of this Rs. 100 crores, Rs. 27 crores, it was primarily on account of a rate increase we have taken in SWPL as well as in Ennore Coal Terminal. So, this is a permanent rate increase, which will continue for the forthcoming quarters.

So, on account of rate increase, primarily in coal as well as on some rail kind of assets, we have taken this rate increase, which is at Rs. 27 crores. Balance, Rs. 68 crores is coming primarily because of the volume increase, which has happened in SWPL, Jaigad and Dharamtar port, if you look at it on a Y -o-Y basis. So, these three port assets , on a per tonne basis the revenue is higher as well as the EBITDA is also higher. So, that's where we see that the revenue has gone up on account of these three ports giving higher volumes. Also, corresponding impact has also been there on the EBITDA.

Sumit Kishore: Sure. This is very clear. My second question is in relation to CAPEX . You mentioned that first half CAPEX has been about Rs. 9.02 billion , what is the CAPEX target for FY '26? And if you could split it across the port and logistics business separately?

Nagarajan J : Yes. So, we have given a guidance of Rs. 4,000 crores spend in the port business and Rs. 1,500 crores spend in the logistics business , so we continue with that guidance.

Sumit Kishore: Okay. So, there's going to be a pickup in second half?

Nagarajan J : Yes. So, if you look at our capital commitments, it's around Rs. 3,300 crores.

Rinkesh Roy: Already in the first half.

Nagarajan J : Yes. So, payouts can be a few quarters here and there, but commitments have already been there. And obviously, this is a group CPC cell which negotiates the credit terms , so it's always a bit stringent.

Sumit Kishore: Sure. And I would just like to squeeze in one quick clarification. You had mentioned on the previous call that your logistics revenue target for the fiscal is Rs. 7 billion to Rs. 8 billion and EBITDA target of Rs. 1 billion. I mean, what is your take on this guidance after 1H?

Nagarajan J : Yes, we will continue with that guidance. And also from a logistics CAPEX spend perspective, it is always a mix of acquisition, organic as well as inorganic growth. From an inorganic side, we have already announced acquisition of Kudathini multimodal, the Kudathini Railway Siding, JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 8 of 15

and there are more on the anvil, acquisitions coming on the anvil . Coming to Navkar EBITDA, we are at Rs. 45 crores in H1, and we continue with our guidance of Rs. 100 crores for FY '26.

Sumit Kishore: Thank you. That's all from my side.

Moderator: Thank you

. Our next question comes from the line of Bharani from Avendus Spark. Please go ahead.

Bharanidhar Vijayakumar: Yes. So, my first question is on our upcoming asset additions in the next two years like Jatadhar port or the Slurry Pipeline, etc. So , what is the status of these projects in terms of, say, approvals or environmental clearance or land acquisition or giving contract to the EPC contractor, etc. ? If you can update on the status of these projects?

Rinkesh Roy: Okay. So , I will be limiting myself to two specific projects that you asked about , one is Jatadhar port and one is Slurry Pipeline. So, these are all ongoing projects. So , there are now no regulatory approvals that have to be taken. So, all the regulatory approvals are in place. And in Jatadhar, work has started. Dredging works have been completed to the tune of 4.5 million cubic meters and work on the berths and other conveyors and all, these have also started. So, we are on course to completion of this project by March ' 27. Parallely, the Slurry Pipeline, this is a 30 2-kilometer project, out of which 218.3 kilometers of welding of pipes has been done. And out of that 218.3, 194.4 kilometers have been lowered into the ground. So, broadly, you can say 60% to 70% of the work on this project has already been completed and we expect its completion also on schedule by March '27.

Bharanidhar Vijayakumar: Okay. That is very helpful. Can you throw some light on the nature of the disruption in the iron ore market, which impacted Paradip's volumes? And what could reverse or change in the coming quarters, which can result in the volumes growing there? Thank you.

Rinkesh Roy: So, if you look at the statistics across all the four iron ore terminals at Dhamra, Paradip Iron Ore, Paradip port terminal as well as Gopalpur. Last year, H1, there was around 16 million tonnes of iron ore dispatched from these four terminals , this year it has dropped down to around 9 million tonnes. So, there has been a loss of 7 million tonnes of iron ore movement across these four port terminals. Because the iron ore prices had come down below a normal economic level for movement. And these prices have gone up in the last month, and we are now seeing a firming up of these prices in the international market. And a lot of players have started movement , especially some of the large miners operating in that area. So, they have started their movements, and we are foreseeing a better performance from October onwards.

Bharanidhar Vijayakumar: Sure. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Mohit Kumar from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 9 of 15

Mohit Kumar: Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, I have two questions. First is on the Kolkata container terminal, which you won in the Q2. If I look at the volumes for the Kolkata for a very long period of six to eight years, the container volume has not grown, right? So, I am trying to understand the strategy, how do you see the cargo volumes here and the capacity ramp -up as you commission this particular asset?

Rinkesh Roy : You are right, there has been a static movement at Kolkata. But one thing you will appreciate is

that Kolkata is one of those few terminals which serve a very captive market. And the market they had missed out on in the last few years was the Nepal traffic, which had shifted to Visakhapatnam. And there is a trend now that with better efficiencies that we will get in, along with the port taking the right measures to improve efficiencies in and around the port logistics, we are expecting this traffic to also make a comeback back into Kolkata, and that will drive the growth further.

Mohit Kumar: So, do we have some kind of estimate for the Nepal traffic?

Rinkesh Roy: The Nepal traffic, the current estimations are that we will be getting around 30% to 40%

the

moment we set up the right infrastructure, because these are currently without topside equipment. So, within 18 months or so we expect a gradual shift back into Kolkata. And this terminal, we are expecting a full occupancy, at least 90% occupancy at these two berths that we are taking.

Mohit Kumar: Understood, sir. My second question on the bid pipeline for privatization. If I look at the government's initial announcement, FY '26 was looking to be very strong. I think we had around four to five terminals, which were supposed to bid out in Paradip. Can you please help us with the update on the bid pipeline? And how are you looking for H2, do you think --

Rinkesh Roy: So, currently, the one RFQ that's in the market is the Paradip south key terminal. And subsequently, many other terminals in Paradip will be coming up for mechanization bids, including CQ1 and CQ2 and IOHP. So, these all will be coming up, and we will be evaluating and proceeding and participating there.

Mohit Kumar: And are there any container terminal bid which is in the market as of now?

Rinkesh Roy: As of now, the Kolkata balance of NSD will be coming up, for which the RFQ has already come up. That is for the balance part of the Netaji Subhas Dock. And the outer harbor in Tuticorin, that's a mega project, but that will be also coming up soon where they will be tweaking with the terms of the concession. So, these two things will be coming up very shortly, that's our expectation.

Mohit Kumar: Understood, sir. Thank you and all the best.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Veenit from Investec. Please go ahead.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16, 2025

Page 10 of 15

Veenit Pasad: Thank you for taking my questions. Sir, a couple of questions. One is what we understand is JSW Steel at Vijayanagar is taking some minor shutdowns, maintenance shutdowns for part of the capacity. Does that impact our volume, let's say, at Southwest or other terminals in any manner? And how much could be the impact of it?

Rinkesh Roy: So, we do not expect any impact on our volumes at either SWPL or any other location.

Veenit Pasad: Okay. And sir, secondly, if you look at Kolkata, do you expect interim operations to commence there or volumes will only come in post 18 months once the complete mechanization is done?

Rinkesh Roy: No, we will get interim operations in, and that also we will be doing it soon as quickly, as the conditions precedent are met we will be starting interim operations soon.

Veenit Pasad: Should we expect that in the next few months, two, three months or so?

Rinkesh Roy: We are keeping our fingers crossed. We are trying this next quarter. But hopefully, by end of this financial year, we should be starting our interim operation.

Veenit Pasad: Understood. And sir, one bookkeeping question. We have seen a sharp increase in the other income this quarter again despite cash balance or liquid investments coming off given our investments in the newer ports and you had acquired also Slurry pipeline end of last year. So, what is driving such increase in other income? And how should we think it going forward as well?

Nagarajan J: So, this is a one-off thing. So, there were some insurance claim which we have received on account of some claims done in Jaigarh port in Q1. So, we received a claim to the tune of Rs. 18 crores in Q2. That is what we have recognized in our books. Also, there was an arbitration which was going in SWPL and that arbitration concluded in our favor. We have taken a provision of Rs. 16 crores. The liability came to Rs. 6 crores. So, there is a reversal of Rs. 10 crores provision.

Veenit Pasad: Understood. And anything other than that to be aware about? Or other than that, it's all more regular.

Nagarajan J: No regular stuff. These are like one-off items, two major one-off items.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question

comes from the line of Mr. Achal from Nuvama Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Just two questions, sir. First, with respect to the tariff regime, given for our major port terminals, is there a case for the revision in tariff or any timeline you could talk about by when you can expect market pricing?

Rinkesh Roy: I could not get exactly what is it.

Page 11 of 15

Vishesh Pachnanda : Achal, would you mind repeating your question? Or is the tariff increase related to terminals or --

Achal Lohade: Yes. For our major port terminals, say, for iron ore, for example, or Goa terminals, right? These are under these are at major ports, which are under different tariff regimes. If we look at the new regulations, the government allows free market pricing for the major port terminals as well. I wanted to check if our terminals have also moved to free market pricing? If not, is there any expectation? Yes.

Lalit Singhvi : Achal, this new policy is still in a draft stage. So, it is not yet finalized. So, once it is finalized, they will all get benefit. So, right now, it is at the same tariff regime.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And the second, if you could give some more understanding on the Rs. 8,000 crores logistics revenue, what you mentioned by FY '30, what kind of mix are you expecting from EXIM to domestic road versus rail? If you could give some color in terms of organic as well as inorganic, if possible?

Rinkesh Roy: Just a minute. Broadly, what we are looking at, we are looking at going to a level of around 284 rakes by 2030, 2031. And in that, it would be close to 107 rakes of specialized rakes and 177 of container rakes. Plus, we are looking at setting up of around 24 rail terminals as well as five port terminals, broadly around in the range of 30 terminals by 2030 and purchase of containers along with the container train. So, these would be the three main areas apart from the expenditure on terminals. So, here, we are looking at from the domestic kind of CTO business, broad numbers would come to by five years down the line, it would be around rakes, containers and terminals put together. It would be around 25% margin that we are looking at out of that top line.

Achal Lohade: You are saying essentially out of Rs. 8,000 crores, Rs. 2,000 crores from domestic business. Have I understood right, sir, FY '30, '31?

Rinkesh Roy: No. The mix in domestic will be slightly higher than what you are looking at in EXIM. So, the breakup would be broadly, that is it would be somewhere around 60% would be domestic and around 40% will be EXIM.

Achal Lohade: And how much of that total Rs. 8,000 crores revenue would be from group cargo -- group customers?

Rinkesh Roy: So, group customers, we are expecting somewhere in the range of 35% to 40%. That would be the range.

Achal Lohade: Understood. And the investment is around Rs. 5,000 crores, if I remember the number right. If you could elaborate a little bit on that? How much there would be the capital...

Rinkesh Roy: Total CAPEX will be Rs. 9,000 crores. The top line would be Rs. 8,000 crores. EBITDA would be around ?

JSW Infrastructure Limited
October 16 , 2025

Page 12 of 15

Nagarajan J : 25%.

Rinkesh Roy: 25%.

Nagarajan J : So, of the Rs. 9,000 crores already Rs. 1,000 crores spend has happened on acquiring Navkar. Also, we have acquired Kudathini, of which we are expecting a spend of around Rs. 350 crores. So, these two spends have been locked in now.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Madhur Rathi from CCIPL. Please go ahead.

Madhur Rathi: Sir, I wanted to understand regarding current capacity utilization at Navkar and with the 100 acres of land that we have, sir, how much can our capacity be increased over the next three , four in our FY '30 outlook that we have?

Rinkesh Roy: So, broadly

y, I would put it as surplus land at Navkar would be to the tune of 100 acres split equally between Panvel and Morbi. So, it's broadly 59, 60 acres in Panvel and around 40 acres in Morbi. In the 60 acres that we look at Panvel, we are looking at utilizing around 10 to 12 acres of that. So, 50 acres will be still going surplus in Panvel area, which we will be monetizing or putting it to use at a later date, seeing the opportunities of growth there. And at Morbi, we are looking at more of long-term partnership with different customers. So, we have already approached some players there. And as and when these fructify, that will be offered on long-term lease.

Madhur Rathi: And sir, what is our current capacity at both these locations?

Rinkesh Roy: So, the current capacity utilization at, let us say, the Mumbai sector would be around 60% to 65%. And in Morbi, it will be in the range of 55% to 60%.

Madhur Rathi: Got it. Sir, just a final question from mine. Sir, if I consider Morbi as a ceramic hub of India, sir, how much of the logistics requirement there would be either catered by us or our private cruise terminal? And sir, how big can this opportunity become over the next three to five years?

Rinkesh Roy: So, you see we have already started a service. To answer your question, we have already started a service transporting tiles from Morbi to Kolkata. And then on the return leg, we are picking up a lot of other cargo back into Mumbai region and then onwards into Morbi. So, we have been able to do three services of this Morbi, Kolkata last month, and this will be gradually increasing. And again, the potential for different sectors is being reviewed, and we are putting up strategies in place for that.

Moderator: Thank you. We have our next question from the line of Ankita Shah from Elara Capital. Please go ahead.

Ankita Shah : Sir, I just had one question. What is happening in the Fujairah terminal? There has been a continuous gradual decline in the volumes there. So, I just wanted to understand.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 13 of 15

Rinkesh Roy: So, Ankita, there was a kind of in the first half of this year, there was an issue with black oil demand in that area totally. So, there was more demand for white tanks than for black tanks and the prices there , black product prices also came down. Now we are gradually seeing that it's come back to some sort of normalcy. And we are hopeful that we should be slightly less than last year, not greatly down, but slightly less than last year. At the same time, EBITDA numbers will be maintained at last year's level despite this disruption in black oil.

Ankita Shah : Okay. And this concession is also expiring next year, right, 2027. So, is there any scope for renewal there or this will be handed over back?

Lalit Singhvi : So, this you are talking about the O&M contract what we have in Fujairah, right?

Ankita Shah : Yes.

Lalit Singhvi : Because the oil terminal is our own. There is no period as such. So, this O&M contracts will be renewed because they have a practice of giving on a five-year basis. So, this is a second in run.

And then once it comes to nearer term because they are very happy with that performance. So, it's one-on-one what we have got from the government of Fujairah, this is likely to be continued okay.

Nagarajan J : So, rollover of that contract will happen.

Ankita Shah : And as Rinkesh sir mentioned that there has now been an uptick at this terminal. Can you see this scaling up maybe one or two years down the line to a higher number in terms of volume contribution?

Rinkesh Roy: So, Fujairah port and Dibba port, they will be going on the higher scale. Dibba is the first year of operations and is doing very well. So, their numbers will also increase. And Fujairah is also increasing now because there is one more mines, which has increased the production, which is

opposite to this port. So, we can see the quantum going up in the years to come.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Alok Deora from Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited.

Alok Deora: Just had a couple of questions. So, first is on logistics. So, we are looking at these kind of investments over the next four, five years. So, is it fair to assume that a large part would be through the acquisition mode, I mean, through the inorganic route or we would be kind of doing it a little on the organic side as well?

Rinkesh Roy: So, it will be a mix of both. And as I told you, a great part of it will be on creation of low-cost terminals. So, we are looking at the GCTs in a very, very serious way. So, GCTs will be a very big driver for our growth, along with wherever we get good acquisition opportunities, we will be taking that.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 14 of 15

Alok Deora: Sure. And you have highlighted this just to get some more clarity, the iron ore volumes, which declined, which kind of impacted the second quarter. So, in October, they have kind of normalized or we are just hoping that it will kind of normalize during the quarter?

Rinkesh Roy: No, no. If you see the entire quarter of Q2 was around even less than one million. So, it's around three lakhs. And here now, we are gradually seeing that this month, it would be upwards of around five lakhs. So, we are seeing a gradual uptick in that.

Alok Deora: Okay. But Q3 also could be a Y-o-Y kind of a decline?

Rinkesh Roy: It might be unless there's a good movement price increase. Otherwise, we will be still seeing a Y-on-Y decrease. But we have to kind of reduce the losses. So, there, we are seeing that the losses might get reduced.

Alok Deora: Sure. Got it. Just one last question. So, the overall margins, which have come down in the quarter as compared to the last quarter, it's kind of below 50%. So, that's primarily driven by the volume only. I mean, had the volumes been normalized, the margin would have been on the upper side?

Nagarajan J : No, this is a consol P&L, which we have shared, which includes Navkar also. Last year, Navkar was not there. Navkar came in October second week. So, Navkar typically a 15% EBITDA

business, whereas you see the port business has given a 53% EBITDA margin, which is one% up from what we have had last year. So, on a weighted average basis, it's at 46% or 47 %.

Alok Deora: Right. So, going forward, it would be like a weighted average would be like a 47%, 49% kind of range.

Nagarajan J : Yes, somewhere between oscillating between 45 % and 50 %.

Alok Deora: Sure. And this Navkar margins can it inch higher ahead as the volumes also scale up?

Nagarajan J : Yes, a bit higher, not much, but.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Nidhi Shah from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Nidhi Shah: So, my first question is on the contribution of Dharamtar and Jaigarh in our H1 EBITDA on % terms?

Lalit Singhvi : So, Dharamtar and Jaigarh EBITDA margin range is around 65% to 70%.

Nidhi Shah: Not the margin. I was wondering in the consol, what is the contribution of Dharamtar and Jaigarh?

Vishesh Pachnanda : Maybe I can get back to you on this. It's a very number specific question. So, maybe after the call, I will get back to you.

JSW Infrastructure Limited

October 16 , 2025

Page 15 of 15

Nidhi Shah: All right. My second question also could you also let me know about Tuticorin? And my second question would be on the tonnage tax. So, you mentioned that some tonnage tax impact was there this quarter. Where is this tonnage tax exactly coming from?

Nagarajan J : So, this is coming in Jaigarh port, wherein we have four mini bulk carriers in operation. So, overall, this year, we are expecting an EBITDA of around Rs. 50 crores from those operations.

So, tonnage tax savings or the tax

savings will be around Rs. 17 crores, which we are projecting for FY '26.

Nidhi Shah: And my last question would be the progress of the Slurry pipeline of laying down was only about five kilometers this quarter. Is that because of the rains?

Rinkesh Roy: Yes, yes. So, generally, this monsoon period, it totally gets waterlogged because these are very low-lying areas, they get totally waterlogged and actual real work starts happening somewhere

November type. But even there also, we try to do the places where there is no water logging. So, that is the main reason.

Nidhi Shah: So, we could see that the progress on this could significantly...

Rinkesh Roy: That is correct. You are absolutely correct.

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, we will take that as the last question for today. I would now like to hand the conference over to the management for closing comments. Over to you, gentlemen.

Rinkesh Roy : So, ladies and gentlemen, to conclude, I would like to highlight that JSW Infrastructure has had a remarkable journey over the past two decades. Looking ahead, the future holds even greater promise as we develop three new greenfield ports, advance value-accretive brownfield expansion projects and scale up our logistics platform to support long-term growth. The investments and efforts we are making today are poised to deliver significant gains in EBITDA and profitability starting FY '27, '28.

Thank you once again for your time. Wishing you and your families a joyful, prosperous and safe Diwali.

Vishesh Pachnanda : Thanks, operator.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Motilal Oswal Financial Services, that concludes this conference.

Thank you all for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Jan 2026

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Call: May 2026

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